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CITY OF BERKELEY

BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL SPECIAL MEETING

June 23, 2026

WEBVTT

1
00:01:56.280 --> 00:02:04.180
Boardroom: Pretty important.

2
00:02:22.980 --> 00:02:26.530
Boardroom: Paint… Okay.

3
00:02:26.710 --> 00:02:32.869
Boardroom: Alright, thank you everyone so much for your patience. I'm calling to order the special meeting of the Berkeley City Council.

4
00:02:33.000 --> 00:02:35.209
Boardroom: Folks, if you could quiet down, please.

5
00:02:36.570 --> 00:02:43.939
Boardroom: Thank you. It's, June 23rd, 2026, 617 p.m. Can you start us off with the roll, please?

6
00:02:44.000 --> 00:02:58.319
Boardroom: Thank you, Mayor. And before we start with Roll, I just want to let everyone know we've been advised by Councilmember Bartlett that he'll be participating remotely under the Just Cause exemption in the Brown Act, so we're just gonna run through that script real quick with Councilmember Bartlett.

7
00:02:59.340 --> 00:03:18.769
Boardroom: Councilmember Bartlett is intending to participate in the meeting remotely pursuant to the Brown Act under the Just Cause justification. A quorum of the Council is participating in person at a single physical location that is identified on the agenda, open to the public, within the boundaries of the agency, and meets accessibility requirements. This satisfies the requirements of the Brown Act.

8
00:03:19.390 --> 00:03:24.919
Boardroom: Councilmember Bartlett has notified us of their need to participate remotely.

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9
00:03:25.300 --> 00:03:38.789
Boardroom: Councilmember Bartlett, please provide a general description of the circumstances relating to your need to appear remotely at this meeting. You are reminded that you need not disclose any medical diagnosis, disability, or other confidential medical information.

10
00:03:39.190 --> 00:03:42.669
Ben Bartlett: Thank you. Let's just call it a child care emergency.

11
00:03:44.240 --> 00:04:00.640
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember Bartlett. Please at this time disclose, whether there are any other individuals 18 years of age or older, present in the room at your remote location, and if so, the general nature of your relationship with such individuals.

12
00:04:01.200 --> 00:04:03.149
Ben Bartlett: Unfortunately, I'm the only adult here.

13
00:04:03.620 --> 00:04:11.970
Boardroom: Thank you. And Councilmember Bartlett, you were reminded that you must participate through both audio and visual technology.

14
00:04:12.150 --> 00:04:15.639
Boardroom: Alright, thank you, everyone. And let's move on with the roll.

15
00:04:16.980 --> 00:04:20.410
Boardroom: Councilmember Kesarwani? Here. Taplin?

16
00:04:20.410 --> 00:04:21.209
Terry Taplin: Presence.

17
00:04:21.660 --> 00:04:22.640
Boardroom: Bartlett.

18
00:04:26.240 --> 00:04:36.010
Boardroom: Thank you. Trigab? Present. O'Keefe? Here. Blackaby? Here. Nunapara? Here. Humbert? Present. Amir Ishii? Here.

19
00:04:39.170 --> 00:04:39.850
Boardroom: Okay?

20

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00:04:40.800 --> 00:04:47.150
Boardroom: Alright, so since it's… tonight is a special meeting, we have only a couple of items on here.

21
00:04:47.320 --> 00:04:55.240
Boardroom: So, we have a supplemental that will be presented by staff, and then Councilmember Kesarwani, if you could also present your supplemental.

22
00:04:55.530 --> 00:05:06.390
Boardroom: And, just so folks know, what we'll do is, I will also have some comments, and then we'll move over to questions, so if anyone has any questions.

23
00:05:06.390 --> 00:05:16.719
Boardroom: for any of the supplementals or anything about the CAP or the budget, and then, we will take public comment, and then we'll hear comments from the council members before voting, so…

24
00:05:17.150 --> 00:05:20.330
Boardroom: Okay would you like to take it away?

25
00:05:24.770 --> 00:05:26.599
Boardroom: Barry Card, or Dave?

26
00:05:29.570 --> 00:05:39.189
Boardroom: Thank you, Mayor Ishii and Councilmembers. We have a very short presentation for you tonight, so, share screen. Thank you.

27
00:05:39.780 --> 00:05:41.049
Boardroom: Very much.

28
00:05:41.420 --> 00:05:43.310
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

29
00:05:47.370 --> 00:05:55.890
Boardroom: Again, we're meeting at a special council meeting tonight to adopt the proposed 27 and 28 biannual budget and the proposed 5-year CIP.

30
00:05:55.950 --> 00:06:10.449
Boardroom: Also, to adopt the fiscal year 2027 Annual Appropriation Ordinance. This particular PowerPoint presentation is just to go over the

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changes since last Tuesday's meeting, June 16th, 2026. Next slide, please.

31
00:06:13.140 --> 00:06:22.909
Boardroom: there were some changes that happened within a week that we presented last Tuesday, and most of those were to capture First Source and Civic Arts

32
00:06:23.540 --> 00:06:29.819
Boardroom: Budget, as well as our pass-through, business, district budget.

33
00:06:30.300 --> 00:06:33.250
Boardroom: Just to capture the projected revenue.

34
00:06:33.660 --> 00:06:35.259
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

35
00:06:37.740 --> 00:06:56.799
Boardroom: And the same thing for the expenditures. They were mostly to capture the civic arts and public arts, and first source budget to reflect what is contributed from the capital projects that are eligible, as well as the pass-through budget of our business improvement districts.

36
00:06:58.200 --> 00:06:59.850
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

37
00:07:03.640 --> 00:07:10.870
Boardroom: Overall, this is a proposed all-fund summary from the changes, so what we are looking now,

38
00:07:11.220 --> 00:07:17.400
Boardroom: Further, any more changes after this presentation is a proposed budget.

39
00:07:17.610 --> 00:07:26.679
Boardroom: Of $918.1 million of a 2027 budget, with a revenue of $787.3.

40
00:07:26.970 --> 00:07:29.950
Boardroom: And fiscal year 2028 budget of…

41
00:07:30.080 --> 00:07:36.979

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Boardroom: $873.1 million in expenditure, and $789.6 million.

42
00:07:37.460 --> 00:07:39.130
Boardroom: of revenue.

43
00:07:39.360 --> 00:07:55.370
Boardroom: As I've already stated in the prior slide, the changes come from pass-through business improvement district funds, along with anticipated revenues approved by Council in May and June of 2026, and changes also incorporate the appropriate budget for First Source and Public Arts.

44
00:07:55.660 --> 00:08:03.610
Boardroom: As well as updates to the Parks Tax and Measure FF, based on the revised public arts and First Source contributions.

45
00:08:03.750 --> 00:08:17.499
Boardroom: There is a sub… as part of our supplemental 2, there is a detailed explanation of the changes, in the Schedule of Changes attachment. There is no changes made to the general fund since the 6-16 meeting.

46
00:08:17.700 --> 00:08:19.290
Boardroom: Next slide, please.

47
00:08:20.140 --> 00:08:23.830
Boardroom: That concludes this very short presentation. Thank you so much.

48
00:08:24.620 --> 00:08:26.230
Boardroom: Thank you very much.

49
00:08:26.400 --> 00:08:28.729
Boardroom: Do you want to go ahead, Councilmember?

50
00:08:32.960 --> 00:08:35.150
Boardroom: Sure, thank you very much, Madam Mayor.

51
00:08:37.590 --> 00:08:45.430
Boardroom: Thank you, Mr. City Manager, and Deputy City Manager, and all of the department heads, Ms. Dupaiah, and

52

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00:08:45.430 --> 00:09:00.929
Boardroom: all of the other staff who have worked really hard, to propose really painful reductions so that the budget before us tonight is balanced. I just want to share some opening thoughts that this has been among

53
00:09:00.980 --> 00:09:14.090
Boardroom: the most challenging budgets that I have faced on the Council in my 8 years of serving on this body, and unlike the budget of fiscal year 2021, when we had the global COVID-19 pandemic and a recession.

54
00:09:14.160 --> 00:09:23.780
Boardroom: In some ways, this budget is more dire, because we are not in a recession. There isn't a reason to draw on our reserves.

55
00:09:23.910 --> 00:09:30.529
Boardroom: Yet we face a structural deficit in which expenditures, particularly for position costs.

56
00:09:31.000 --> 00:09:37.700
Boardroom: Are on track to consistently outpace revenues unless we reduce the size of our organization.

57
00:09:38.520 --> 00:09:55.530
Boardroom: I want you all to know that I have spent countless hours over the last month especially, poring over our budget to ensure that it reflects our values of fiscal sustainability, investment in basic services like street paving.

58
00:09:55.660 --> 00:09:58.540
Boardroom: And protection of the most vulnerable.

59
00:09:58.950 --> 00:10:02.130
Boardroom: I have seen the dedication of our city staff.

60
00:10:02.650 --> 00:10:08.459
Boardroom: And on a personal note, it really does, pain me that

61
00:10:09.370 --> 00:10:16.589
Boardroom: This budget before us considers layoffs for certain individuals who will not be able to shift into vacant positions.

62
00:10:16.750 --> 00:10:35.269

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Boardroom: But I do want to thank our city manager and our HR Director for the ongoing work to determine if, folks can shift to a position that's vacant for which they are qualified for. That is something I push very hard for, and

63
00:10:35.450 --> 00:10:42.030
Boardroom: I'm really pleased that we can do that. So, you know, let me go into the proposed amendments.

64
00:10:42.300 --> 00:10:46.350
Boardroom: That I have submitted, and they're available online.

65
00:10:47.290 --> 00:10:57.199
Boardroom: And, first, I want to thank the mayor for her proposal, and what I'm proposing here is intended to be in addition to

66
00:10:57.580 --> 00:11:07.210
Boardroom: the mayor's proposal, and in working very closely with the city manager, and listening to the feedback from…

67
00:11:07.670 --> 00:11:18.829
Boardroom: the fire department, and the concerns that have been raised about the elimination of positions, I am proposing to use general fund sources

68
00:11:19.050 --> 00:11:25.250
Boardroom: to fund… 9 full-time equivalent positions in the fire department.

69
00:11:25.440 --> 00:11:32.980
Boardroom: So you can… I'm referring to the Exhibit 1 summary of the proposed recommendation.

70
00:11:33.210 --> 00:11:37.189
Boardroom: It's gonna take me some time to get it onto the Zoom, because I don't have a Zoom…

71
00:11:37.460 --> 00:11:46.419
Boardroom: Okay, thank you, Councilmember Blackaby. I want to thank, actually, Councilmember Blackaby and Councilmember Taplin for co-sponsoring this budget proposal.

72
00:11:47.390 --> 00:11:50.799

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Boardroom: So, so we have these general fund sources.

73
00:11:51.180 --> 00:11:54.930
Boardroom: And, we are proposing to use those sources to fund

74
00:11:55.040 --> 00:12:01.000
Boardroom: Five firefighters, 3 paramedics, and 1 fire inspector.

75
00:12:01.740 --> 00:12:08.540
Boardroom: In regards to the fire inspector, I do want to note that that position… approves…

76
00:12:10.080 --> 00:12:15.849
Boardroom: They conduct inspections, permit reviews, and code enforcement services.

77
00:12:16.000 --> 00:12:27.889
Boardroom: So, to the extent that we have longer wait times for permit reviews, that would pose a detrimental impact to approving building permits for new housing developments in a timely manner.

78
00:12:28.000 --> 00:12:35.210
Boardroom: And so, I think that is a very important position to propose funding.

79
00:12:35.460 --> 00:12:50.909
Boardroom: We also have, $50,000 from Councilmember Blackaby's district office budget that is going to fund Euclid Street Garbage Corral design in his district, so it's $50,000 in the first year and $25,000 in the second year.

80
00:12:51.330 --> 00:12:57.060
Boardroom: And then finally, I want to talk about this small sites allocation from the Housing Trust Fund.

81
00:12:59.640 --> 00:13:02.759
Boardroom: I am a strong supporter of affordable housing.

82
00:13:02.860 --> 00:13:09.050
Boardroom: But we are in a $30 million budget deficit that necessitates layoffs.

83

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00:13:09.370 --> 00:13:16.090
Boardroom: In a situation like that, I think we have to be very smart about how we spend our scarce resources.

84
00:13:16.910 --> 00:13:32.270
Boardroom: I want to note that the land trusts in recent years have received $8.2 million from the City of Berkeley to acquire properties. I'm gonna say that again. They have received $8.2 million.

85
00:13:32.600 --> 00:13:39.729
Boardroom: So what I am asking for is consideration For new affordable housing.

86
00:13:41.470 --> 00:13:50.969
Boardroom: As my report notes, we have 1740 San Pablo Avenue, which is a blighted property at the corner of Delaware Street and San Pablo Avenue.

87
00:13:51.160 --> 00:14:04.079
Boardroom: That's one example of where these funds could be used. They are in need of $2-4 million in local GAAP funding that will create 54 new units of below-market rate affordable housing.

88
00:14:04.370 --> 00:14:10.869
Boardroom: I just want to note that people who've already been displaced from our community, particularly the black population.

89
00:14:11.100 --> 00:14:17.460
Boardroom: They're not able to come here tonight and advocate for their interests. That's why I'm here

90
00:14:17.630 --> 00:14:23.419
Boardroom: to advocate for people who can no longer afford to live in our community. Please.

91
00:14:24.060 --> 00:14:26.260
Boardroom: And I have been a champion

92
00:14:26.440 --> 00:14:37.839
Boardroom: for 6 years, leading a community engagement process at the North Berkeley BART station to create more than 700 homes at that station, half of them affordable to low-income households.

93
00:14:38.610 --> 00:14:46.530

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Boardroom: And we have a proposal for permanent supportive housing for formerly homeless people at that site. 85 new units.

94
00:14:46.730 --> 00:14:59.169
Boardroom: And they are doing all they can to secure their funding stack. They just submitted a Homekey Plus proposal, and they are in need of $3 million of local GAAP funding. So I'm advocating for

95
00:14:59.540 --> 00:15:04.299
Boardroom: Unsheltered homeless people in the city of Berkeley and in Alameda County?

96
00:15:04.470 --> 00:15:10.030
Boardroom: So that building can get built as soon as possible, and they can have a shot to come inside.

97
00:15:12.640 --> 00:15:13.610
Boardroom: So…

98
00:15:13.980 --> 00:15:29.929
Boardroom: I am for affordable housing, I am for spending our scarce dollars in a smart way. When we put our scarce housing trust fund monies into new affordable housing, you know, in this report, I need to explain to folks

99
00:15:30.170 --> 00:15:32.849
Boardroom: Because of the way affordable housing works.

100
00:15:32.990 --> 00:15:37.160
Boardroom: That… those funds leverage state.

101
00:15:37.380 --> 00:15:55.800
Boardroom: Funds, federal low-income housing tax credits, and private investment at a rate of $4 to $1. So the $3.8 million that we're talking about for the Housing Trust Fund, that creates $19 million that can be invested in our community.

102
00:15:55.900 --> 00:15:58.540
Boardroom: That is what I am fighting for.

103
00:16:01.810 --> 00:16:12.360
Boardroom: And then finally, I take the issue of tenant protection very seriously. I talked at the outset about protecting the most vulnerable.

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104
00:16:12.360 --> 00:16:26.529
Boardroom: This budget, despite all of the sacrifice that has been made, it still includes $800,000 in each year going to Eviction Defense Center and East Bay Community Law Center.

105
00:16:26.640 --> 00:16:31.090
Boardroom: to fund eviction defense.

106
00:16:31.650 --> 00:16:38.939
Boardroom: And we have $200,000 in total, $100,000 each year, going to flexible funds to help people stay housed.

107
00:16:39.530 --> 00:16:40.660
Boardroom: And we have…

108
00:16:40.660 --> 00:17:04.110
Boardroom: some of the strongest tenant protections in the state. If your rent-controlled unit changes property, you don't get evicted in the city of Berkeley. You have to have 10 specific just causes to get evicted. So I just want people to understand all of that. I want my colleagues to listen to what I'm saying about the use of scarce resources. We had

109
00:17:04.310 --> 00:17:11.350
Boardroom: the former CEO of the Tenderloin Neighborhood Development Corporation writing to us, telling us

110
00:17:11.530 --> 00:17:30.140
Boardroom: that the small sites is a very expensive investment. On the list that Mr. White has sent to us, the small site acquisition on Solano Avenue is asking for another $350,000 from the city to repair an elevator. We have to think about those long-term costs that we are going to be on the hook for.

111
00:17:31.690 --> 00:17:35.729
Boardroom: And whether we can actually take that on right now, and forego

112
00:17:36.030 --> 00:17:42.539
Boardroom: $15 million of state funding and federal funding that this… these monies could leverage.

113
00:17:43.140 --> 00:17:55.539

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Boardroom: So I want to close by noting that, again, this budget is balanced, and I have every expectation that my colleagues and I tonight will find a way to pass a balanced budget.

114
00:17:55.830 --> 00:18:01.910
Boardroom: And, I want to thank you all for your time and giving me the opportunity to present this proposal.

115
00:18:08.170 --> 00:18:15.830
Boardroom: Alright, thank you, Councilmember. Councilmember Barley, if you wouldn't… or, Blackbee, if you wouldn't mind removing it so I can put up…

116
00:18:16.060 --> 00:18:19.000
Boardroom: mine, that would be helpful. Thank you.

117
00:18:21.560 --> 00:18:22.800
Boardroom: Alright.

118
00:18:30.830 --> 00:18:36.460
Boardroom: Alright, good evening, everyone. Thank you all so much for being here, and there are 100 folks online as well.

119
00:18:36.610 --> 00:18:38.120
Boardroom: Hello to you.

120
00:18:41.210 --> 00:18:58.459
Boardroom: I'm sharing this, and I will go over it in a little bit more detail. For those of you that missed it, last week we had a City Council meeting where we discussed the budget. We had presented the, proposal from the City Manager, as well as the CIP. Sorry? Oh, thank you.

121
00:18:59.040 --> 00:19:02.709
Boardroom: Those are my notes. Give me a second.

122
00:19:03.770 --> 00:19:08.040
Boardroom: Let me… Make sure…

123
00:19:13.860 --> 00:19:14.630
Boardroom: Okay.

124
00:19:15.350 --> 00:19:20.420

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Boardroom: Alright, we presented the CIP, and I presented my budget last week.

125
00:19:20.610 --> 00:19:27.390
Boardroom: I want to reiterate again exactly what Councilmember Keserwani said, that we're in a $30 million structural deficit.

126
00:19:27.910 --> 00:19:45.969
Boardroom: for the next 2 years. And our revenues really are just not keeping paces with our expenses. We've been kicking the can down the road, and we've really reached a dead end here. We know that we need to make some hard decisions. And besides our deficit, something that I want to make sure folks really understand that's very important.

127
00:19:46.110 --> 00:19:59.350
Boardroom: is that there is significant uncertainty of this November's election. Not only do we have both an infrastructure bond and a sales tax on the ballot this November locally, but there's a measure on the statewide ballot

128
00:19:59.380 --> 00:20:10.099
Boardroom: that could require a two-thirds vote for local special taxes, and also prohibit charter cities like Berkeley from collecting transfer taxes.

129
00:20:10.190 --> 00:20:15.739
Boardroom: So keep in mind that if this ballot measure gets passed in November.

130
00:20:16.690 --> 00:20:29.400
Boardroom: we would lose an estimated $35 million in annual revenue on top of our existing structural deficit of $30 million. So we are in an incredibly dire situation.

131
00:20:29.900 --> 00:20:48.709
Boardroom: And although there are efforts right now from the governor's office to remove this from the ballot, it's been up and down, and there's only two more days to figure out if that could change. So again, we could end up having twice as much of money

132
00:20:48.870 --> 00:21:02.840
Boardroom: of loss this November. And so, my budget is based on the fact that we need to make hard decisions, and make decisions based on knowing that we have more issues coming. Millions of dollars worth.

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133
00:21:07.180 --> 00:21:29.029
Boardroom: For these reasons, we're being responsible in our recommendations with the goal of coming back early 2027 to do a mid-year review and be able to fully project how many positions and services we can bring back into the budget. It's my belief that we can't make these decisions now without knowing what's going to happen in November, that we really need to wait to understand our financial situation in a better way.

134
00:21:30.040 --> 00:21:38.380
Boardroom: We know that HR is doing everything they can to offer positions to people whose jobs are being eliminated, and again, I really want to thank our HR Director, Janelle.

135
00:21:38.660 --> 00:21:52.870
Boardroom: I can confirm, also, so folks understand, because I know that fire positions are a big part of what we're talking about this evening, that there are 3 vacant fire positions, 3 paramedics, and 4 paramedic supervisors.

136
00:21:53.010 --> 00:21:57.300
Boardroom: As well as other positions that are currently in the budget that can be filled

137
00:21:57.680 --> 00:22:03.279
Boardroom: With the additional revenue, we can hopefully bring back remaining positions that we're talking about tonight.

138
00:22:04.190 --> 00:22:09.879
Boardroom: I presented my recommendations last week, and today I'm presenting a modestly updated version of that.

139
00:22:10.190 --> 00:22:18.320
Boardroom: Taking a look at Councilmember Kesarwani and Taplin and Blackaby's recommendations,

140
00:22:18.850 --> 00:22:22.000
Boardroom: I will show you some of the changes that we're looking at.

141
00:22:23.160 --> 00:22:38.049
Boardroom: One is to allocate increased ambulance fees to cover $238,232 for FY27 for the… No, no, I'll move it. Yeah, for the one full-time fire inspector position.

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142
00:22:38.270 --> 00:22:48.359
Boardroom: And to allocate the D6 office surplus funds of $50,000 for FY27 and $25,000 for FY28 for the Euclid Garbage Corral design.

143
00:22:49.360 --> 00:22:54.969
Boardroom: Confirming also that the small sites allocation of $3.8 million is for FY27

144
00:22:55.110 --> 00:23:05.439
Boardroom: And that if that money is not applied for in FY27, that any unallocated funds at the end of the fiscal year would return to the general pot of the Housing Trust Fund.

145
00:23:06.200 --> 00:23:21.419
Boardroom: And then also, return for a mid-year budget review in early 2027, which is when we usually get our numbers for AA01, to assess revenue projections and make informed decisions on positions to be included in the FY28 budget.

146
00:23:21.440 --> 00:23:35.519
Boardroom: You'll notice when I walk through it, or I'll show you, I'll scroll through it, that we have not recommended any positions for FY28, and that's specifically because we don't know what our financial situation will look like until after November.

147
00:23:35.590 --> 00:23:44.559
Boardroom: And to me, it's important that we make fiscally cautious decisions right now, while we have so much uncertainty.

148
00:23:45.770 --> 00:23:55.200
Boardroom: And, the assessment will include any revenue impacts resulting from local sales tax measure, bond measure, and other local, state, or federal policies that have changed.

149
00:23:55.520 --> 00:23:57.840
Boardroom: So I'm gonna scroll through that.

150
00:24:03.260 --> 00:24:04.210
Boardroom: Okay.

151
00:24:05.880 --> 00:24:13.060
Boardroom: So you can see at the top here, all of these are funds that are special fund allocations, these are not general funds.

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152
00:24:13.170 --> 00:24:25.010
Boardroom: This is funds for… the, downtown Berkeley revitalization projects, including Oxford for All, Car Free Telegraph, Small sites.

153
00:24:25.140 --> 00:24:27.430
Boardroom: Sacred Rest, Village of Love.

154
00:24:27.710 --> 00:24:43.910
Boardroom: And then general fund transfers, including the pitch project from Councilmember Humbert, with funds from his office, and then the general fund expenses that I was talking about earlier, including the one Office of Economic Development full-time position.

155
00:24:45.050 --> 00:24:48.860
Boardroom: Funding for Solano Stroll, Live Free.

156
00:24:49.240 --> 00:25:03.369
Boardroom: Dba outreach worker, $38,000 of that. And then, as I mentioned earlier, these were added, the fire inspector position of $238,232, and the Euclid Street Garbage Corral design.

157
00:25:03.700 --> 00:25:22.060
Boardroom: And the revenue fund transfers that we would be looking at to fund those positions and projects include salary savings from my office, $160,000, CAO non-personnel, CAO salary, that's the city attorney's office, sorry, salary savings, a VTO,

158
00:25:22.490 --> 00:25:24.359
Boardroom: City Council Catering.

159
00:25:24.910 --> 00:25:26.950
Boardroom: Cannabis settlement funding.

160
00:25:27.300 --> 00:25:35.580
Boardroom: Increased annual ambulance transport revenue, as I mentioned, which would fund the fire inspector position, and the Euclid Street garbage Corral design.

161
00:25:37.830 --> 00:25:45.070
Boardroom: Okay. Additionally… In regards to the CIP,

162

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00:25:45.140 --> 00:25:50.740
Boardroom: Again, I know that that presentation was done at the last meeting, so folks have not been able to see that.

163
00:25:50.740 --> 00:26:13.450
Boardroom: But I really want to thank the work that Public Works, Parks, IT, all city staff, really, because our finance department, I know, is involved as well. So thank you so much for all the work you did on the CIP plan, and we're interested in ensuring that items that were identified for Measure FF funding are, in fact, eligible, and so for that reason, we'd like to move these four items to

164
00:26:13.450 --> 00:26:28.480
Boardroom: unfunded and pending, pending further review by staff, and the Safe Streets Oversight Committee, which was the committee that was started, with Measure FF, and this is the Streets Measure FF, not the fire one.

165
00:26:28.960 --> 00:26:31.380
Boardroom: Yeah, it's okay, I didn't put it on.

166
00:26:31.750 --> 00:26:49.900
Boardroom: Okay, so that… so the different, different pieces of the CIP that would move into unfunded and pending further review would be the Citywide Traffic Signal Master Plan, which is on page 220 of the PDF, the Transportation Design Guideline Study, which is on page 224,

167
00:26:50.080 --> 00:26:59.769
Boardroom: Transportation Nexus Study, which is on page 225, and the Vision Zero Plan Phased Implementation Roadmap, which is on page 225.

168
00:27:02.290 --> 00:27:04.749
Boardroom: Yes. Councilmember Humbert.

169
00:27:04.920 --> 00:27:09.960
Boardroom: Yes, for purposes of discussion, I'd like to move the mayor's, budget. Second.

170
00:27:12.350 --> 00:27:13.560
Boardroom: Thank you.

171
00:27:13.810 --> 00:27:22.039
Boardroom: Are there any questions on any of the budgets, the proposals, the CIP from Council?

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172
00:27:26.920 --> 00:27:28.870
Boardroom: Oh, yes. Councilmember Taplin.

173
00:27:37.570 --> 00:27:39.180
Boardroom: Councilmember Taplin, are you speaking?

174
00:27:39.180 --> 00:27:40.010
Terry Taplin: Very hello.

175
00:27:40.010 --> 00:27:41.389
Boardroom: Oh, yeah, we can hear you now.

176
00:27:41.580 --> 00:27:43.360
Terry Taplin: Thank you, and good evening.

177
00:27:43.570 --> 00:27:48.010
Terry Taplin: Is there a way to… Compare what each…

178
00:27:48.980 --> 00:27:53.039
Terry Taplin: Is proposing with respect to the fire department positions.

179
00:27:57.720 --> 00:28:05.699
Boardroom: Yeah, so we have added onto our budget funding for the fire inspector position, just.

180
00:28:05.700 --> 00:28:06.210
Terry Taplin: FYG.

181
00:28:06.210 --> 00:28:07.470
Boardroom: 27.

182
00:28:08.340 --> 00:28:23.599
Boardroom: And that, again, was because we wanted to make sure we understood what our financial situation was going to be after November, so that we would be able to make decisions about other positions as well, not just FY28, but all of these positions that we're talking about.

183
00:28:27.060 --> 00:28:28.759
Terry Taplin: Yes, thank you, and the other…

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184
00:28:35.670 --> 00:28:39.159
Boardroom: Apologies, Councilmember Taplin, I didn't know you were referring to…

185
00:28:39.580 --> 00:28:51.149
Boardroom: this proposal… so… so the proposal that… that we've put forward, it funds 5 firefighters, 3 paramedics, and 1 fire inspector.

186
00:28:51.260 --> 00:29:05.900
Boardroom: And I do want to say, you know, to what the mayor is talking about as it relates to fiscal uncertainty, I am also considering that. I have never been fiscally irresponsible in my time on the Council.

187
00:29:06.030 --> 00:29:09.030
Boardroom: And I am aware of the transfer tax

188
00:29:09.600 --> 00:29:24.119
Boardroom: uncertainty that is out there. You know, there's this possible ballot measure, there was some movement in Sacramento for a possible deal, it's unclear if the deal is going to be accepted or not. So I am aware of that multi-million dollar risk.

189
00:29:24.550 --> 00:29:28.220
Boardroom: I'm also aware of other revenue sources.

190
00:29:28.360 --> 00:29:31.519
Boardroom: So I'm taking all of that in totality.

191
00:29:31.850 --> 00:29:40.320
Boardroom: when I'm proposing this, and I think it is a reasonable approach to do this now, and not wait until November.

192
00:29:40.460 --> 00:29:43.540
Boardroom: Thank you. Questions, Councilmember Blackaby?

193
00:29:44.200 --> 00:29:46.959
Boardroom: Yeah, question on the mayor's proposal,

194
00:29:47.620 --> 00:30:00.960
Boardroom: One thing that we've considered in, the Kesawani-Taplin-Blackby proposal on the fire side is that one way or the other, these services need to be provided. Citizens expect

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195
00:30:01.080 --> 00:30:06.889
Boardroom: fire safety, they deserve fire safety. And whether we do it through full-time staff.

196
00:30:07.190 --> 00:30:13.209
Boardroom: Or we do it through overtime of people who are currently, sworn and serving.

197
00:30:13.400 --> 00:30:17.549
Boardroom: That time, that service will be provided.

198
00:30:17.850 --> 00:30:37.749
Boardroom: I think it's a more cost… so, have you considered what happens to overtime if we don't fund these positions? Yes, and actually, I think that, recently, Mr. David White has had given an answer about that as well, looking at, positions versus overtime, so perhaps you can address that.

199
00:30:38.970 --> 00:30:50.760
Boardroom: Sure, happy to be City Manager. So, I would say, theoretically, if you look at, what's proposed, you could argue that there's gonna be a reduction in overtime. I think, pragmatically.

200
00:30:50.760 --> 00:31:04.010
Boardroom: we wouldn't recommend any reductions in overtime, because when we've observed the fire department's overtime over the past few years, for various reasons, no accusations to be offered. They've been going over their allocated overtime budget, and we see that trend continuing, so…

201
00:31:04.040 --> 00:31:11.249
Boardroom: Hypothetically, you could do it, but I think pragmatically, we wouldn't recommend it, because they're going to need what they're allocated, going into the next two fiscal years.

202
00:31:11.440 --> 00:31:17.339
Boardroom: I guess my question is a topic we've kind of talked about with respect to police as well as fire, which is…

203
00:31:17.390 --> 00:31:31.639
Boardroom: At the end of the day, we either have people in the sworn positions, doing the job and potentially less overtime, or we have fewer

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people in sworn positions and potentially more overtime, if there's some amount of service that needs to be provided.

204
00:31:31.740 --> 00:31:39.019
Boardroom: So I guess my point of view on this is, from the perspective of health and safety of people in those jobs.

205
00:31:39.230 --> 00:31:43.910
Boardroom: It's sort of more prudent to have people in the full-time roles.

206
00:31:44.060 --> 00:32:02.969
Boardroom: then have less people, and then rely on the overtime, where people are working extra shifts and putting themselves in… you know, so I guess that's my consideration, is I don't know if this proposal is fully considering what happens if we don't fund these positions, in terms of the overtime piece, not to mention the healthcare costs, mental health care costs, and that kind of thing. And have we thought about that?

207
00:32:06.440 --> 00:32:12.500
Boardroom: I mean, anyway, is there some, like, if we have fewer people in the full-time roles, we rely more on overtime?

208
00:32:12.670 --> 00:32:19.039
Boardroom: Right, so with the fire department proposals that Councilmember Kesarwani's proposed.

209
00:32:19.120 --> 00:32:26.140
Boardroom: the firefight… so there's two differences. The firefighters are filling in overtime shifts so that, right, if they're not

210
00:32:26.200 --> 00:32:39.909
Boardroom: If they don't have those positions, someone's gonna have to cover the overtime when it occurs. The paramedic positions are a little bit different because, they're not assigned to filling overtime roles, they're actually assigned to pieces of equipment.

211
00:32:39.980 --> 00:32:52.590
Boardroom: But again, we wouldn't, in terms of what the department needs for overtime, they need everything that they're allocated, so there'd be no change in that, regardless of how this shakes out. Okay, alright.

212
00:32:52.640 --> 00:33:04.610

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Boardroom: Keep in mind that these positions that you're looking at have already been frozen for FY26, so it's not that we're, you know, getting rid of more bodies.

213
00:33:04.700 --> 00:33:13.140
Boardroom: So, as the Deputy City Manager said, the overtime would be the same. So, my proposal does consider that.

214
00:33:14.460 --> 00:33:19.460
Boardroom: Okay, we'll come back to, during the comment period, but thank you. Okay. Are there other questions?

215
00:33:20.170 --> 00:33:24.169
Boardroom: Okay, so let's move on to public comment then.

216
00:33:25.120 --> 00:33:29.449
Boardroom: If you have public comment on any of these pieces.

217
00:33:29.690 --> 00:33:43.219
Boardroom: Mayor, I apologize. Before we do public comment, I just wanted to point out that there is, revised material, from the City Manager for the City Council's consideration, and if the…

218
00:33:43.240 --> 00:33:52.770
Boardroom: I also would like to move forward with a motion to accept that. So, if we could make, yeah, if we could amend the motion to accept the sub 3 from the city staff.

219
00:33:53.250 --> 00:33:53.940
Terry Taplin: Tuck in.

220
00:33:54.370 --> 00:34:13.549
Boardroom: So, do we need to make a motion to amend, or just a friendly amendment of sufficient? Look, in order to consider it and fold it into the actual action of the Council, we do need to vote to accept it for consideration. We have a motion from Vice Mayor Trey Gubb and a second from Councilmember Taplin, so… go ahead.

221
00:34:14.170 --> 00:34:22.580
Boardroom: Yeah. Okay. On the motion to accept the revised material, Councilmember Kezzarwani? Yes. Taplin?

222
00:34:22.810 --> 00:34:23.440

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Terry Taplin: Bye.

223
00:34:23.639 --> 00:34:24.659
Boardroom: Bartlett?

224
00:34:24.659 --> 00:34:25.379
Ben Bartlett: Yes.

225
00:34:25.850 --> 00:34:31.930
Boardroom: Trega? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby? Yes. Munapara? Yes.

226
00:34:32.080 --> 00:34:35.110
Boardroom: Humbert? Yes. Amir Ishii? Yes.

227
00:34:35.560 --> 00:34:45.059
Boardroom: It's accepted for consideration, and if the maker and seconder of the, motion would like to include that in their motion, that… they may do so.

228
00:34:47.130 --> 00:34:57.550
Boardroom: Yeah. They're both okay with including that in their motion, so… Okay, it's acceptable to the mover and seconder. Thank you very much. Okay, alright, we'll take public comment. Thank you so much. Come on up.

229
00:34:57.880 --> 00:35:11.500
Boardroom: Oh, and so, folks, just for those of you who are newer to public comment, so when you come up, if you are taking minutes from someone else, if you could just organize that beforehand and let us know so we can put the right amount of time on the clock. Okay, go ahead.

230
00:35:11.680 --> 00:35:15.099
Boardroom: I have 3 colleagues willing to cede time. May I have 4 minutes?

231
00:35:17.210 --> 00:35:28.449
Boardroom: Thank you for this opportunity to comment. I'm Thomas Gregory, I'm the chapter of SEIU, SEIU CSU PTRLA, speaking on behalf of our more than 500 members.

232
00:35:28.520 --> 00:35:37.910
Boardroom: Under management's proposed budget, as amended by the Mayor's June 17th amendments, our chapter is facing six layoffs, as well as the elimination of many more vacancies.

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233
00:35:37.910 --> 00:35:55.969
Boardroom: These 6 folks to be laid off would cost the city less than $1.2 million per fiscal year, and that's fully loaded with benefits, pensions, and everything. And our chapter wants the city to fund these 6 jobs for one year through fiscal year 27, using one-time money if needed.

234
00:35:56.140 --> 00:36:21.130
Boardroom: Our chapter understands and agrees that the city must stop relying on one-time monies to balance its budget year after year. But we don't need to end our addiction cold turkey in fiscal year 27. And significantly, we aren't ending our addiction cold turkey in fiscal year 27. Management's proposed budget, with amendments, is using $9.4 million in one-time money to fund 33 positions, mostly in fire and police, and a couple in HHCS.

235
00:36:21.450 --> 00:36:32.519
Boardroom: This money is being used to cover the 33 jobs through fiscal year 27, with the hope that the sales tax will pass in November, and that the resulting revenue will pay for those 33 jobs beginning in fiscal year 28.

236
00:36:32.650 --> 00:36:57.639
Boardroom: Of the 33 jobs that would be saved through fiscal year 27 with this $9.4 million, 18 are currently filled, and 15 are currently vacant. Our chapter feels that the city should use money to fund a filled position before it uses such money to fund a vacancy. Unlike staff, vacancies cannot achieve any positive outcomes for constituents, and unlike staff, vacancies don't have mortgages to pay or family expenses to cover.

237
00:36:58.220 --> 00:37:23.049
Boardroom: Of the 15 vacancies management's budget proposes to save using one-time money in fiscal year 27, the City could instead save only 12 of those vacancies, rather than all 15, and there would still be enough in that $9.4 million pot to prevent our chapter's layoffs, all 6 of them for a year. Alternatively, the City could support our chapter by adding a modest amount to that $9.4 million pot, namely $1.1 million.

238
00:37:23.240 --> 00:37:47.230
Boardroom: I'm not sure where that, I'm not sure where the $2 million in Urswell flock money went, but that would be more than enough to do the trick. Also, based on the last 5 years, we're expecting, a fund balance of about $30 million to roll over from the current fiscal year, and there's a similar amount in the, in the city's, stability reserve that's for a rainy day, and we would say that laying off workers is a rainy day.

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239
00:37:47.230 --> 00:37:50.640
Boardroom: Both for the workers, and for the city, and for our constituents.

240
00:37:50.640 --> 00:37:56.910
Boardroom: You might, folks might ask, what's the point of buying one year of a reprieve for our members facing layoff?

241
00:37:56.910 --> 00:38:21.879
Boardroom: It just seems to be kicking a part of the problem down the road, and perhaps that's true, but the community would get served well for another year. Some staff members would be able to retain their livelihood for another year, and that's all good. But more importantly, that extra year would help the city, ensure that no staff are shown the door due to a flawed austerity plan. And our chapter believes that the current plan is flawed, and that city-city leadership

242
00:38:21.880 --> 00:38:24.620
Boardroom: It needs another year to get the plan right.

243
00:38:24.620 --> 00:38:38.539
Boardroom: Here are some examples of how the current austerity plan is flawed. We're losing, behavioral health clinicians and community health workers that the city, that the community expects, that provide services the community expects and deserves.

244
00:38:38.540 --> 00:39:03.359
Boardroom: We are eliminating positions with job duties that generate revenue, like grant writing and debt collection. And another example is the loss of the mobile crisis unit will just force police to provide and field those calls that previously would have gone to the mobile crisis unit, which might end up costing the money, costing the city money rather than saving the city money. As a 612 Daily Cal article quotes.

245
00:39:03.360 --> 00:39:17.670
Boardroom: a department director is saying that that transfer to the police is an unintended consequences. Our chapter is worried about that the ramifications of this austerity plan are not fully known and well thought out, and we need to

246
00:39:17.740 --> 00:39:20.960
Boardroom: Do it again. Thank you. Thank you.

247
00:39:25.400 --> 00:39:33.160

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Boardroom: Hi, I'm Nakia, but I will need 2 minutes because my coworker will be receding her time to me. Okay.

248
00:39:34.190 --> 00:39:45.980
Boardroom: So, good evening, Mayor and Council Members. My name is Nakia Harris, and I'm a Community Health Worker Specialist here, for the City of Berkeley with Black Infant Health, and a proud member of SEIU 1021.

249
00:39:46.350 --> 00:39:55.970
Boardroom: I understand that the city is facing, difficult budget decisions, but I am asking you to reconsider the proposed layoffs that would eliminate positions like mine.

250
00:39:56.160 --> 00:40:02.560
Boardroom: I may have less seniority than some of my colleagues, but the families I serve do not see me as a number on a budget spreadsheet.

251
00:40:02.590 --> 00:40:27.509
Boardroom: They see me as someone they can call when they are struggling, overwhelmed, isolated, or in need of support. Every day, I work directly with pregnant and parenting women, mothers, and help them navigate healthcare systems, access resources, address barriers to health births, and build the support networks they need to thrive. I facilitate support groups, conduct outreach, connect family to services, and help mothers who often feel unseen and unheard.

252
00:40:28.270 --> 00:40:40.140
Boardroom: When a mother is struggling with housing, food insecurities, stress, mental health challenges, or simply needs someone to listen, community health workers are often the first people they turn to.

253
00:40:40.440 --> 00:40:50.420
Boardroom: The work we do through Berkeley Black Infant Health is not just a program, it is a part of Berkeley's commitment to addressing racial disparities in maternal and infant health outcomes.

254
00:40:50.420 --> 00:41:04.389
Boardroom: Eliminating community health worker positions means fewer families receiving support, fewer mothers connected to resources, fewer opportunities for prevention, and less capacity to serve those who need us most.

255
00:41:04.410 --> 00:41:07.470
Boardroom: The cost of losing these services will be felt

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256
00:41:07.470 --> 00:41:28.459
Boardroom: Long after this budget cycle ends. I ask that you look at alternatives, including the vacancy savings that has already been identified, and preserve these critical public health positions with more thorough review of the impacts that can be conducted. Please invest in the people who are investing in Berkeley families every day. Thank you for your time and your consideration.

257
00:41:28.550 --> 00:41:29.880
Boardroom: Thank you.

258
00:41:39.350 --> 00:41:42.620
Boardroom: Charlie Cole, they, them, District 2.

259
00:41:42.760 --> 00:42:05.729
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor Ishii, City Council, community members. As a full-time graduate student with multiple part-time jobs and community commitments, time is not a luxury, and Audre Lorde reminds neither is poetry. I have one minute to make a comment on something that stretches far beyond the capacity of 60 seconds. I sat draft and comment for the City Council's budget plan in rebuttal for an 11th hour pool to eviscerate small sites' affordable housing.

260
00:42:05.730 --> 00:42:23.319
Boardroom: Funding I want to make clear… funding. I want to make clear, pitting firefighters against the working class and the working class against the unhoused is class warfare. U1 Small Sites is Grassroots people power project. The federal government couldn't imagine this because they're too busy with AI and genocide.

261
00:42:23.470 --> 00:42:40.699
Boardroom: U1 small sites sweepingly voted for a vision within Berkeley City limits a legacy rooted in equity. Is there… this is where our tax dollars are meant to go, so don't go overreaching into the people's pockets. Listen to the recommended Housing Commission, follow the Mayor's intuition, fund U1 small sites.

262
00:42:41.580 --> 00:42:42.690
Boardroom: Thank you.

263
00:42:45.360 --> 00:43:04.459
Boardroom: Hi, good evening, Council. My name is Bryce Miller. I am a former president of Telegraph for People, and I study city planning at UC Berkeley. First, I just want to thank the Mayor and everyone who worked on the mayor's budget proposal. I think it did a really good job

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balancing the budget, and I asked the entire Council to back the Mayor's budget proposal.

264
00:43:04.530 --> 00:43:17.899
Boardroom: Specifically because of the car-free Telegraph funding allocation. Telegraph has the second highest pedestrian traffic in the East Bay. It's also my favorite street to walk on. I walk on it multiple times per day.

265
00:43:18.290 --> 00:43:35.270
Boardroom: Pedestrians vastly outnumber cars on the road, if you just take a look, but cars get most of the right-of-way space. From a public safety perspective, every month, pedestrians and cyclists are injured or killed by cars on Telegraph and in Southside.

266
00:43:35.270 --> 00:43:47.099
Boardroom: So making Telegraph a car-free street is the right thing to do for public safety. Cars are dangerous, inefficient, and polluting, so please support the mayor's recommendation. Thank you for your time. Thanks.

267
00:43:51.350 --> 00:43:54.819
Boardroom: I also have a minute, given to me by Betsy Morris.

268
00:43:55.880 --> 00:43:56.910
Boardroom: Got it.

269
00:43:56.940 --> 00:44:21.640
Boardroom: Good evening. My name is Leah Simon Weisberg. As many of you know, I have spent the last 25 years, trying to address the housing affordability crisis. What the proposal includes, particularly around small sites, is extremely uninformed. There is a reason that you have none of the affordable housing. The new production people

270
00:44:21.640 --> 00:44:23.189
Boardroom: here are supporting it.

271
00:44:23.190 --> 00:44:40.469
Boardroom: You also, as much as I love Randy Shaw, he's a colleague of mine, he is a producer of affordable housing. So the fact that he wants you to give money to him, doesn't really mean that that justifies it. As I've said many, many, many times.

272
00:44:40.470 --> 00:44:47.180

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Boardroom: When you ask tenants where they would prefer to live in Berkeley, they will always say the land trusts.

273
00:44:47.180 --> 00:45:00.599
Boardroom: I have never had someone come up to me and say, I can't wait till RCD's next project, I can't wait to live there. And part of the problem is, is that the land trusts provide an enormous amount of democracy and respect.

274
00:45:00.670 --> 00:45:13.549
Boardroom: and tenants feel seen, and they have good management because they participate in that. That is why there's almost nobody here from the City of Berkeley who lives here. The only residents that are here

275
00:45:13.550 --> 00:45:21.839
Boardroom: Are people fighting for the small sites? Because we have neighbors who live there, we have teachers who've taught our children, who are now retired, who live in them.

276
00:45:21.840 --> 00:45:35.229
Boardroom: community of Berkeley lives there. Please do not think that you are protecting tenants, or… because the tenants are saying, fund this. Please do not say that you are doing something around,

277
00:45:35.430 --> 00:45:41.739
Boardroom: Affordable housing, because people… these products also leverage money.

278
00:45:41.930 --> 00:45:59.249
Boardroom: and small sites, there's almost no other funding for it. Where production knew there's lots of sources for it. It makes a huge difference. That's why so many of your residents, and I'm in District 2, why we are here fighting for it. Thank you.

279
00:46:05.660 --> 00:46:08.970
Boardroom: I have two other, give me a minute.

280
00:46:11.580 --> 00:46:19.020
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor Ishii and City Council. My name is Isabel Gaston, and I live in District 6.

281
00:46:19.760 --> 00:46:28.989
Boardroom: I strongly support preserving the firefighter and paramedic positions that are under consideration for elimination.

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282
00:46:29.740 --> 00:46:39.369
Boardroom: There are few responsibilities more fundamental to city government than protecting the lives and safety of its residents.

283
00:46:40.140 --> 00:46:52.649
Boardroom: Firefighters and paramedics are the people we depend on during the most critical moments of our lives. When a home is on fire, a family member suffers a heart attack, a major bike collision occurs.

284
00:46:52.650 --> 00:47:02.929
Boardroom: A wildfire, an earthquake. In those moments, every second matters. The speed and effectiveness of Berkeley's emergency

285
00:47:03.000 --> 00:47:06.980
Boardroom: Response can mean the difference between life and death.

286
00:47:07.260 --> 00:47:12.770
Boardroom: I know this personally because I had such an experience several years ago.

287
00:47:13.240 --> 00:47:17.700
Boardroom: These positions are not discretionary services.

288
00:47:17.990 --> 00:47:24.400
Boardroom: Cutting 9 positions will inevitably place greater strain on remaining personnel.

289
00:47:24.740 --> 00:47:33.299
Boardroom: The impacts would be felt across every single council district, and by residents of all ages.

290
00:47:33.450 --> 00:47:39.480
Boardroom: Including seniors, People with disabilities, and those experiencing homelessness.

291
00:47:39.770 --> 00:47:44.210
Boardroom: We are a densely populated… city.

292
00:47:44.860 --> 00:47:59.020

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Boardroom: Vulnerable to earthquakes and wildfires, and frequent fires in homeless encampments, unfortunately. Maintaining a fully staffed, highly trained emergency response system is not a luxury.

293
00:47:59.090 --> 00:48:10.290
Boardroom: We are fortunate to have a fire department that is widely respected for its professionalism, expertise, and commitment to serving the community.

294
00:48:10.480 --> 00:48:17.399
Boardroom: BFD has earned a reputation as among the finest emergency responders

295
00:48:17.710 --> 00:48:28.790
Boardroom: in the state of California. Their dedication saves lives every day, often under extraordinarily difficult circumstances.

296
00:48:28.830 --> 00:48:41.250
Boardroom: With a budget of close to $800 million, I think the city can find $1.7 million to fund these positions, and that's exactly what Rashi, Terry, and Brent's proposal does.

297
00:48:41.640 --> 00:48:44.339
Boardroom: I urge the Council to vote tonight.

298
00:48:44.610 --> 00:48:47.220
Boardroom: For preserving these nine positions.

299
00:48:47.340 --> 00:48:52.469
Boardroom: We cannot afford to take this exceptional service for granted.

300
00:48:52.620 --> 00:48:54.689
Boardroom: Thank you.

301
00:48:55.260 --> 00:48:56.420
Boardroom: Thank you.

302
00:49:01.710 --> 00:49:04.710
Boardroom: Hi, I think I have an extra minute over here.

303
00:49:05.530 --> 00:49:14.249

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Boardroom: Yep. Okay, hi, I'm Lisa Bullwinkle. I am from District 3. I am on the Art Commission, but tonight I'm speaking as a resident.

304
00:49:14.670 --> 00:49:28.240
Boardroom: Departments were all asked to cut their budgets by 10%, and I would like you to consider how much you are asking Civic Arts to cut theirs, especially knowing that the arts are an income generator to the city.

305
00:49:28.240 --> 00:49:38.730
Boardroom: Current budget cuts to civic arts include eliminating the leadership position and the reassignment of remaining staff responsibilities, which would limit the scope of arts programming.

306
00:49:38.730 --> 00:49:50.510
Boardroom: This totals a loss of $288,000, more than 20% of the civic Arts budget. This should be more than enough to cover the 10% originally required of all departments.

307
00:49:50.930 --> 00:49:59.059
Boardroom: However, Civic Arts is being asked to cut their budget even further by reducing the grant program another 10%.

308
00:49:59.220 --> 00:50:05.559
Boardroom: Organizational grants are currently in the second year of a two-year cycle. This is bad timing.

309
00:50:05.960 --> 00:50:15.009
Boardroom: Festival grants have already taken a hit of more than $40,000 reduction during the last cycle from their prior level of $200,000.

310
00:50:15.480 --> 00:50:24.450
Boardroom: If we do need to take any additional funding cuts, it would be preferable to cut the large pass-through funds that the Council issues

311
00:50:24.450 --> 00:50:40.140
Boardroom: without any oversight of the Art Commission. In future, we're considering asking that all pass-through funds, which are one-time fixes, should be allotted to the grants program to be distributed in a transparent and equitable manner.

312
00:50:40.290 --> 00:50:43.130
Boardroom: Cutting 50% of these funds now.

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313
00:50:43.290 --> 00:50:57.330
Boardroom: from the affected organizations that are budgeted to receive them would give them time to adjust their budgets until the funds are correctly applied for and distributed through the grants program. Help us bring joy back into this community.

314
00:50:57.830 --> 00:51:02.239
Boardroom: Especially during these dark times. Thank you. Thank you.

315
00:51:09.300 --> 00:51:19.950
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor and Council. My name is Claire Greensfelder. I'm a homeowner in District 6, a member of the Berkeley Cultural Trust, and Executive Director of the California Institute for Community Art and Nature.

316
00:51:19.980 --> 00:51:36.620
Boardroom: Two points about the arts budget. One, the position that was, Jennifer Lovehorn, who had been our coordinator, director, it's set to be cut. We requested it be frozen, because there's a possibility in the future that there's funds to bring it back. If it's cut, it will be much harder.

317
00:51:36.620 --> 00:51:51.489
Boardroom: Second, as Lisa just referenced, the $83,000 cut to civic grants, approximately about 100 grants are made. That's about $830 per group. This is not a huge savings for the city, but it's devastating to the groups that receive the money.

318
00:51:51.730 --> 00:52:04.910
Boardroom: When you think about the fact that $830, at least in our organization, provides $800 honorariums to artists, puts money directly in their pockets for participating in events, artists are struggling right now.

319
00:52:04.910 --> 00:52:15.599
Boardroom: And we don't want to mirror what is happening at the federal level with the NEA and the NEH cutting grants to programs such as ours. Thank you. Please consider restoring the $83,000. Thank you.

320
00:52:19.860 --> 00:52:23.589
Boardroom: I'll speak for 2 minutes, my John Butler.

321
00:52:24.450 --> 00:52:31.880

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Boardroom: Greeting, Councilmembers and Mayor Ishii. My name is Vinita Goyal. I'm a Berkeley resident and work for Full Spectrum Labs.

322
00:52:31.980 --> 00:52:50.419
Boardroom: We are building economic power and economic democracy for communities so that they can build the muscle to defend public… political democracy, especially in the current moment when our basic rights are being dismantled, as we are witnessing today precipitated with Councilmember Quesarani's proposal.

323
00:52:50.530 --> 00:52:57.549
Boardroom: When a city wins a voter-approved measure, it needs to deliver on the approved allocation items.

324
00:52:57.630 --> 00:53:14.030
Boardroom: to win voter trust and confidence, but to actually serve the community on the intended outcomes. The city has lost over a thousand unsubsidized affordable homes since 2020. Thousand more are at risk in the next 5 years.

325
00:53:14.030 --> 00:53:27.510
Boardroom: Without sufficient resources to fund permanent affordable housing, displacement in the city is and will be inevitable. Mayor Ishii's allocation of $2.5 million to the Small Sites Program

326
00:53:27.780 --> 00:53:32.589
Boardroom: In the upcoming budget is a crucial step in the right direction.

327
00:53:32.670 --> 00:53:45.679
Boardroom: The city's dollars will not only unlock regional and state dollars, but also private and philanthropic capital needed for the acquisition of buildings and protection of residents who remain at risk.

328
00:53:45.680 --> 00:53:59.159
Boardroom: We can't afford to conflate the city's preservation goals with those of production and protection. We need the city's political will to fund permanent, affordable housing now. Thank you for your consideration.

329
00:53:59.610 --> 00:54:01.180
Boardroom: Thank you.

330
00:54:05.980 --> 00:54:18.820

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Boardroom: Should only need about 3 or 4 minutes, and I think I have enough time to yield behind me. Oh, could you ask who's yielding? Oh, 3, you 3, okay. Madam Mayor, City Council, City Manager, my name is Steven Gilman.

331
00:54:18.820 --> 00:54:26.510
Boardroom: I'm the International Association of Firefighters 10th District Vice President. I represent 57,112 firefighters

332
00:54:26.510 --> 00:54:29.820
Boardroom: In the proud states of Hawaii, California, Arizona.

333
00:54:29.820 --> 00:54:35.009
Boardroom: New Mexico, the Mariana Islands, and today I'm here to talk about your firefighters.

334
00:54:35.040 --> 00:54:37.560
Boardroom: Firefighter standing in this room behind me.

335
00:54:38.740 --> 00:54:42.719
Boardroom: And today's more about a line item. Today's more about a budget.

336
00:54:43.120 --> 00:54:48.710
Boardroom: It's about whether a promise that the people of Berkeley had that was made by the City Council

337
00:54:49.250 --> 00:54:53.229
Boardroom: Because the citizens of this city Have already done the part.

338
00:54:53.400 --> 00:54:57.980
Boardroom: the heavy lifting. They passed two sales tax initiatives.

339
00:54:58.190 --> 00:55:00.680
Boardroom: Measure GG, Measure FF.

340
00:55:01.970 --> 00:55:04.430
Boardroom: They came back to the ballot twice.

341
00:55:04.530 --> 00:55:06.430
Boardroom: with 74%.

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342
00:55:06.690 --> 00:55:10.669
Boardroom: of a budget. The people of Berkeley reached into their own pocket.

343
00:55:11.530 --> 00:55:17.959
Boardroom: And they said, fire protection and public safety are a priority, and we'll pay for it ourselves.

344
00:55:18.740 --> 00:55:20.870
Boardroom: And they tax themselves in good faith.

345
00:55:21.650 --> 00:55:27.829
Boardroom: Because they believed that when they called 911, their firefighters, would be there.

346
00:55:28.130 --> 00:55:30.650
Boardroom: Because they trusted that this council

347
00:55:30.940 --> 00:55:33.890
Boardroom: Would match their commitment with action.

348
00:55:34.530 --> 00:55:36.499
Boardroom: And since their inception.

349
00:55:37.250 --> 00:55:45.870
Boardroom: Both Measure FF and GG, that investment has added up to over $100 million in dedicated public safety tax revenue.

350
00:55:46.150 --> 00:55:53.440
Boardroom: Over $100 million that the voters of this city sent here, not for consultants, Not for studies.

351
00:55:54.000 --> 00:55:56.869
Boardroom: Not to paper over a structural deficit.

352
00:55:57.310 --> 00:56:04.080
Boardroom: That this council let grow year after year, but for protection of their citizens on their worst day.

353
00:56:04.840 --> 00:56:10.889

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Boardroom: And for the men and women who respond day in and day out, They made a commitment.

354
00:56:11.390 --> 00:56:24.350
Boardroom: They said that this department has the highest self-funding of any other department by passing those sales tax measures. Between the sales tax measures, your ambulance revenue, the fire marshal revenue.

355
00:56:24.530 --> 00:56:28.089
Boardroom: It's about 42% of your fire department's entire budget.

356
00:56:28.380 --> 00:56:30.529
Boardroom: That is unheard of.

357
00:56:31.340 --> 00:56:38.720
Boardroom: I would guarantee you any city council, any city manager would be ecstatic to have that type of funding behind their fire department.

358
00:56:40.370 --> 00:56:42.729
Boardroom: And what I've heard today is promising.

359
00:56:43.840 --> 00:56:51.899
Boardroom: What I've heard today is that this Council has proposed 9 of the bodies that you were considering cutting. No station closure.

360
00:56:52.150 --> 00:56:58.129
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilwoman Cassarwani. If I have your name correct, I apologize for your proposal.

361
00:56:58.950 --> 00:57:05.179
Boardroom: And I want to be clear to the public. I just want to make sure, firefighters are not against affordable housing.

362
00:57:05.630 --> 00:57:08.500
Boardroom: Because I've heard a lot of groans about the proposed budget.

363
00:57:08.850 --> 00:57:16.540
Boardroom: But I will guarantee you this, everybody in this room, any citizen of Berkeley, That when they call 911,

364
00:57:16.990 --> 00:57:19.419
Boardroom: When they have a loved one who's in jeopardy.

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365
00:57:19.800 --> 00:57:21.939
Boardroom: When they have a child who is choking.

366
00:57:22.560 --> 00:57:37.699
Boardroom: When their house is burning, or their apartment is burning, and it could be the difference between losing one apartment, or displacing an entire apartment building in families, that they are gonna want a fully funded fire department.

367
00:57:38.980 --> 00:57:44.110
Boardroom: Fully funded. Something that they've done twice by passing those sale tax measures.

368
00:57:44.360 --> 00:57:46.030
Boardroom: So the right decision…

369
00:57:46.740 --> 00:57:54.680
Boardroom: for the people of Berkeley, for Local 1227, and they would be grateful for it, is for you to continue to fund these positions.

370
00:57:55.680 --> 00:57:58.640
Boardroom: And I'm gonna be honest with you about what comes next.

371
00:57:59.320 --> 00:58:07.839
Boardroom: Because a commitment made by this council in this chamber is only as good as the follow-through that comes after it.

372
00:58:08.130 --> 00:58:11.529
Boardroom: And when you were talking about cutting Engine 4,

373
00:58:11.830 --> 00:58:17.460
Boardroom: The one that you considered shutting down that engine? Who responded to 17 cardiac arrests?

374
00:58:17.650 --> 00:58:27.750
Boardroom: Sorry. I got more time? No, no, I'm sorry, your time is actually limited to 4 minutes, so you've had your 4 minutes. But someone else is welcome to finish where you left off. Go ahead.

375
00:58:35.570 --> 00:58:46.580

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Boardroom: Good evening, I'm John Bagler, and I've got, 4 additional members back there. So, you can only have 4 minutes total, so you'll have your 1 minute, and then… Yeah. Yes. Thank you so much.

376
00:58:46.680 --> 00:59:03.950
Boardroom: As DVP Gilman, stated, when you were looking at closing Station 4, this is a very busy fire station. This is a place that responded to multiple fires, multiple cardiac arrests, and multiple calls for assistance. Things are always gonna be hard, your budgets are always gonna be difficult.

377
00:59:03.950 --> 00:59:19.029
Boardroom: And with that, I'm going to go into my comments, because they actually echo a lot of what DVP Gilman said. And so, Madam Mayor, members of the City Council, I rise today to strongly suggest that the Council find another way to adopt a budget that does not include the discussed cuts to the fire department.

378
00:59:19.040 --> 00:59:37.840
Boardroom: I was here in 1991 on a fire engine for multiple days, and watched Berkeley and Oakland burn, and although it was early in my 36-year career, I never forgot it, nor have I ever seen fire behavior like that, and I've been on the biggest fires in California's history. That was before the last 30 years of worsening climate change, population growth.

379
00:59:37.840 --> 00:59:40.560
Boardroom: In addition to building into the wildland-urban interface.

380
00:59:40.600 --> 00:59:49.699
Boardroom: The firefighters support repaired streets. We need to rapidly respond our fire apparatus on those roads to come to your homes, and so we can do our jobs.

381
00:59:49.700 --> 01:00:01.109
Boardroom: We are for affordable housing, not only for workforce, but for the members of this community. And we are for safe shelters, and we are the ones that will be responding to help those in need at every one of those locations.

382
01:00:01.260 --> 01:00:15.559
Boardroom: As DVP Gilman said, this city and your council has gone to its voters multiple times, and the voters have let you know loud and clear just how much they value public safety. Some of the frozen or proposed cut positions were specifically called out in that ballot language.

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383
01:00:15.740 --> 01:00:24.399
Boardroom: My guess is that every single elected official here wishes they could have had 70% voter support when you guys went to the ballot.

384
01:00:24.980 --> 01:00:34.780
Boardroom: We all rely upon each other in times of emergency. Now your public is relying upon you to fulfill its primary job of local government, which is protecting its citizens.

385
01:00:34.940 --> 01:00:52.160
Boardroom: The mayor mentioned the Taxpayer Deception Act, which is being put forth by the Howard Jarvis taxpayers' groups. Do not govern from a place of fear. Trust that if, and that's a big if, it actually qualifies for the November ballot, that the voters in California will defeat it handedly, knowing the damage it proposes.

386
01:00:52.160 --> 01:01:01.049
Boardroom: This is a fight that unifies us all. Unions, the League of Cities, and every municipality in California. Do not use it conveniently as a threat to justify any cuts.

387
01:01:01.120 --> 01:01:18.430
Boardroom: These voters who will defeat it are the same folks who put you into office. Put your faith into them like they have into you. This is not just a budget or a spreadsheet. It's not a math problem or a political exercise. This is a discussion about life safety and the ability for these firefighters to save lives and property.

388
01:01:18.430 --> 01:01:29.920
Boardroom: Give them what they need to do their job. It's a critically important job at that. Not just now, but in the future. Thank you for your consideration, and please do the right thing and fund all of the fire department positions. Thank you.

389
01:01:31.430 --> 01:01:32.530
Boardroom: Thank you.

390
01:01:37.880 --> 01:01:45.289
Boardroom: Can I have everyone who… oh, are you all not speaking? Oh, okay. Who… who's next?

391
01:01:48.020 --> 01:01:49.190
Boardroom: Thank you.

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392
01:01:55.370 --> 01:01:56.519
Boardroom: Who's speaking?

393
01:01:59.260 --> 01:02:03.950
Boardroom: Well, first of all, Setting one group against another.

394
01:02:04.160 --> 01:02:07.460
Boardroom: Like this is just really low.

395
01:02:07.680 --> 01:02:08.630
Boardroom: Okay.

396
01:02:12.140 --> 01:02:18.310
Boardroom: People who are struggling to stay in their homes, people in Berkeley who live here.

397
01:02:18.420 --> 01:02:20.570
Boardroom: We're struggling to stay in their homes.

398
01:02:21.310 --> 01:02:24.000
Boardroom: Should not be set against.

399
01:02:24.980 --> 01:02:26.759
Boardroom: city workers.

400
01:02:29.730 --> 01:02:35.430
Boardroom: Also, since the subject has been already Brought up by someone else.

401
01:02:36.170 --> 01:02:38.850
Boardroom: I'd like to talk a little bit about taxation.

402
01:02:39.220 --> 01:02:43.919
Boardroom: You keep passing regressive taxes, okay?

403
01:02:45.010 --> 01:02:49.230
Boardroom: Why are you not looking at the people with the money?

404
01:02:49.480 --> 01:02:54.529
Boardroom: And tax them instead of… Poor and working class people.

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405
01:02:56.190 --> 01:02:57.470
Boardroom: Thank you.

406
01:03:02.230 --> 01:03:20.569
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor and Council Members. My name is Jane White, District 5. I'm a member of NSA and also work with SBS. I'm not speaking officially for those organizations, I'm speaking for myself.

407
01:03:20.620 --> 01:03:25.860
Boardroom: I'm here to urge the support of what

408
01:03:26.270 --> 01:03:45.380
Boardroom: us voters voted in good faith to allocate the money for the small sites. It just… it just keeps feeling like we're shifting sands, and we vote for something, and we all go and celebrate, and then all of a sudden, what we have said has disappeared.

409
01:03:45.430 --> 01:03:57.299
Boardroom: So, I'm really, urging… we know that small sites is a proven tool for preserving affordable housing and preventing displacement, and it is

410
01:03:57.300 --> 01:04:05.729
Boardroom: the values that we in Berkeley supported and rallied again for. Thank you very much. Thanks, Jane. Thanks.

411
01:04:12.660 --> 01:04:16.129
Boardroom: Good evening. Janice Chang, District 3.

412
01:04:16.190 --> 01:04:34.770
Boardroom: The issue with removing funds from the Small Sites Project is trust. Ten years ago, I voted for Measure U1, just like 75% of the voters at Berkeley did, because I believe the funds would be used for affordable housing. So this measure was advertised that way, and yet,

413
01:04:35.240 --> 01:04:51.460
Boardroom: it was put into the general fund, and so that is an issue, with all these tax measures that people are talking about. So last year, you voted to divert $2.5 million of U1 funds from this budget… to balance the budget last year, in 2025.

414
01:04:51.460 --> 01:04:57.709

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Boardroom: This year, you're proposing another $3.5 million to take away from the small sites program.

415
01:04:57.980 --> 01:05:17.160
Boardroom: This diminishes your credibility when you also adamantly state how much our city needs affordable housing, and how much you want to see people housed. The Kesarwani, Taplin-Backabee proposal does not guarantee that money to go… Thank you, Jess. …where it needs to go. Thank you.

416
01:05:24.700 --> 01:05:44.599
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor and Council and Community. I have a firefighter, I'm a wannabe firefighter, I practice law instead, but I want to be a firefighter. One of them, I hear, has a minute to… Thank you so much, I appreciate that. I also have my fellow SEIU 1021 member on the line, Christina Reya, who's…

417
01:05:44.900 --> 01:05:55.300
Boardroom: succeeding her minute. Can someone else from FIRE give another minute so we don't have to find that person? Thank you. So, thank you. Thank you. So I have 3 minutes.

418
01:05:56.310 --> 01:06:12.470
Boardroom: My name is Moni Law, and I speak as a wannabe firefighter, a city employee, and a supporter of affordable housing. And my position is that we can have all three. We do not need to divide families.

419
01:06:12.580 --> 01:06:22.319
Boardroom: against firefighters. We do not have to opt for one or the other. It is critical that our promises are kept. GG and FF.

420
01:06:22.600 --> 01:06:41.600
Boardroom: Firefighters supported it, the community supported it, we have to support them. Small sites was approved by U. 1. There is Unity for Urgent. Urgent housing. I go out on the streets, as many of us do as community members, and help unhoused families that we found in the rain on the corner.

421
01:06:41.790 --> 01:06:51.879
Boardroom: And who else showed up? The paramedics. Blind Tony, who died recently, but was housed finally, was helped by the paramedics.

422
01:06:52.350 --> 01:06:58.799
Boardroom: Also, children sleeping on sidewalks is unacceptable in the city of Berkeley. How can that be?

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423
01:06:59.380 --> 01:07:00.470
Boardroom: Often.

424
01:07:00.580 --> 01:07:11.530
Boardroom: We also look at no shelter during the winters are available for families. There is no shelter in Berkeley for families. It's unacceptable and shocking to me.

425
01:07:11.750 --> 01:07:21.649
Boardroom: Families include low-income workers, people with disabilities, seniors, and the small sites program is critical. Please do not cut it. Finally.

426
01:07:21.790 --> 01:07:35.170
Boardroom: I really want to thank Mayor Ishii for her efforts to emphasize the importance of credibility and consistency in effective governance. Your proposal is strong and solid, and we can make room for everyone, including…

427
01:07:36.160 --> 01:07:58.740
Boardroom: art and the joy of community festivals, etc. So I also speak as a member of the Indigenous Peoples Pow Wow Committee, and the Juneteenth Committee. But I think Berkeley is special because we prioritize things such as culture, such as community, such as unity, such as diversity, such as housing people, because they have the right to housing, such as employees who work hard and are…

428
01:07:58.740 --> 01:08:00.149
Boardroom: very much…

429
01:08:00.460 --> 01:08:13.069
Boardroom: putting their lives on the line often to help this make a better city. So SEIU 1021, Union Strong, City of Berkeley, historic, and are being the first on Earth Day.

430
01:08:13.110 --> 01:08:25.759
Boardroom: Last point. In the fires that are to come, because of climate change, more reason for the priority of fire department staff, as well as housing for people to not be in the

431
01:08:25.939 --> 01:08:42.200
Boardroom: outrageous, you know, climate actions that we're having recently with nowhere to go. So we can't have blind Tonys on the street suffering for years, or families that I've met and housed, and got

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housing for them with hotels. Thanks. Thank you. Give them housing, not hotels.

432
01:08:48.010 --> 01:08:53.159
Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor and Council. My name is Dustin Tranberg, District 3.

433
01:08:53.620 --> 01:08:56.410
Boardroom: Dustin Tranberg, District 3.

434
01:08:56.620 --> 01:09:02.180
Boardroom: I'm the proud son of a San Jose firefighter, and I'm here to speak in support of the Small Sites Program.

435
01:09:02.689 --> 01:09:17.350
Boardroom: The, Small Sites Program helps transform, rental housing from being fed to the sharks of the speculative market, and helps transform it into self-funded, resident-managed housing.

436
01:09:17.670 --> 01:09:22.890
Boardroom: That supports… democracy in the City of Berkeley, and perhaps,

437
01:09:23.460 --> 01:09:28.280
Boardroom: People from being kicked out of their homes. Often people have been here for decades already their entire lives.

438
01:09:28.689 --> 01:09:41.049
Boardroom: I urge you to not put these two communities at war with each other. Firefighters and equal housing can live together, and the City of Berkeley is the place for that to happen. Thank you very much.

439
01:09:41.210 --> 01:09:42.300
Boardroom: Thank you.

440
01:09:46.510 --> 01:09:49.910
Boardroom: So I'm… I'm getting… she's gonna give me her minute.

441
01:09:50.670 --> 01:09:56.759
Boardroom: Hi, so, my name is Bridget, and I'm, actually a recipient of the small site.

442
01:09:56.760 --> 01:10:21.709

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Boardroom: I live at 2627 California Street. If it had not have been for the Bay Area Community Land Trust and small sites, I wouldn't even be able to stand here and talk to you today, because I would have been exempted out of Berkeley. I would not have been able to afford to live here. So I am here to represent. I'm also here to represent black people, people of color, and what's happening out there. We… it's hard. If you're on this board, or you're

443
01:10:21.710 --> 01:10:44.399
Boardroom: the mayor, you're in anything. You don't understand how expensive it is to try to just make it every day, and we're just trying to keep a roof over our head. We don't really want to try and, you know, do too much of anything else. I hear an understanding about a proposal today about affordable housing and building it from the ground. That can be… I don't understand why it can't be that and small sites.

444
01:10:44.400 --> 01:10:50.249
Boardroom: That would even give Berkeley an overall, you know, design of low income.

445
01:10:50.420 --> 01:11:08.499
Boardroom: So, and when sometimes things are built from the ground up, what they consider affordable is not affordable for the people that actually live there. But if it's already there, it's preserved, and we want to preserve it, we want to improve it, we want to make it better, it's heck of cheaper. So I just want to say, please.

446
01:11:08.500 --> 01:11:17.579
Boardroom: Please do not get rid of small sites. It's people like me and those that cannot afford to do it, and I work a decent job.

447
01:11:17.670 --> 01:11:22.649
Boardroom: You know, I'm not diligent or whatever, I just… I'm just trying to keep a roof over my head.

448
01:11:22.650 --> 01:11:46.469
Boardroom: And then as we get older and start getting to the point of retirement and stuff, trying to stay here and keep some sort of balance on the rents that we pay, small sites, low-income housing, is the only way that that's going to happen. So I just wanted to make sure that I, you know, give that to you and help you understand that. It is important. I know that the firefighters are important, because without them.

449
01:11:46.470 --> 01:11:54.980

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Boardroom: I'm not gonna be… I want to be able to have them respond right away if something happens to me, like I think all the rest of you do. Thank you, Richard. Thank you.

450
01:12:03.220 --> 01:12:24.530
Boardroom: Hi there, Council and Mayor Ishii. My name is Alan Kane, I'm the Executive Director of the Solano Avenue Association. I'm here to supplement the very short comments that were made in the midnight hour last week. I did want to express the Slano Avenue Association's sincere appreciation for the fact that everybody stepped up to the plate to help us produce the 50th Solano Stroll.

451
01:12:24.530 --> 01:12:45.420
Boardroom: We're 60… roughly 60 days away from the event, so not only are we scrambling to produce this festival, we're also looking at ways to, you know, make sure that 2027 happens, and we're changing the ways that, adjusting the ways that we do our fundraising and that kind of thing, but it's just fantastic that everybody stepped up to the plate.

452
01:12:45.420 --> 01:12:49.930
Boardroom: I just can't express our appreciation enough. Thank you.

453
01:12:50.200 --> 01:12:51.400
Boardroom: Thank you.

454
01:12:56.190 --> 01:13:08.829
Boardroom: Hi, Jennifer Hansen-Romero, I'm actually Vice Mayor of Albany, and I wanted to come here and thank, Mayor and the rest of the City Council for working so…

455
01:13:09.270 --> 01:13:20.280
Boardroom: difficultly with this… everything going on, and so many decisions to make, and so many things to do, and, you know, Albany, you know.

456
01:13:20.660 --> 01:13:28.400
Boardroom: is, part of Solano, and so is Berkeley, part of Solano, and the line goes very…

457
01:13:28.400 --> 01:13:43.360
Boardroom: kind of staggered up and down, so you have businesses that are, in fact, part of Berkeley, but are on the Albany streets and sidewalks. So it's so important for our partnership to be able to do this between our cities together, combined.

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458
01:13:43.360 --> 01:13:59.110
Boardroom: to unify and be able to bring this 50th Solano stroll to, to our people, and surrounding people, and all of the businesses, and hope for that economic, wealth. Thank you.

459
01:14:04.880 --> 01:14:08.759
Boardroom: Good evening. I'm a homeowner in, District 3.

460
01:14:08.990 --> 01:14:12.570
Boardroom: There was an issue at San Pablo Park for Juneteenth.

461
01:14:13.160 --> 01:14:19.370
Boardroom: And my son was going to have a booth and serve some… Graduates?

462
01:14:19.530 --> 01:14:28.199
Boardroom: Before, the weekend before, City of Berkeley called him and told him he couldn't do it. When I walked around the corner and saw the chaos at San Pablo Park.

463
01:14:28.340 --> 01:14:32.210
Boardroom: You had someone get stabbed on Oregon and Park.

464
01:14:32.310 --> 01:14:35.320
Boardroom: You had a teenager who was beat.

465
01:14:35.440 --> 01:14:52.539
Boardroom: My family picked him up, cleaned him up, they stole his shoes and his phone, they put him on a lift all the way to East Park. I'm sorry, is this related to the budget? It's related to the budget, because what I'm saying is that you guys need to either police stuff that goes on in San Pablo Park, it should have been

466
01:14:52.970 --> 01:14:59.249
Boardroom: Caged up, fenced up. Those kids from other cities should not be allowed to tear up our park.

467
01:14:59.480 --> 01:15:02.490
Boardroom: And I feel Berkeley Police sat on the corner.

468
01:15:02.600 --> 01:15:11.570

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Boardroom: If you need more police, get more police. They did nothing while those 15-year-olds, 14-year-olds, tore up the park. Thank you.

469
01:15:18.840 --> 01:15:36.250
Boardroom: Hello, my name is Angela, and I'm a resident of the 10-unit Addison Court Housing Cooperative just down the block. I'm here tonight because I care deeply about keeping our communities whole. Please reject the memo from Councilmember Kesawani, and accept the Mayor's budget proposal, which allocates funding for small sites.

470
01:15:36.380 --> 01:15:48.320
Boardroom: Rent stabilization and eviction for good cause do not fully protect tenants from displacement and for-profit properties. Please preserve the culture, diversity, and don't put more of our neighbors onto the street.

471
01:15:48.550 --> 01:16:07.819
Boardroom: My neighbors bought the building collectively 30 years ago, which was only possible due to the help from the Northern California Land Trust and the Housing Trust Fund dollars to bring the buildings up to code. We help people save money due to low rents and support folks through job losses, complicated divorces, family and pet deaths, and transitioning due to declining health.

472
01:16:07.920 --> 01:16:12.649
Boardroom: Our residents work and worked in Berkeley, in downtown print shops, and more.

473
01:16:13.500 --> 01:16:21.250
Boardroom: The community land trusts create permanent democratically run housing, and please continue to support them through the small size fund. Thank you. Thank you.

474
01:16:28.640 --> 01:16:45.060
Boardroom: Good evening, Council. This supplemental is not about the best decision for the city. It's about city council members ignoring the will of the voters, 75% of whom voted for ballot measure U1 so the funds would be used

475
01:16:45.060 --> 01:16:49.190
Boardroom: For affordable housing and services, not salaries.

476
01:16:49.670 --> 01:16:52.260
Boardroom: Berkeley residents are appalled

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477
01:16:52.510 --> 01:17:03.710
Boardroom: By the hubris and arrogance of city council members who think they know better than the public and can discard the will of the voters and democracy.

478
01:17:04.760 --> 01:17:11.919
Boardroom: Who in the world would vote for a ballot measure by the city council, including this November?

479
01:17:12.250 --> 01:17:16.080
Boardroom: Knowing that we cannot trust the City Council.

480
01:17:16.370 --> 01:17:24.569
Boardroom: to follow the will of the voters and to disregard the will of the public. Everybody supports firefighters and firefighting.

481
01:17:24.770 --> 01:17:34.309
Boardroom: It is shameful to pit firefighters against residents who insist that you honor the will of the voters. Thanks so much. Thanks for your comment.

482
01:17:50.260 --> 01:17:52.109
Boardroom: Good evening, City Council.

483
01:17:52.970 --> 01:17:59.099
Boardroom: My name is Reverend Sophia DeWitt, Chief Program Officer at East Bay Housing Organizations.

484
01:17:59.300 --> 01:18:08.309
Boardroom: And I'm here to speak in favor of, the mayor's budget proposal, which includes money for the Small Sites program.

485
01:18:09.040 --> 01:18:10.050
Boardroom: Evo!

486
01:18:10.170 --> 01:18:12.729
Boardroom: An affordable housing developer.

487
01:18:12.910 --> 01:18:15.540
Boardroom: Organization, member organization.

488

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01:18:16.070 --> 01:18:27.600
Boardroom: Under… and our members… recognize the need for a three P's approach to our housing Challenges. That's production.

489
01:18:28.500 --> 01:18:35.829
Boardroom: through new production, preservation through the Small Sites program, and tenant protections.

490
01:18:36.040 --> 01:18:42.450
Boardroom: There is no conflict. There was no conflict until last evening.

491
01:18:42.950 --> 01:18:46.590
Boardroom: And there needs to be no conflict.

492
01:18:47.000 --> 01:18:56.089
Boardroom: RCD, one of our member developers, sent you a letter last week supporting small sites. Thank you. Thanks, Reverend.

493
01:18:58.170 --> 01:18:59.289
Boardroom: Thank you, sir.

494
01:19:10.810 --> 01:19:25.990
Boardroom: Hi, good evening. My name is Amanda, and I'm here with Urban Habitat today to speak in support of the Small Sites Acquisition Program. And I just first want to point out how insidious this memo that was released last night was, because

495
01:19:25.990 --> 01:19:35.899
Boardroom: We support the firefighters here today, and when I read the memo, I was like, okay, well, you know, if the money needs to go there, we're in a deficit, sure. But then, it says.

496
01:19:35.900 --> 01:19:44.860
Boardroom: also delete $3.8 million to preservation just because, and the Housing Advisory Commission said, oh, actually.

497
01:19:44.860 --> 01:19:59.700
Boardroom: the preservation is important, that's where we want the money to go, but for some reason, because a few council members decide, well, actually, we think it should be better in production, that's how we're gonna do it, and we'll just forget about the third P, preservation, which, as Sophia mentioned, is…

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498
01:19:59.880 --> 01:20:13.920
Boardroom: part of the three P's that the Bay Area has agreed upon as the way to get out of this housing crisis. If we want to move forward together for a Bay Area for everyone, we need all three of those P's. Thank you. Thank you.

499
01:20:18.280 --> 01:20:42.820
Boardroom: Mayor Ishii and members of the City Council, my name is Ainia, I'm Executive Director at the Northern California Land Trust. I just want to say, I stand with the firefighters of BFD. They responded to a fire at one of our properties last month. They saved the lives of more than a dozen people, so I… I am actually outraged that we're having to come here and be pitted against the work of these heroes.

500
01:20:42.820 --> 01:20:56.389
Boardroom: And the other thing that I really just want to say is that we want the entire memo to be fully rejected, and we support the mayor's amendment for, for adoption. So thank you so much.

501
01:20:58.100 --> 01:20:59.390
Boardroom: Thank you.

502
01:21:02.590 --> 01:21:17.530
Boardroom: Hello, my name is Howard Menashi, I'm resident at, in District 5, and wanted to offer my sincere gratitude and thanks to you, Mary Ishi, our Councilwoman O'Keefe, and Wahita Mary, and the City Manager, for supporting our McGee Avenue

503
01:21:17.680 --> 01:21:36.010
Boardroom: restructuring program that was being proposed as part of the CIP, FY27, and we appreciate that there are a lot of needs of similar streets in the city, but we appreciate all the support you've given us, and hope for our… hope that our council will approve it. Thank you.

504
01:21:36.650 --> 01:21:37.530
Boardroom: Q.

505
01:21:40.070 --> 01:21:58.999
Boardroom: Hi, I'm Gail Alcock in District 2, and, yes, I agree that the Small Sites program is really critical, really crucial, not only for providing, preserving and upgrading buildings that we already have.

506
01:21:59.090 --> 01:22:11.760

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Boardroom: But also to restore trust in the councils, because your primary, number one item on the top of the strategic plan is affordable housing.

507
01:22:11.980 --> 01:22:21.879
Boardroom: And that should be… on the top of that plan, should be the people that have no houses and are Berkeley residents already. Thank you.

508
01:22:22.580 --> 01:22:23.710
Boardroom: Thank you.

509
01:22:29.540 --> 01:22:40.030
Boardroom: Good evening, Council! My name is Luis Chico, and I live in District 8. I'm a supporter of telegraph-free people, and I want to thank Mayor Ishii for including the 1.3 million car-free telegraph designs in her proposed budgets.

510
01:22:40.300 --> 01:22:53.850
Boardroom: I'm asking you to follow through on the unanimous 22 decision to pedestrianize Telegraph. Telegraph is the second busiest pedestrian corridor in East Bay, yet pedestrians are given a fraction of the right of way.

511
01:22:54.500 --> 01:23:07.490
Boardroom: Cyclists and pedestrians are repeatedly killed, injured, injured, or even sent to the ambulance due to these, cars. Making it car-free supports Vision Zero, helps local businesses, is through more roadfoot traffic.

512
01:23:08.030 --> 01:23:13.789
Boardroom: Critically, he clears the streets for ambulances and fire crews, who so they can respond without fighting traffic.

513
01:23:14.880 --> 01:23:25.430
Boardroom: So I'm asking you, for the sake of all Berkeley citizens who thrive and live on Telegraph, the most… one of the most busy city, intersections in Berkeley, please support this measure.

514
01:23:26.940 --> 01:23:27.980
Boardroom: Thank you.

515
01:23:32.950 --> 01:23:40.270

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Boardroom: Good evening, Mayor and Council. Matt Gustafson with the Bay Area Community Land Trust, resident of District 2 in Berkeley. I just… I'm… I'm…

516
01:23:40.270 --> 01:24:00.970
Boardroom: I want to stand in solidarity with firefighters and also city staff tonight. I am similarly outraged at the pitting that I felt like is totally unnecessary in the memo, which also includes a lot of misinformation about, recent changes in public policy and state and regional levels that recognize the importance of preservation of housing, and,

517
01:24:00.970 --> 01:24:06.480
Boardroom: and dismisses the importance of preservation of existing affordable housing. The $8.1 million to Community Land Trust.

518
01:24:06.480 --> 01:24:24.930
Boardroom: ignores hundreds of million dollars that's already been allocated to new construction of affordable housing, which also has access to other programs, like County Measure W funding tens of millions of dollars there and other places. There's also public funding coming down the pipeline. I just want to say, the memo isn't really about getting the most bang for your buck.

519
01:24:24.960 --> 01:24:37.980
Boardroom: This is about totally eliminating preservation. A budget without preservation for housing is a budget that doesn't believe low-income Berkeley residents deserve agency in their homes, don't deserve to remain in place, or self-manage, or self-govern. Thank you. Thank you. Thank you.

520
01:24:41.780 --> 01:25:05.219
Boardroom: Good evening, Kristin Limekuller, District 1. I'm here to express my concerns about eliminating the nine paramedic and firefighter positions. I believe the decision to eliminate these positions is short-sighted and does not reflect a commitment to Berkeley's public safety. In recent years, a dramatically changing climate, coupled with the devastating fires that destroyed over 10,000 homes in LA, have opened our eyes to the risk

521
01:25:05.220 --> 01:25:14.780
Boardroom: Berkeley faces in the event of a catastrophic firestorm. We know that Tilden Park, while providing a green belt that we all enjoy, also poses a serious risk.

522
01:25:14.780 --> 01:25:39.500

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Boardroom: to not just the hills, but our entire city below. If the climate conditions and high velocity winds combine with a spark, we will need every single trained firefighter and paramedic defending our lives. We also know that firefighters have responded to numerous fires near the freeway and railroad tracks that are sometimes a result of unsafe practices by unhoused people. Our first responders are there to protect both the housed and unhoused.

523
01:25:39.500 --> 01:25:42.660
Boardroom: Even when that is extremely challenging.

524
01:25:42.840 --> 01:25:43.930
Boardroom: Thank you.

525
01:25:47.850 --> 01:25:59.610
Boardroom: I have, I have two additional minutes, one from Eric from the Fire Department, and one from Lisa, who's in line. On behalf of the Homeless Services Panel of Experts, I am Carol Morasovic, the chair.

526
01:25:59.690 --> 01:26:09.970
Boardroom: Firefighters provide an essential service, and they provide it efficiently and equitably in Berkeley. And I can testify to what happens

527
01:26:09.970 --> 01:26:21.189
Boardroom: when that is not applied. When I was in my 20s, my parents had strokes 5 days apart. I was with my father while my mother was in the hospital, when he had a massive stroke.

528
01:26:21.240 --> 01:26:35.210
Boardroom: And I… it seemed like when I called, there were a lot of questions before the paramedic was dispatched. I would lay… and it seemed as if there was a delay. I would later be told at the hospital by that paramedic that

529
01:26:35.440 --> 01:26:36.840
Boardroom: They didn't…

530
01:26:37.410 --> 01:26:50.410
Boardroom: They didn't dispatch until after I had answered all those questions, because my parents lived in a black neighborhood. And that's what happens when there's a lack of equity.

531
01:26:50.900 --> 01:26:59.639

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Boardroom: As to the small sites program, this is homelessness prevention. It is also an essential service. Shelters.

532
01:26:59.780 --> 01:27:06.579
Boardroom: That is… homelessness being addressed is an essential service to this community.

533
01:27:07.260 --> 01:27:13.700
Boardroom: We asked on the Homeless Services Panel of Experts if

534
01:27:14.050 --> 01:27:29.660
Boardroom: Council would consider referring to staff to negotiate with the motel conversions to reduce the price so that this… that the shelter could be restored, the emergency shelter. We still believe that can be done. There are planned negotiations.

535
01:27:29.710 --> 01:27:43.080
Boardroom: that staff is presenting… already planning to do with the convergence. And we hope that we can save that emergency shelter. Thank you for restoring the, the,

536
01:27:43.740 --> 01:27:45.750
Boardroom: Downtown Business District.

537
01:27:45.890 --> 01:27:47.820
Boardroom: a DBA worker.

538
01:27:48.610 --> 01:27:58.690
Boardroom: I'm sorry you're all in this position, because these are our essential services. You're clearly paying for the sins of your father, because there has been waste in the past.

539
01:27:58.970 --> 01:28:01.370
Boardroom: But we cannot…

540
01:28:01.690 --> 01:28:14.370
Boardroom: reduce these essential services. Again, housing. And the small sites is important. We shouldn't really be debating one against another. The fire department is important. Homelessness prevention is important.

541
01:28:15.050 --> 01:28:28.719

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Boardroom: We have to have all of this, and we have to cut back on consultants. We recommended that from the homeless parental of Experts. Things have to be scrutinized a lot more carefully. I've come to you

542
01:28:28.720 --> 01:28:38.160
Boardroom: over the years, often wondering, where is all this money coming from? We have to scrutinize everything carefully so that we preserve these essential services. Thank you.

543
01:28:38.720 --> 01:28:40.130
Boardroom: Thanks, Carol.

544
01:28:43.910 --> 01:28:45.710
Boardroom: Did you have a public comment?

545
01:28:47.750 --> 01:28:51.859
Boardroom: If you can't reach this mic up here, we can also move one over.

546
01:28:53.720 --> 01:28:58.459
Boardroom: I… think I… Reach it.

547
01:29:00.310 --> 01:29:01.090
Boardroom: You ready?

548
01:29:02.550 --> 01:29:05.330
Boardroom: Thank you for allowing me to speak.

549
01:29:05.890 --> 01:29:09.790
Boardroom: I just wanted to thank the fire department and all the city workers.

550
01:29:09.990 --> 01:29:16.960
Boardroom: I believe that they all deserve their fair pay. Bible says a hired hand is worthy of their pay.

551
01:29:17.780 --> 01:29:22.929
Boardroom: I live at 2747 San Pablo Avenue in Terry Taplin's district.

552
01:29:23.250 --> 01:29:27.300
Boardroom: And the building I live in is a relatively new building.

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553
01:29:27.560 --> 01:29:30.450
Boardroom: And the fire alarm system doesn't work.

554
01:29:30.720 --> 01:29:35.060
Boardroom: Berkeley Fire Department has showed up several times, Because…

555
01:29:35.320 --> 01:29:38.440
Boardroom: The system doesn't work, it's malfunctioned.

556
01:29:39.080 --> 01:29:41.289
Boardroom: But I think the biggest problem we have

557
01:29:41.720 --> 01:29:46.519
Boardroom: It's not cutting people's jobs out, it's oversight and accountability.

558
01:29:47.020 --> 01:29:52.630
Boardroom: I believe that if city council and elected officials We're held accountable.

559
01:29:53.170 --> 01:29:58.640
Boardroom: for managing budgets, And if they did not, and that affected their pay.

560
01:29:58.840 --> 01:30:06.119
Boardroom: the outcome would definitely be different, and homeless people definitely need affordable housing. Thank you.

561
01:30:09.640 --> 01:30:13.460
Boardroom: Okay, we have a number of folks online.

562
01:30:15.390 --> 01:30:21.939
Boardroom: Alright, our first speaker is Makai Freeman. Makai, you should be able to speak.

563
01:30:43.170 --> 01:30:46.840
Boardroom: Sorry, Bruce. Oh, yeah. Makai, can you hear us?

564
01:30:47.430 --> 01:30:49.410
Boardroom: You should be able to unmute.

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565
01:30:58.250 --> 01:31:06.000
Boardroom: Alright, give me one moment, let me… Try one more time.

566
01:31:08.980 --> 01:31:13.739
Boardroom: Okay, I just prompted you, you should be able to speak.

567
01:31:14.070 --> 01:31:15.320
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Hi, can you hear me?

568
01:31:15.640 --> 01:31:17.000
Boardroom: Yes, we can hear you.

569
01:31:28.940 --> 01:31:30.350
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Hi, can you hear me?

570
01:31:31.570 --> 01:31:32.350
Boardroom: Yes.

571
01:31:32.350 --> 01:31:33.620
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Hello, can you hear me?

572
01:31:34.010 --> 01:31:34.600
Boardroom: Yes.

573
01:31:34.600 --> 01:31:36.340
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Okay, good afternoon.

574
01:31:37.760 --> 01:31:39.469
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: may even count.

575
01:31:39.950 --> 01:31:41.450
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Numbers.

576
01:31:42.260 --> 01:31:46.079
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: People are looking… And taking note.

577
01:31:46.900 --> 01:31:50.940
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I'm not as… representing an organization.

578

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01:31:52.090 --> 01:31:53.719
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: At this time.

579
01:31:54.400 --> 01:31:58.250
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I'm speaking as… Alright, Susan.

580
01:31:58.940 --> 01:32:00.649
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And I was so young.

581
01:32:01.250 --> 01:32:02.820
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: a resident Berkeley.

582
01:32:04.370 --> 01:32:06.190
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: He's run so hard.

583
01:32:06.810 --> 01:32:08.200
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: to live here.

584
01:32:09.130 --> 01:32:10.780
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Give me a favorable.

585
01:32:11.210 --> 01:32:12.949
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Housing is no joke.

586
01:32:13.480 --> 01:32:15.060
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: You have kicked down.

587
01:32:16.780 --> 01:32:18.160
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: So, Ken?

588
01:32:19.960 --> 01:32:21.949
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: The fields have access.

589
01:32:25.730 --> 01:32:26.990
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Housing.

590
01:32:28.040 --> 01:32:31.910
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Our streets are… Ancestion me.

591
01:32:32.560 --> 01:32:40.260

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Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And then I'm trying to get… who have… Ask some more accountability.

592
01:32:41.040 --> 01:32:42.570
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: increase?

593
01:32:43.310 --> 01:32:51.160
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: streets, and now… You're asking us… To trust you.

594
01:32:52.140 --> 01:32:57.220
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: with increased… Money from Tacos.

595
01:32:57.680 --> 01:32:59.309
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: and bond measures.

596
01:33:00.880 --> 01:33:04.840
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: is false… Narrative.

597
01:33:05.740 --> 01:33:07.400
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: To choose the treatment.

598
01:33:08.860 --> 01:33:10.530
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Firefighters.

599
01:33:12.180 --> 01:33:17.090
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: And housing, because we… I support Leah.

600
01:33:17.980 --> 01:33:21.510
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Yes, he's… Budgets?

601
01:33:22.640 --> 01:33:26.570
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: I asked you… To show leadership.

602
01:33:28.130 --> 01:33:29.790
Michai Freeman CIS She/Her: Accountability.

603
01:33:29.790 --> 01:33:32.140
Boardroom: Thanks, Makai.

604

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01:33:33.450 --> 01:33:43.029
Boardroom: Sorry. Thank you, Makai. Our next speaker on the budget is Mark Hedlund. Mark, you should be able to unmute.

605
01:33:43.520 --> 01:33:55.009
Marc Hedlund (he/him): Thank you all for your hard work on a very difficult budget. I was a member of the Coordinating Committee for 2024's Measure FF, the streets one, and I wanted to make a quick comment, speaking only for myself.

606
01:33:55.300 --> 01:34:02.969
Marc Hedlund (he/him): I agree with Mayor Ishii's proposed changes, moving selected items from Measure FF funds to unfunded for future consideration.

607
01:34:03.280 --> 01:34:07.620
Marc Hedlund (he/him): One of the frequent pieces of feedback we heard from voters about Measure FF.

608
01:34:08.340 --> 01:34:15.230
Marc Hedlund (he/him): was that they were concerned Council would misallocate funds collected by this measure, which led to the measure's Oversight Committee.

609
01:34:15.420 --> 01:34:24.519
Marc Hedlund (he/him): Allowing that committee and staff to ensure all phones are in line with Measure FF's text, as Measure Ishii has proposed, would avoid those concerns. Thank you.

610
01:34:25.570 --> 01:34:26.750
Boardroom: Thanks, Mark.

611
01:34:27.720 --> 01:34:36.130
Boardroom: Alright, our next speaker on the budget is the caller with the number ending in 405. You should be able to unmute.

612
01:34:46.620 --> 01:34:52.649
Boardroom: Caller ending, with 405. You should be able to unmute, star 6.

613
01:35:04.740 --> 01:35:08.430
Boardroom: One more time, caller ending in 405.

614
01:35:08.920 --> 01:35:11.390

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Boardroom: You should be able to unmute.

615
01:35:15.560 --> 01:35:16.590
Boardroom: Right?

616
01:35:17.450 --> 01:35:20.189
Boardroom: We will go ahead and come back to you.

617
01:35:20.740 --> 01:35:24.399
Boardroom: Our next speaker is Kelvin Ward.

618
01:35:26.430 --> 01:35:28.650
Kelvin Ward: Yes, good evening, Mayor Ishii.

619
01:35:28.910 --> 01:35:32.879
Kelvin Ward: Members of the City Council, my name is Kelvin Ward, and I…

620
01:35:33.110 --> 01:35:36.709
Kelvin Ward: serve as a regional organizer with Live Free California.

621
01:35:36.930 --> 01:35:47.320
Kelvin Ward: I wholeheartedly support Mayor Ishii's proposed budget, including the $200,000 reallocation to live freeze gun violence.

622
01:35:47.460 --> 01:35:53.270
Kelvin Ward: Intervention and Prevention Program, which will help close the, fiscal… fiscal

623
01:35:53.420 --> 01:35:56.839
Kelvin Ward: Funding gap, for 2027.

624
01:35:57.090 --> 01:36:06.619
Kelvin Ward: And as someone who has worked in violence intervention and prevention for years, I have seen firsthand how these programs save lives, interrupt

625
01:36:06.840 --> 01:36:10.910
Kelvin Ward: Cycles of violence and create safer communities.

626
01:36:11.060 --> 01:36:17.959

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Kelvin Ward: Community-based violence intervention is not an expense, it's an investment in public safety, healing, and hope.

627
01:36:18.110 --> 01:36:22.750
Kelvin Ward: I want to thank Mayor Ishii and each council member in advance for your support.

628
01:36:22.850 --> 01:36:30.449
Kelvin Ward: And urge you to approve this critical funding in the midst of all the difficult, challenges that you have. Thank you.

629
01:36:30.450 --> 01:36:31.370
Boardroom: Thanks, Kelvin.

630
01:36:32.310 --> 01:36:36.409
Boardroom: Alright, our next speaker is Joel Meyerson.

631
01:36:38.020 --> 01:36:48.669
Joel Myerson: Hi, my name is Joel Myerson, District 1. I'd like to address the entire Council, but in particular, Council Members Kessarwani, Blackby, and Taplin, who introduced the supplemental motion.

632
01:36:48.840 --> 01:37:02.350
Joel Myerson: Measure U1 was passed by Berkeley voters by an overwhelming 3-1 majority. In the ballot argument signed by former Mayor Jesse Aragin, he stated, Measure U1 is the real affordable housing measure.

633
01:37:02.620 --> 01:37:10.040
Joel Myerson: If any of you council members think you can ignore the will of the voters and use the U1 money for something else, let me explain something.

634
01:37:10.140 --> 01:37:12.189
Joel Myerson: We will never trust you again.

635
01:37:12.500 --> 01:37:32.009
Joel Myerson: Why should we? Why would you expect the voters to pass a $300 million bond act and increase sales tax? You have shown that any ballot measure, no matter how impressive its purpose sounds, any ballot measure that puts money into the general fund is a ballot measure that is ripe for misappropriation and abuse. Please think about this before you vote.

636

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01:37:33.230 --> 01:37:34.299
Boardroom: Thank you.

637
01:37:37.140 --> 01:37:40.450
Boardroom: Alright, next speaker, Kathy Labriola.

638
01:37:41.920 --> 01:37:49.930
Kathy Labriola: Yes, actually, my name is Rick Lewis. I am using my partner's connection.

639
01:37:50.140 --> 01:37:54.729
Kathy Labriola: I am opposed to the defunding of the small sites program.

640
01:37:55.040 --> 01:38:04.170
Kathy Labriola: Councilmember Kasawani mentioned earlier that a program that she was discussing would, help

641
01:38:04.700 --> 01:38:12.949
Kathy Labriola: avoid displacement of residents from Berkeley. The SSP program, in fact, prevents low-income residents

642
01:38:13.100 --> 01:38:15.530
Kathy Labriola: From being displaced in the first place.

643
01:38:15.880 --> 01:38:21.400
Kathy Labriola: SSP… Offers a unique approach to providing affordable housing.

644
01:38:21.570 --> 01:38:26.940
Kathy Labriola: It preserves housing in the neighborhoods where residents have lived for years.

645
01:38:27.040 --> 01:38:35.079
Kathy Labriola: They have built community in their buildings, and they keep affordable housing in rapidly gentrifying neighborhoods.

646
01:38:35.410 --> 01:38:45.780
Kathy Labriola: Other cities have adopted the SSP programs. Merkley must maintain its leadership in this area and fully fund the small tract program.

647
01:38:45.780 --> 01:38:46.370

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Boardroom: pick.

648
01:38:49.150 --> 01:38:52.020
Boardroom: Next speaker, Teresa Gonzalez.

649
01:38:54.350 --> 01:39:05.670
Teresa L. Gonzalez: Good evening, Mayor Ishii, Berkeley City Council and City Manager. My name is Teresa Gonzalez, and I'm speaking on behalf of Live Free California and the Berkeley Gun Violence Intervention and Prevention Program.

650
01:39:05.810 --> 01:39:11.980
Teresa L. Gonzalez: First, thank you to Mary Ishii and the entire Council for your leadership during an extraordinarily difficult budget season.

651
01:39:12.130 --> 01:39:22.030
Teresa L. Gonzalez: We are especially grateful to you all for identifying funding to save many critical services and programs, including the $200,000 to close our fiscal year 27 funding gap.

652
01:39:22.220 --> 01:39:28.670
Teresa L. Gonzalez: In 2024, Berkeley experienced 3 fatal shootings and 5 non-fatal shootings. 8 people were shot.

653
01:39:29.040 --> 01:39:42.870
Teresa L. Gonzalez: The financial cost exceeded $13 million, but the human cost was even greater. Lives lost, families shattered, children traumatized, entire communities left carrying the lifelong pain, and all Berkeley taxpayers ultimately bearing the cost.

654
01:39:43.070 --> 01:39:52.300
Teresa L. Gonzalez: In 2025, Berkeley experienced zero fatal shootings and zero non-fatal shootings. That means youth and adults who are most vulnerable to gun violence are alive today.

655
01:39:52.860 --> 01:39:56.289
Teresa L. Gonzalez: It means safer communities and stronger communities for all of Berkeley.

656
01:39:56.290 --> 01:39:58.400
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks, Teresa.

657
01:40:00.240 --> 01:40:02.880

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Boardroom: Meryl Siegel is our next speaker.

658
01:40:05.350 --> 01:40:11.810
meryl siegal: Hi, thank you. I am here to support the Small Tides funding, and I'm also here to support democracy.

659
01:40:12.400 --> 01:40:19.489
meryl siegal: Democracy is alive when you see 75% of voters voting for a ballot measure, and…

660
01:40:19.640 --> 01:40:22.480
meryl siegal: Having that ballot measure stay intact.

661
01:40:22.630 --> 01:40:28.730
meryl siegal: You measure U1, this is the second time it's been rated by all City Council.

662
01:40:28.730 --> 01:40:47.919
meryl siegal: And this is a very important measure for affordable housing, because with small sites housing, you have the housing now! You have it right now! You don't have to wait for it. It's not gonna be a monstrosity in the community. The people are living there. Many are senior citizens and poor.

663
01:40:48.270 --> 01:40:58.670
meryl siegal: I just can't even fathom why anyone would want to touch that money. It is an essentially Berkeley-esque Beautiful.

664
01:40:58.860 --> 01:41:02.839
meryl siegal: idea, and we need to preserve that. Thank you.

665
01:41:03.440 --> 01:41:04.520
Boardroom: Thanks, Merrill.

666
01:41:06.530 --> 01:41:08.350
Boardroom: Heather Bromfield?

667
01:41:11.900 --> 01:41:20.390
Heather Bromfield: Good evening, my name is Heather Brownfield. I'm with Enterprise Community Partners in Northern California. I'm also an East Bay resident.

668

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01:41:20.510 --> 01:41:30.010
Heather Bromfield: And, I'm presenting tonight on the proposal to cover a $200,000 emerging developer capacity building grant. Enterprise gets to work with both small and large mission-based

669
01:41:30.010 --> 01:41:42.609
Heather Bromfield: developers in Berkeley in a variety of ways, investing in positioning projects for major grants and tax credits. Capacity-building grants are lifelines for small organizations who perform deeply necessary and difficult anti-displacement work in the Berkeley community.

670
01:41:42.820 --> 01:41:55.650
Heather Bromfield: We're grateful to Councilmember Cassarwani for citing Enterprise's research and MMOs, but I wanted to clarify a couple of things. First, Enterprise is in support of all three P's of affordable housing, including production, protections and preservation.

671
01:41:55.780 --> 01:42:12.430
Heather Bromfield: The memo cites our research stating that new construction leverages state and federal dollars and claims that preservation cannot. This is untrue. Preservation can leverage regional and state funding and small sites projects in other jurisdictions. Recently leveraged funding from BAFA to executes six projects, or sorry, multiple projects.

672
01:42:12.600 --> 01:42:16.320
Heather Bromfield: Second, just earlier this week, our Assemblymember, Buffy Wicks, and now State Senator.

673
01:42:16.320 --> 01:42:18.680
Boardroom: Heather, I'm sorry, your time's up, thank you.

674
01:42:19.810 --> 01:42:22.369
Boardroom: Our next speaker is Mia Ferden.

675
01:42:31.600 --> 01:42:34.349
Boardroom: Hello? Oh, yes, we hear you.

676
01:42:34.350 --> 01:42:35.940
Mia Verdin (she/they/ella): Sorry, I was fumbling for the mute.

677
01:42:35.980 --> 01:42:53.329
Mia Verdin (she/they/ella): Good evening, Mayor and City Council. My name is Mia, and I'm the Board President for Telegraph for People. I would

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like to thank the Council and Mayor Ishii for including funding for car-free telegraph designs in the Mayor's budget proposal. I respectfully ask the Council to support the Mayor's proposed budget and follow through with previous Council President in prioritizing the pedestrianization of Telegraph Avenue.

678
01:42:53.330 --> 01:43:09.870
Mia Verdin (she/they/ella): As a student at UC Berkeley, living on Southside was the first time I ever experienced living in a walkable area. The proposal to pedestrianize Telegraph is the exact kind of policy that not only preserves a special part of our city, but also follows through with the city's Vision Zero goal in promoting pedestrian safety. With so many pedestrians, cyclists, micromobility users.

679
01:43:09.870 --> 01:43:29.259
Mia Verdin (she/they/ella): comprising an overwhelming majority of Southside residents and traffic violence being ever-present, we must approach this issue as what it truly is, as one of public safety. Keeping the Mayor's proposal and funding the city to pedestrianize Telegraph Avenue is a vital step that the Council can take to reduce these preventable deaths and injuries. Please vote to support the Mayor's budget proposal and fund Carfree Telegraph. Thank you for your time.

680
01:43:29.430 --> 01:43:30.580
Boardroom: Thank you, Mia.

681
01:43:33.360 --> 01:43:35.300
Boardroom: Dorothea Dorenz?

682
01:43:38.410 --> 01:43:41.440
Dorothea Dorenz: Good evening, hi. I support the

683
01:43:41.720 --> 01:43:46.179
Dorothea Dorenz: a proposal that Terry Taplin and Kishwani and Gathaby had.

684
01:43:46.540 --> 01:43:49.510
Dorothea Dorenz: Given to us, and the reason is…

685
01:43:49.730 --> 01:44:03.779
Dorothea Dorenz: It's not that I don't care about small sites and people being housed. Actually, I care very much about the future of housing in this city, because it will supply us with more housing for people.

686

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01:44:03.860 --> 01:44:14.869
Dorothea Dorenz: The fact that the measure for small sites was passed in 2014 doesn't take into account the major changes that have gone down around

687
01:44:14.980 --> 01:44:26.329
Dorothea Dorenz: the city being forced to create 9,000 new residences in our city. The picture has changed enormously, and so we have to be flexible.

688
01:44:26.380 --> 01:44:40.930
Dorothea Dorenz: and find more housing for more people. Not take away housing, but find more housing, and the idea that this proposal figures out how to keep the firemen hired is very, very, very important. So, I'm asking you to look into this.

689
01:44:40.930 --> 01:44:42.940
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks for your comment.

690
01:44:44.580 --> 01:44:47.990
Boardroom: All right, Della Luna, you're up next.

691
01:44:53.090 --> 01:44:59.020
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: Yes, thank you. I wanted to… speak in support.

692
01:44:59.080 --> 01:45:15.019
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: of bringing in the more housing? Well, one, I want to say it's… I think the fire departments and the 9 hirings, is just critical. Like, that should not even be a question, so I appreciate the council members that went through effort to bring those positions back.

693
01:45:15.020 --> 01:45:30.580
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: My reasoning behind that is just those firefighters, those positions could help any resident in Berkeley at any time. So, the value that it presents to all of us, whether small sites, affordable housing, or in the hills.

694
01:45:30.650 --> 01:45:38.829
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: you know, it benefits all of us, even the potentiality that it could save our lives. But I'm in support of the larger housing projects being built.

695

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01:45:38.830 --> 01:45:53.279
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: And I know… well, not just generally speaking, but in this case, because I know that there are people waiting for the right to return, and I don't think the small sites actually creates a funnel for new people, or people to return into Berkeley, because people are already in those homes, generally speaking.

696
01:45:53.340 --> 01:45:56.129
Della Luna (she/her) Huichun: And then they're also very expensive. Small sites has been very expensive.

697
01:45:56.130 --> 01:45:58.160
Boardroom: Thank you. Thank you, Della.

698
01:46:00.020 --> 01:46:03.199
Boardroom: Our next speaker is Paula Senhoi.

699
01:46:06.210 --> 01:46:18.200
Paula Saenghoi: Thank you, good evening, everyone, Free Council members, and Irishi, and community members. My name is Paul Thinghoy, and I am, from District 5. So, I'm here in…

700
01:46:18.540 --> 01:46:28.780
Paula Saenghoi: I'm here to speak as a resident of, the small sites, allocated funds that, Bay Area Community Land Trust were able to, acquire, and I…

701
01:46:28.830 --> 01:46:41.550
Paula Saenghoi: basically here to, in support of that, and also in support of the mayor's proposal. Of course, the firemen are very, very important for our community as well, so again, I don't agree with, having

702
01:46:41.760 --> 01:46:51.579
Paula Saenghoi: Hearing the community talk about putting us, or pinning us against the very important fire community, the fireman community, people that need,

703
01:46:52.100 --> 01:46:57.270
Paula Saenghoi: those spaces that need to be filled, basically, is a very essential, very essential,

704
01:46:58.000 --> 01:47:08.639
Paula Saenghoi: necessity for our city to, like, function correctly, because they are, like, our first line of defense when anything happens.

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Basically, if we're calling the fire department or 911, they will be the first ones to come. They are heroes.

705
01:47:08.640 --> 01:47:15.059
Boardroom: Thank you, Paula. Thanks for your time. Our next speaker is April Victoria King.

706
01:47:17.620 --> 01:47:19.939
April Victoria King (she/hers/they): Good evening, Mayor Ishii and Councilmembers.

707
01:47:19.940 --> 01:47:43.229
April Victoria King (she/hers/they): I'm a District 3 resident at the Stewart Street Co-op. As a music educator, artist, mother, and Berkeley resident, I'm deeply grateful to have affordable housing in an environment where my family is valued, rooted, and protected from displacement. At Stuart Street, we're members of a forming co-op who have agency, responsibility, and a voice in the place we get to call home. My family's story should not be considered lucky or exceptional in Berkeley.

708
01:47:43.230 --> 01:48:08.210
April Victoria King (she/hers/they): What the Small Sites program makes possible is permanent affordability, resident power, and preservation of Berkeley's neighborhoods. I implore the City Council to continue to support the Small Sites program while supporting everything our city needs. Berkeley is one of the best cities in the world, and we have a duty to keep leading as an example in an inclusive, thriving community. I want to thank Mayor Ishii and the Council members supporting Small Sites.

709
01:48:08.210 --> 01:48:15.739
April Victoria King (she/hers/they): the full Council to protect Measure U1's purpose and fund Small Sites Program in this budget. Thank you.

710
01:48:15.990 --> 01:48:17.039
Boardroom: Thank you.

711
01:48:19.830 --> 01:48:20.850
Boardroom: All right.

712
01:48:21.020 --> 01:48:23.910
Boardroom: Berkeley neighborhoods, you should be able to unmute.

713
01:48:28.190 --> 01:48:33.080

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Berkeley Neighborhoods: Oh, hi, this is actually Christopher Kroll. I'm… I'm not… I'm representing only myself.

714
01:48:33.260 --> 01:48:43.750
Berkeley Neighborhoods: I do want to notice… note that last year, I had a serious bike accident, and the wonderful EMTs from Station 3 on Russell Street, who I really appreciate.

715
01:48:44.980 --> 01:49:00.060
Berkeley Neighborhoods: helped… I had serious facial injuries, and thanks to them, I was able to get to Highland Hospital and get treated. So, I'm very grateful to have the personal experience, to the emergency services, the fire department of the City of Berkeley. That said.

716
01:49:00.060 --> 01:49:15.939
Berkeley Neighborhoods: I am here today to support the mayor's supplemental. I do not support pitting emergency public safety positions against a measure that was passed by the voters by 75% 10 years ago to provide for much-needed affordable housing in Berkeley.

717
01:49:15.990 --> 01:49:29.470
Berkeley Neighborhoods: I urge you to not repeat what happened last year, when this funding was raided, and to leave Measure U alone and not take money from that fund. Thank you very much.

718
01:49:29.470 --> 01:49:30.350
Boardroom: Thank you.

719
01:49:32.840 --> 01:49:35.590
Boardroom: Alright, call in user 1.

720
01:49:35.960 --> 01:49:37.490
Boardroom: You should be able to unmute.

721
01:49:49.190 --> 01:49:50.190
Call-In User_1: Can you hear me?

722
01:49:50.790 --> 01:49:52.050
Boardroom: Yes, we can hear you.

723
01:49:53.180 --> 01:50:00.960
Call-In User_1: Hi, my name is Bernadette. I'm a Berkeley resident. I've been in Berkeley for about 40 years.

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724
01:50:01.090 --> 01:50:12.059
Call-In User_1: I'm actually appalled that we're being asked to choose between, firefighters, or affordable housing, or the small size program.

725
01:50:12.060 --> 01:50:22.779
Call-In User_1: I know that we can do better as Berkeley. The City Council members, I would like for you all to come up with something that's a win-win situation.

726
01:50:22.820 --> 01:50:25.480
Call-In User_1: Which is thoroughly,

727
01:50:25.860 --> 01:50:40.779
Call-In User_1: doable, that we don't have to worry about if somebody has an emergency. We know someone who had a pulmonary embolism that had to be carried down the stairs by the firefighters. If they had not shown up, that person would not be alive today.

728
01:50:40.860 --> 01:50:53.489
Call-In User_1: We know people, personally, who have also been having to call the ambulance because of other illnesses. We can't be, talking about losing our housing or having safeties. Like, why are we pitching safety against.

729
01:50:53.490 --> 01:50:54.000
Boardroom: Thank you.

730
01:50:54.000 --> 01:50:55.160
Call-In User_1: Shelter.

731
01:50:55.160 --> 01:50:58.039
Boardroom: Thank you so much for your comment. Sorry, your time is up.

732
01:50:59.390 --> 01:51:04.080
Boardroom: Alright, our next speaker is 1000 Eda Martinak.

733
01:51:10.670 --> 01:51:11.780
1000 - Ida Martinac, DLC 744: Hmm, hello?

734
01:51:11.970 --> 01:51:13.190
1000 - Ida Martinac, DLC 744: Good evening.

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735
01:51:13.650 --> 01:51:23.449
1000 - Ida Martinac, DLC 744: I'm a resident of District 3, and I'm also a commissioner of the Berkeley Rent Board, but speaking here on my own behalf.

736
01:51:23.530 --> 01:51:34.300
1000 - Ida Martinac, DLC 744: I would like to incorporate by reference what others have said tonight in support of the small sites program, and would also like to add the following

737
01:51:34.320 --> 01:51:48.999
1000 - Ida Martinac, DLC 744: What kind of mind devises a budgetary, supplemental, pitting vulnerable people in dire need of remaining in their homes against the fire department that we all love and need?

738
01:51:49.400 --> 01:52:08.789
1000 - Ida Martinac, DLC 744: The rationale that Small Sides' program doesn't take advantage of federal funding flies into the face of massive uncertainty in regard to everything coming down from DC at this time. We cannot and should not base our budgetary decisions on any federal monies. This is happening…

739
01:52:09.240 --> 01:52:15.120
1000 - Ida Martinac, DLC 744: at the time when the senior population of the state of California is facing exponentially rising…

740
01:52:15.120 --> 01:52:18.980
Boardroom: Sorry, your time is up, but thank you for your comment. Thank you, Ida.

741
01:52:19.480 --> 01:52:23.339
Boardroom: Our next speaker is Cheryl Davila, former council member.

742
01:52:24.200 --> 01:52:38.680
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: Yeah, so, it's interesting and sad that you would put, an item in that's gonna, take money away.

743
01:52:39.090 --> 01:52:56.099
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: from the… not… well, not good to have a bond issue on the ballot and use the money that you already received for something else that it wasn't intended to do. That's not cool. That's like…

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744
01:52:56.190 --> 01:52:59.509
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: That's… that's really, really bad.

745
01:52:59.810 --> 01:53:03.320
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: And you should have given Makai more time.

746
01:53:03.320 --> 01:53:28.259
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: And also, you need to fund mental health. I went… I was out and about, as I am in Berkeley often, and people that work for the city come up to me and tell me all the crap that goes on in the city, and it's not good. Like, why are you funding the police department so much money? You could take away some of that money and fund

747
01:53:28.260 --> 01:53:29.560
Cheryl Davila, Former Councilmember, Founder CEMTF: Mental health and the mobile.

748
01:53:29.560 --> 01:53:31.109
Boardroom: Great time, Michelle. Thank you.

749
01:53:31.350 --> 01:53:34.860
Boardroom: Our next speaker is Alfred Tu.

750
01:53:38.110 --> 01:53:38.920
Alfred Twu: Hey, can you hear me?

751
01:53:39.890 --> 01:53:40.890
Boardroom: Yes.

752
01:53:40.890 --> 01:53:53.210
Alfred Twu: Great, thank you, everyone. Thank you to the mayor and Councilmember for supporting the small sites. This is a great program, it keeps housing affordable, and it also modernizes and makes it safer and more accessible.

753
01:53:53.310 --> 01:53:59.899
Alfred Twu: The first small-size project, which was on Stewart a few years ago, it turned a vacant building nobody was living in.

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754
01:54:00.070 --> 01:54:04.760
Alfred Twu: Added a wheelchair ramp, made other upgrades, and created new housing.

755
01:54:05.080 --> 01:54:15.620
Alfred Twu: It also saves tenants for, in current buildings, the expense of moving and preserves their community relationships and their state money coming. SBM 1091,

756
01:54:15.760 --> 01:54:25.899
Alfred Twu: which Senator Aragin is a co-author, passed the Senate, and also passed Assembly Housing Committee, where every Democrat voted for it, including our Assembly member, Buffy Wicks.

757
01:54:26.270 --> 01:54:37.290
Alfred Twu: And finally, also want to put in a word for the telegraph car-free. That's been a long time coming, and with thousands more living in Southside, it's long overdue.

758
01:54:37.440 --> 01:54:38.320
Alfred Twu: Thank you.

759
01:54:38.530 --> 01:54:39.760
Boardroom: Thanks, Alfred.

760
01:54:43.130 --> 01:54:44.640
Boardroom: All right.

761
01:54:44.920 --> 01:54:49.490
Boardroom: Next up is Sloan. Sloan, you should be able to speak.

762
01:54:52.800 --> 01:54:54.420
Sloane: Peace Council?

763
01:54:54.550 --> 01:54:57.230
Sloane: My name is Sloan, and I'm with Live Free.

764
01:54:57.420 --> 01:55:10.180
Sloane: I wholeheartedly support the Mayor's proposed budget, including the $200,000 reallocation of Let Free's Gun Violence Intervention and Prevention Program, which will close our funding gap for the fiscal year of 2027.

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765
01:55:10.330 --> 01:55:24.939
Sloane: This work is deeply personal to me. I have seen firsthanded the impact that violence has on individuals, families, and entire communities, and I've also witnessed the power of a community-based intervention, healing, and support to transform lives.

766
01:55:24.940 --> 01:55:40.620
Sloane: We thank the Mayor Ishii and all the council members in advance for your support of our program and your commitment to our community safety. Your investment helps ensure that life-saving work can continue reaching those who need it most. Thank you all for your time and consideration.

767
01:55:40.620 --> 01:55:41.779
Boardroom: Thank you, Sloan.

768
01:55:43.690 --> 01:55:46.069
Boardroom: Alright, Kelly's iPad, you're next.

769
01:55:50.660 --> 01:56:01.289
Kelly’s iPad: Okay, as I go through City Council agendas, meeting after meeting, I see spending on consent rarely questioned.

770
01:56:01.410 --> 01:56:09.089
Kelly’s iPad: It is as if we have endless, unquestioned spending until we get to the budget process, then we are in a crisis.

771
01:56:09.300 --> 01:56:14.790
Kelly’s iPad: This round has put the fire department as a sacrificial lamb to balance the budget.

772
01:56:15.290 --> 01:56:29.280
Kelly’s iPad: The proposal to use U1 funds puts the integrity of the ballot measures to question. As an example given earlier of how new housing is superior to preserving existing housing through small sites.

773
01:56:29.410 --> 01:56:31.319
Kelly’s iPad: The BART housing

774
01:56:31.350 --> 01:56:51.189
Kelly’s iPad: still has not broken ground, and this started in 2018. San Jose makes their program of buying up existing small sites the

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centerpiece of creating affordable housing. There is something wrong with this whole process. We need to preserve our firefighters, paramedics, and small sites program.

775
01:56:51.680 --> 01:56:54.319
Kelly's iPad: Look at our oversight and accountability.

776
01:56:54.320 --> 01:56:55.360
Boardroom: Kelly.

777
01:56:57.730 --> 01:57:01.310
Boardroom: Alright, Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program.

778
01:57:04.920 --> 01:57:15.119
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: Good evening, I should have, 3 minutes, one from Rebecca Webb from the 10-2-1 clerical Chapter, one from Shannon Lee Gallagher, Local 1, and one from Jordan Reamer, Local 1227.

779
01:57:16.930 --> 01:57:21.469
Boardroom: Sorry, give us a minute to… Just a second…

780
01:57:26.230 --> 01:57:29.829
Boardroom: They're in the room. Oh, Rebecca's here. Rebecca in the room.

781
01:57:29.830 --> 01:57:30.789
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: Yeah, they're all in the room.

782
01:57:30.790 --> 01:57:33.879
Boardroom: room… and I'm sorry, who was the third person?

783
01:57:34.050 --> 01:57:35.649
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: Jordan Reamer, Local 1227.

784
01:57:35.820 --> 01:57:37.469
Boardroom: Got it. Alright, thank you.

785
01:57:39.290 --> 01:57:41.970
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: Good evening, Honorable Mayor and members of the City Council.

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786
01:57:42.170 --> 01:57:45.729
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: I'm Justin Pitcher, and the President of Public Employees Union Local 1 asked me.

787
01:57:45.880 --> 01:57:50.859
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: I would like to join you in person this evening, but I'm currently supporting camp operations at Berkeley Tuolumne Camp.

788
01:57:51.500 --> 01:57:57.719
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: I spoke to you during the first reading of the budget, and I'm here tonight as you work to bring a budget over the finish line.

789
01:57:58.000 --> 01:58:14.960
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: I'm grateful for the partnership with City Manager Bootenhagen, Human Resources Director Rodriguez, and the many contributors that got us to where we are in right-sizing our budget, and we are grateful for the roles that we have been able to tentatively find for our impacted members. But that doesn't make tonight's decisions any easier to swallow for our membership.

790
01:58:15.270 --> 01:58:29.989
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: Tonight, I stand in solidarity with my brothers and sisters across all of our bargaining units. While we all fulfill different needs, we live by the one city, one team mantra, and the elimination of any one position tonight will have a rippling effect on the services we render to our community.

791
01:58:30.440 --> 01:58:35.809
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: We understand how we got here, and the need to be fiscally responsible, and the uncertainty of the future.

792
01:58:36.350 --> 01:58:49.480
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: Furthermore, we support the proposals for the preservation of fire services, and Berkeley proposed this evening, but we urge you to bring your commitment to the Street Trauma Prevention Program that you expressed during the first budget reading back to the table in your final adopted budget.

793
01:58:49.900 --> 01:58:51.320
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: Public safety is…

794

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01:58:51.460 --> 01:59:01.280
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: Not just those in uniform providing essential services, it is also the programs that are administered by our small but mighty non-sworn members within the public safety departments.

795
01:59:03.040 --> 01:59:11.370
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: I will reiterate again tonight that programs with pending grant applications for long-term funding should not be eliminated in a short-sighted action.

796
01:59:12.010 --> 01:59:23.990
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: In closing, I don't envy the job that you have to do this evening. No one final adopted budget will fulfill all of the needs of our community, nor will it ensure that all of our members of the city team will be able to feed their families post-layoff.

797
01:59:24.580 --> 01:59:27.120
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: As the uncertainty of the future becomes known.

798
01:59:27.340 --> 01:59:36.089
Justin Pitcher, Recreation Program Supervisor: You have the commitment of Public Employees Union Local 1 asked me to reach amicable solutions for a stable future service model. Thank you for your time.

799
01:59:37.080 --> 01:59:38.500
Boardroom: Thank you.

800
01:59:39.570 --> 01:59:41.560
Boardroom: Live Free California?

801
01:59:43.810 --> 01:59:48.680
Live Free California: Yes, hello, I believe Deborah Gorman's on and is gonna seat her a minute to me.

802
01:59:51.740 --> 01:59:55.289
Boardroom: May I get that name one more time, please? I see Deborah Gore.

803
01:59:55.290 --> 01:59:56.709
Live Free California: Yes, Deborah Gore, yes.

804

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01:59:56.710 --> 01:59:59.979
Boardroom: Okay. It's a purple square.

805
02:00:00.580 --> 02:00:02.719
Boardroom: Kinda near the bottom.

806
02:00:02.970 --> 02:00:07.920
Boardroom: Okay… so… Got it.

807
02:00:10.810 --> 02:00:11.770
Boardroom: Okay.

808
02:00:12.890 --> 02:00:27.979
Live Free California: Thank you. Hello and good evening, Mayor Ishii and Council. My name is Santina, and I am here to speak on behalf of Live Free California and support the Mayor's budget recommendation to use $200,000 from the General Fund to support LIFRI's Community Gun Violence Prevention and Intervention Program.

809
02:00:28.040 --> 02:00:37.739
Live Free California: Although I'm not on the ground myself doing the hard work, I see the impact and importance, how our team provides support to parents, children, and community members who have lost a loved one.

810
02:00:37.900 --> 02:00:51.040
Live Free California: They get calls at 1, 2 AM, without hesitancy, are on location with victims and families, offering support, resources, and a shoulder to cry on. Checking in with victims and families, creating lifelong friendships and trust within the community.

811
02:00:51.080 --> 02:00:59.410
Live Free California: And not just after a tragedy happens, but the prevention work. Going to parks and canvassing schools during the day, making sure kids are in class.

812
02:00:59.480 --> 02:01:03.549
Live Free California: Being part of after-school programs and giving rides after football practices.

813
02:01:03.640 --> 02:01:17.820
Live Free California: Providing training to community members on how to de-escalate conflict and support their families and neighbors. And these are things they were already doing 10, 15, 20 years before Live Free,

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because it is important to them. And I'm not only here in a professional manner, but also personal.

814
02:01:17.980 --> 02:01:20.270
Live Free California: I'm a victim of gun violence myself.

815
02:01:20.420 --> 02:01:32.969
Live Free California: And although those two instances happened almost 15 years ago, they still affect me to this day. Not only physically, but emotionally and mentally. And I thank God I'm still here today and did not lose my life, but so many others are not as fortunate.

816
02:01:33.360 --> 02:01:46.409
Live Free California: If we as a community had access to the resources LIFRI provides, I strongly feel those events that occurred would not have happened, or at least would have been more prepared to deal with those things after the fact. I would have been supported and confident in moving forward in my life.

817
02:01:46.430 --> 02:01:57.650
Live Free California: These programs are a necessity, not a luxury. And I know how important our Live Free Team is to the community, and how they are changing lives for the better on a daily basis, and I'm proud to be a part of this organization.

818
02:01:57.830 --> 02:02:02.779
Live Free California: I want to thank you all in advance for supporting Live Free and protecting Berkeley. Long live Todd Walker.

819
02:02:04.870 --> 02:02:08.020
Boardroom: Thanks for your comment and for sharing your story.

820
02:02:09.790 --> 02:02:11.740
Boardroom: Next speaker is Moni.

821
02:02:15.270 --> 02:02:19.429
Moni: Hi, this is Moni Gangopathai, I'm a resident of District 1.

822
02:02:19.620 --> 02:02:24.990
Moni: I would urge the City Council, to…

823
02:02:26.490 --> 02:02:34.599

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Moni: Keep Measure 1, U1 small sites funds for the purpose that voters intended, consistent with Mayor Ishii's recommendation.

824
02:02:34.870 --> 02:02:42.130
Moni: The supplemental proposal itself enumerates the successful projects achieved through the Measure U1 funds.

825
02:02:42.520 --> 02:02:56.879
Moni: Reallocating small site funds that voters overwhelmingly supported for a second time erodes the public trust and shifts funds away from guaranteed applications for affordable housing and homelessness services.

826
02:02:57.310 --> 02:03:08.799
Moni: It also undermines the important work of our community land trusts, some of which we've heard today, and ignores the recommendation of the city's own housing experts on the Housing Advisory Commission.

827
02:03:09.370 --> 02:03:13.849
Moni: While the concern for underfunded new affordable housing projects may be valid.

828
02:03:14.010 --> 02:03:17.020
Moni: The proposed reallocation suggests a false conflict.

829
02:03:17.020 --> 02:03:18.830
Boardroom: Good morning. Thanks.

830
02:03:19.860 --> 02:03:22.339
Boardroom: All right, Catherine Day?

831
02:03:26.410 --> 02:03:27.679
kathrynday: Okay, can you hear me?

832
02:03:28.130 --> 02:03:28.740
Boardroom: Yes.

833
02:03:29.040 --> 02:03:44.580
kathrynday: My name's Catherine Day. I live in District 8. I'm calling in to support Mayor Rushi's proposed budget. I'm here to stand for the Small Sites Program and for affordable housing.

834
02:03:44.640 --> 02:03:53.680

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kathrynday: for, keeping faith with the voters by, honoring the promises made to the voters with the U1 measure.

835
02:03:54.430 --> 02:04:07.990
kathrynday: I'm in support of preserving housing. I currently live in a dilapidated apartment building with another educator, with a student, with a,

836
02:04:08.100 --> 02:04:20.700
kathrynday: I'm with a museum worker, and we live the reality of the dilapidated housing, which needs… which needs preserving, which needs renewing, which needs renovating.

837
02:04:22.390 --> 02:04:30.880
kathrynday: So, prevent displacement before it happens, absolutely, and please do not claw back the $1.3 million.

838
02:04:30.880 --> 02:04:31.530
Boardroom: Thank you.

839
02:04:31.530 --> 02:04:32.140
kathrynday: Here.

840
02:04:32.140 --> 02:04:33.190
Boardroom: Thank you.

841
02:04:35.120 --> 02:04:38.570
Boardroom: All right, next speaker is Linda Olivenbaum.

842
02:04:39.040 --> 02:04:46.900
Linda Olivenbaum: Hello, good evening. I urge you not to reallocate Measure U1 funding to fill gaps in the upcoming city budget.

843
02:04:47.130 --> 02:04:58.010
Linda Olivenbaum: Measure U1 was passed overwhelmingly by Berkeley voters to support truly affordable housing, and that is the only purpose for which its funds should be used.

844
02:04:58.150 --> 02:05:07.480
Linda Olivenbaum: Reallocating its funding only increases the skepticism and distrust among voters who see it as a bait-and-switch by the council.

845

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02:05:07.720 --> 02:05:27.369
Linda Olivenbaum: Providing funding towards purchasing existing affordable housing is cost-effective, keeps people in their homes, and preserves the income diversity that still exists in Berkeley, even though this diversity is under severe strain. Please keep the small site's funding in the city budget. Thank you.

846
02:05:27.370 --> 02:05:28.360
Boardroom: Thanks, Linda.

847
02:05:30.960 --> 02:05:32.780
Boardroom: Leo Goldberg?

848
02:05:36.350 --> 02:05:47.969
Leo Goldberg: Hi, good afternoon, or good evening, Mayor and Council Members. My name's Leo Goldberg, born and raised in Berkeley, and I research gentrification and anti-displacement strategies.

849
02:05:48.120 --> 02:06:05.060
Leo Goldberg: And programs like small sites are the best way of addressing displacement pressures, both in Berkeley and elsewhere. If we're serious about maintaining our racial and economic diversity, we need to maintain funding for small sites and capacity building funding for

850
02:06:05.060 --> 02:06:10.389
Leo Goldberg: groups that use small sites, so I urge the Council to maintain funding for the program. Thank you.

851
02:06:11.150 --> 02:06:12.219
Boardroom: Thank you.

852
02:06:14.240 --> 02:06:15.570
Boardroom: Steven Barton?

853
02:06:21.840 --> 02:06:28.210
Stephen Barton: Hello, I'm Dr. Steven Barton, former Housing Director for the City of Berkeley, now retired.

854
02:06:28.720 --> 02:06:35.580
Stephen Barton: I want to speak in favor of the Small Sites Program and Capacity Building for Preservation Organizations.

855

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02:06:35.880 --> 02:06:58.379
Stephen Barton: Yesterday, the governor of California announced that there will be a multi-billion dollar bond measure for affordable housing that will include $500 million for preservation. So there will be matching funds, but if you defund Berkeley's preservation program, Berkeley will not be able to access that funding.

856
02:06:58.890 --> 02:07:18.799
Stephen Barton: Second, anybody who thinks that rent stabilization and good cause for eviction, despite all our protections, is enough to protect tenants when a new landlord comes in and decides that they want to push people out, is not paying attention to what is actually happening in the city of Berkeley.

857
02:07:18.970 --> 02:07:24.720
Stephen Barton: And, of course, eventually, people do move out, and if they've been…

858
02:07:24.720 --> 02:07:28.420
Boardroom: Steven, sorry, your time's up. Thanks for your comment.

859
02:07:30.540 --> 02:07:33.690
Boardroom: Alright, next up, Grayson Savoy.

860
02:07:36.470 --> 02:07:37.660
Grayson Savoie: Hello, can you all hear me?

861
02:07:38.770 --> 02:07:39.640
Boardroom: Yes.

862
02:07:40.460 --> 02:07:58.279
Grayson Savoie: My name is Grayson Savoy, I'm a current UC Berkeley graduate and one of the founding members of Telegraph People, speaking in support of Mayor Ishii's supplemental budget. I want to thank the Mayor and Council for recommending over $1.3 million in funding to study and design a car-free telegraph Avenue in Southside. Today, Telegraph is failing to reach its full potential.

863
02:07:58.280 --> 02:08:01.280
Grayson Savoie: Telegraph is an ideal location for pedestrianization.

864
02:08:01.280 --> 02:08:16.360
Grayson Savoie: The second busiest pedestrian area in the East Bay, at the foot of the world's best public university, and in a neighborhood

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where the vast majority of residents do not own a car. Yet, the current design of the roadway does not reflect the mobility needs of residents or support the City of Berkeley's climate, traffic safety, or equity goals.

865
02:08:16.430 --> 02:08:27.159
Grayson Savoie: A new roadway is long overdue. Today, pedestrians bump shoulders on crowded sidewalks, buses stall behind double-parked cars, and visitors dangerously traverse through noisy, smelly, and uninviting public realm.

866
02:08:27.470 --> 02:08:39.909
Grayson Savoie: A pedestrian-eyed telegraph will not only make it safer for all road users to move around, it will reinvigorate the street, turning the historic heart of Berkeley into a world-class destination. For decades, plans to explore Carfree Telegraph have come and gone, getting passed on and forgotten.

867
02:08:39.910 --> 02:08:41.500
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks, Grayson.

868
02:08:44.720 --> 02:08:46.340
Boardroom: Next is Bach.

869
02:08:50.850 --> 02:08:52.040
Voc: Hello, can you hear me?

870
02:08:52.560 --> 02:08:53.280
Boardroom: Yes.

871
02:08:53.990 --> 02:09:11.690
Voc: Yep. Hi, my name is DeBon Banks, and I'm in support of the Mayor's proposed budget, which includes a reallocation to live free for gun violence intervention program in the amount of $200K, which will close our funding gap for the fiscal year of 2027. We give

872
02:09:12.340 --> 02:09:26.299
Voc: Mayor Isi and the council members in advance, we thank Mayor Isi and the council members in advance for your vote and support of our program, and my personal story that's tied to this, this vote in support.

873
02:09:26.300 --> 02:09:44.970
Voc: is I am a, affected by gun violence, and with last year's budget, it has now enabled a place like Live Free to employ me, to help me and my family, and present recidivism. I do not want to return back to prison.

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874
02:09:45.130 --> 02:09:53.840
Voc: With a job like this, this has really helped me and my family, get back on the right track, and so I am in major support of it.

875
02:09:53.840 --> 02:09:57.340
Boardroom: Thank you. Thanks, Mark. Thanks for your comment. Thank you.

876
02:09:57.520 --> 02:09:59.620
Boardroom: Next up is Tim Frank.

877
02:10:02.790 --> 02:10:04.360
Tim Frank: Hello, can you hear me?

878
02:10:04.680 --> 02:10:05.300
Boardroom: Yes.

879
02:10:05.520 --> 02:10:09.689
Tim Frank: Terrific, thank you very much. So, my name is Tim Frank, and I am representing the…

880
02:10:09.700 --> 02:10:18.529
Tim Frank: the, Building and Construction Trades Council of Alameda County. We supported, Measure U1 and,

881
02:10:18.530 --> 02:10:30.189
Tim Frank: I participated in the committee that wrote and, managed the ballot measure committee campaign to promote that, that,

882
02:10:30.510 --> 02:10:38.229
Tim Frank: Measure, and we're really proud of the projects that have been funded by it, including the,

883
02:10:38.540 --> 02:10:46.660
Tim Frank: the project on Berkeley Way for, formerly homeless, and, people at risk of homelessness, it's…

884
02:10:46.660 --> 02:11:05.769
Tim Frank: managed by the Berkeley Food and Housing Project, paid for by… substantially by U1 funding, but also leveraged with a variety of other state, local, and federal funding. And at this point, there is still more

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funding available to leverage that kind of work, that new construction work.

885
02:11:05.770 --> 02:11:06.270
Boardroom: Thank you.

886
02:11:06.270 --> 02:11:07.510
Tim Frank: There is for the small site.

887
02:11:07.510 --> 02:11:10.010
Boardroom: Kim, thanks, your time's up. Thank you.

888
02:11:11.490 --> 02:11:13.629
Boardroom: Next up is Jeff.

889
02:11:17.490 --> 02:11:22.580
Jef (he/him/they/them): Hello, thank you very much. My name's Jeffrey Melcher, 1139 Addison Street.

890
02:11:22.690 --> 02:11:23.600
Boardroom: Louder.

891
02:11:24.450 --> 02:11:25.310
Jef (he/him/they/them): We can hear you, right?

892
02:11:27.950 --> 02:11:31.400
Boardroom: We can't quite hear you, Jeff, but you've got 49 seconds left.

893
02:11:31.630 --> 02:11:37.769
Jef (he/him/they/them): speak up. I want to say, in District 2, I want to thank Steven Barton, I support

894
02:11:38.030 --> 02:11:42.950
Jef (he/him/they/them): Mayor's Budget, U1 was voter approved.

895
02:11:43.100 --> 02:11:48.619
Jef (he/him/they/them): I'm curious how it's even legal to move that money and refund it into different places?

896
02:11:49.250 --> 02:11:54.160

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Jef (he/him/they/them): But I support the small sites funding project as well. Thank you very much.

897
02:11:55.850 --> 02:11:56.940
Boardroom: Thank you.

898
02:11:59.180 --> 02:12:00.740
Boardroom: Cantrell Killings?

899
02:12:03.160 --> 02:12:09.540
Kentrell Killens: Good evening. I'm Carol Killings from Live Free. We're here in support of the Mayor's allocation of $200,000.

900
02:12:09.830 --> 02:12:14.050
Kentrell Killens: To close our funding gap for fiscal year 2027.

901
02:12:14.310 --> 02:12:17.640
Kentrell Killens: I'm here to represent on behalf of the marginalized community.

902
02:12:17.790 --> 02:12:34.830
Kentrell Killens: Those who are the voiceless as a part of this conversation, those who are trying to stabilize their lives after traumatic experiences, to the young people that we work with that are not yet involved in issues of violence or gangs or anything of that nature, where we're doing intervention work to try to prevent them

903
02:12:34.970 --> 02:12:54.530
Kentrell Killens: from entering to systems that, frankly, don't care about them. I'll speak on behalf of individuals who I met with yesterday in Santa Rita Jail, who are returning to their community in Berkeley, after serving their time and looking to reestablish themselves as productive citizens. We provide that pathway. We provide the important work that makes that happen.

904
02:12:54.530 --> 02:12:56.750
Kentrell Killens: And we represent on behalf of everyone

905
02:12:56.810 --> 02:13:07.600
Kentrell Killens: Who is wasteless in this moment. We really want the support of the, Council, in support of the mayor's allocation, in support of the mayor's budget, and we want to continue to do this work on behalf of…

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906
02:13:07.600 --> 02:13:10.100
Boardroom: Sorry, your time is up, but thank you for your comment.

907
02:13:10.480 --> 02:13:12.290
Boardroom: Cameron Wu, you're next.

908
02:13:22.920 --> 02:13:26.059
Cameron Woo: Hello, I'm Cameron Wu, and I'm a member of

909
02:13:26.730 --> 02:13:31.119
Cameron Woo: I'm a resident of Berkeley and a resident of District 2.

910
02:13:31.680 --> 02:13:39.200
Cameron Woo: I'm a member of the… Civic Arts Commission, but I am here tonight speaking only for myself.

911
02:13:39.480 --> 02:13:44.870
Cameron Woo: I would ask the mayor and the State Council to consider freezing the position of

912
02:13:45.000 --> 02:13:51.689
Cameron Woo: the Chief Officer of Cultural Affairs in the Civic Arts Department, and those extraordinary skills that come with it.

913
02:13:52.280 --> 02:13:56.450
Cameron Woo: And not eliminating the position and those very unique skills.

914
02:13:57.010 --> 02:13:59.459
Cameron Woo: Thank you for your time and your dedication.

915
02:14:00.840 --> 02:14:02.030
Boardroom: Thank you, Cameron.

916
02:14:04.040 --> 02:14:05.460
Boardroom: Tawana Grant?

917
02:14:09.530 --> 02:14:20.320
Tawana Grant: Hi, I'm speaking on behalf of Live Free. We wholeheartedly support the Mayor's proposed budget, which includes a reallocation to Live Free, the gun violence inter…

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918
02:14:20.420 --> 02:14:29.609
Tawana Grant: And prevention program in the amount of $200,000, which will close our funding gap in the fiscal year 2027.

919
02:14:29.610 --> 02:14:40.719
Tawana Grant: We give thanks to Mayor Ishii and all council members in advance for your vote and support to our program. I am a mother, healing from

920
02:14:40.930 --> 02:14:56.580
Tawana Grant: My son being killed. Live Free has been there to support me and my four daughters and grandson 100% along the way. Without them, I don't know what I would have done. There's, like, a lot of things that people do not know about.

921
02:14:56.770 --> 02:15:12.349
Tawana Grant: And they opened the, you know, avenues for people to get knowledge on what to do, how to go about it. I just recently was at San Pablo Park Saturday, seeing over 2,000 kids, at an unprovoked, meetup that.

922
02:15:12.350 --> 02:15:15.840
Boardroom: Thank you, Tawana. I'm sorry, your time is up, but thank you for your comment.

923
02:15:17.890 --> 02:15:20.130
Boardroom: Next is Good Brother Network.

924
02:15:22.790 --> 02:15:37.630
Good Brotha Network: Hello, Mayor Ishii. My name is Londell Porter. I'm an Implementation Specialist with Live Free California. I'm in full support of the, budget for reallocation for our program to keep saving lives in the city of Berkeley. And I see my turn in. Thank you.

925
02:15:38.220 --> 02:15:39.240
Boardroom: Thank you.

926
02:15:41.990 --> 02:15:49.539
Boardroom: Alright, and one more time, caller ending with the number 405.

927
02:15:51.070 --> 02:16:09.530

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1510****405: Hi, Derek, and I heard a homeowner in Berkeley, like, tuning in to say, no flock, and no tent, and 3.25% sales tax. We have to find a different, a better way. Thank you.

928
02:16:10.050 --> 02:16:11.040
Boardroom: Thank you.

929
02:16:11.870 --> 02:16:16.260
Boardroom: Alright, those are all the callers that are online. We're gonna take a 15-minute break and come back.

930
02:16:45.750 --> 02:16:52.379
Boardroom: Okay, hi everyone, we're back in session. Thank you very much for your patience. I really appreciate the time.

931
02:16:52.450 --> 02:17:06.530
Boardroom: I'm gonna make a friendly amendment to, the motion that's on the floor. A few different things. One, the Downtown Berkeley Revitalization Project, let me put this up, actually, on the screen.

932
02:17:09.230 --> 02:17:13.399
Boardroom: The Downtown Berkeley Revitalization Project… there it is.

933
02:17:13.690 --> 02:17:17.480
Boardroom: The amount should actually be 2.8.

934
02:17:17.500 --> 02:17:34.200
Boardroom: And that's because $100,000 is already going toward… is already set aside for this, so it's just a numbers… a number being incorrect. Additionally, I'd like to make a friendly amendment to include the 5 firefighter

935
02:17:34.200 --> 02:17:48.499
Boardroom: 3 paramedic positions on here, with funding, oh, as well as the inspector position. Oh, that was already on there. And, that would come from the increased annual ambulance transport revenue.

936
02:17:48.510 --> 02:17:54.909
Boardroom: As well as a position from the City Clerk's Office Which is currently vacant.

937
02:17:55.170 --> 02:17:58.670
Boardroom: And that would prevent us from using any U1 funding.

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938
02:17:59.219 --> 02:18:08.520
Boardroom: And, there was additional general fund revenue, which is not part of U1, just to be clear, and that would also go towards those positions.

939
02:18:08.670 --> 02:18:10.969
Boardroom: So that's my friendly amendment.

940
02:18:11.360 --> 02:18:13.779
Boardroom: Accepted. Seconded.

941
02:18:14.010 --> 02:18:17.629
Boardroom: So, I also just want to make it clear that

942
02:18:19.219 --> 02:18:32.860
Boardroom: I'm very concerned about making this decision, that I'm really worried about our financial situation in November, and I understand that this decision is going to make some folks really upset, because there are many positions that are being cut in the city.

943
02:18:33.160 --> 02:18:42.740
Boardroom: And I recognize that we've had conversations with some of the other unions and folks who are… will be upset by this decision, and I really just want to say I'm sorry.

944
02:18:43.150 --> 02:18:45.959
Boardroom: And…

945
02:18:46.120 --> 02:19:04.059
Boardroom: So, this is the current motion that's on the floor, and I want to allow my Council colleagues to make comments now, starting with Councilmember Kesarwani. Thank you very much, Madam Mayor, for those amendments. I, I want to thank all of the public commenters.

946
02:19:04.129 --> 02:19:19.920
Boardroom: And, you know, I know there's a lot of varying views, and I was listening to all of you, and I do just want to clarify this issue of U1, this Measure U1 funding that we heard a lot about in public comment.

947
02:19:19.959 --> 02:19:30.119
Boardroom: It was passed by voters in 2016, and it is a general fund tax, meaning it can be used for any general purpose.

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948
02:19:30.379 --> 02:19:38.540
Boardroom: And folks in the public comment were talking, I think, about the language of the ballot measure and how it was

949
02:19:39.379 --> 02:19:44.829
Boardroom: you know, sold, so to speak, to the voters. And so if we go back to that language…

950
02:19:45.219 --> 02:19:50.220
Boardroom: We see that the ballot language stated that the funding would be used for, quote.

951
02:19:50.500 --> 02:19:57.879
Boardroom: Funding and programs to increase affordable housing and protect Berkeley residents from homelessness.

952
02:19:58.310 --> 02:20:02.210
Boardroom: So… this 200,000

953
02:20:02.460 --> 02:20:16.410
Boardroom: that is proposed to come from Measure U1 funding, that is general fund, to be used for this so-called… I'm saying so-called because it's a little bit of a vague term, but this capacity building for small developers.

954
02:20:16.550 --> 02:20:34.600
Boardroom: This is not increasing affordable housing, and it is not protecting Berkeley residents from homelessness. Capacity building for small developers involves funding for staff development to increase technical knowledge and skills, and there's other… other…

955
02:20:35.010 --> 02:20:51.310
Boardroom: tasks or activities that can be funded. It's all about staff development for a developer. So I just want to say, if we're gonna follow the letter of the measure, and what it said, and try to stick to that, we have not stuck to that.

956
02:20:51.700 --> 02:21:04.930
Boardroom: And we can't stick to that when we have a $30 million deficit. I did lead the effort last time to redirect $1.4 million of general fund revenue that happened to come from Measure U1

957

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02:21:05.060 --> 02:21:11.250
Boardroom: To deal with the deficit, So, nothing that I proposed was…

958
02:21:11.450 --> 02:21:14.770
Boardroom: Was bad governance or in bad faith?

959
02:21:15.170 --> 02:21:18.529
Boardroom: I, I think what I did was exactly what…

960
02:21:18.840 --> 02:21:26.980
Boardroom: the measure is intended to do. It is a general fund tax. So, I did say that we would use $200,000 from that

961
02:21:27.070 --> 02:21:34.540
Boardroom: measure to help fund the fire inspector, but I, I, I, I am fine with

962
02:21:34.560 --> 02:21:51.070
Boardroom: and I was going to propose this before the mayor did, to take that off the table, because if people feel like they don't want to use Measure U1 for fire positions, that's fine with me. You know, I want to work in the spirit of compromise to land this tonight, so that's fine. I…

963
02:21:51.070 --> 02:21:56.880
Boardroom: think that I am a little bit nervous about taking from the Assistant City Clerk.

964
02:21:57.080 --> 02:22:03.129
Boardroom: position, because what I proposed did not take from another department

965
02:22:03.250 --> 02:22:07.499
Boardroom: to fund positions in the fire department, and that was very intentional.

966
02:22:07.620 --> 02:22:08.790
Boardroom: So…

967
02:22:09.200 --> 02:22:27.469
Boardroom: I would actually propose that we don't do that, and that we use the increased ambulance response revenue instead, and keep that position in the city clerk's office, because that city clerk's office has not added positions, but their workload has increased.

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968
02:22:27.580 --> 02:22:30.410
Boardroom: So, so I'm just stating that now.

969
02:22:30.660 --> 02:22:43.670
Boardroom: And then I also want to propose… so that would be my alteration. I'm going to make a substitute motion, so… so that's a piece of the substitute motion. And then on small sites, I didn't hear any give on that.

970
02:22:43.770 --> 02:22:50.000
Boardroom: I want to propose a compromise as it relates to small sites. I hear that people

971
02:22:50.370 --> 02:23:01.329
Boardroom: want to invest in this model, so I want to offer that we leave the $2.5 million that has already been put out to bid for small sites for that purpose.

972
02:23:01.430 --> 02:23:09.310
Boardroom: I am not convinced that that isn't enough funding to do an acquisition. Mr. White, can you update us on

973
02:23:09.570 --> 02:23:22.640
Boardroom: the inquiries that have been made as it relates to that RFP, my understanding is there are parties that are looking at this funding and are trying to see if they can, make use of it.

974
02:23:23.170 --> 02:23:25.339
Boardroom: Councilmember, I think,

975
02:23:25.850 --> 02:23:34.869
Boardroom: Housing Community Services Manager Margo Ernst is online and could speak to that with a little bit more detail. Okay, can we have her do that?

976
02:23:40.290 --> 02:23:49.329
Margot Ernst: Yes, hello, good evening, mayor and members of the Council… sorry, I'm trying to turn my camera on.

977
02:23:55.120 --> 02:24:00.660
Margot Ernst: Yeah, I'm… I'm happy to answer the question to the best of my ability. We…

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978
02:24:00.810 --> 02:24:06.949
Margot Ernst: from what we understand, there are, certainly both land trusts, I think, are…

979
02:24:07.280 --> 02:24:20.819
Margot Ernst: are seeking and or pursuing properties. The one that I'm aware of is… is a property that, is about 23 units and would… would require more funding than the $2.5 million.

980
02:24:23.370 --> 02:24:32.329
Boardroom: Okay. Alright, so there's still an exploration. Do we know when is the deadline for that, for respondents to submit for that RFP?

981
02:24:33.320 --> 02:24:45.869
Margot Ernst: I mean, it's just open… it can just stay open, we would just need to make sure we have the funding still, you know, carrying forward in the budget. Okay. But it could stay open.

982
02:24:45.870 --> 02:24:47.170
Boardroom: It could stay open.

983
02:24:47.170 --> 02:24:47.940
Margot Ernst: Yeah.

984
02:24:47.940 --> 02:24:53.569
Boardroom: If there is a possibility of acquiring properties as small as 5 units.

985
02:24:53.640 --> 02:24:57.620
Boardroom: up to 25 units. I believe that that $2.5 million

986
02:24:57.660 --> 02:25:13.059
Boardroom: could be viable. And so, I want to propose that that can stay with small sites, but that this $1.3 million that is unallocated in the housing trust fund remain there for new affordable housing. So, with that, I'd like to make a substitute motion

987
02:25:13.060 --> 02:25:21.859
Boardroom: that builds on everything the mayor just proposed with the amendments, with the exception of taking off the assistant city clerk.

988

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02:25:22.120 --> 02:25:25.180
Boardroom: And actually, I can share screen to show this.

989
02:25:26.000 --> 02:25:31.699
Boardroom: Hang on, let me… So, just to be clear, so…

990
02:25:32.580 --> 02:25:35.359
Boardroom: You wanna stay… you wanna keep…

991
02:25:35.470 --> 02:25:40.880
Boardroom: the U1 funding in here. No, let me share my screen and show my substitute motion.

992
02:25:42.300 --> 02:25:45.479
Boardroom: Okay, so can you all see that? I can make it bigger.

993
02:25:50.390 --> 02:25:54.179
Boardroom: Is that good? Yup. Okay, so…

994
02:25:54.530 --> 02:26:06.319
Boardroom: So, yeah, we… if folks are interested in not having U1 be used as a funding source, I have strucken that out, but I… I don't support

995
02:26:06.490 --> 02:26:08.779
Boardroom: Taking from the city clerk's office.

996
02:26:09.090 --> 02:26:20.050
Boardroom: I have talked to the city manager, and we will likely be receiving more increased ambulance transport revenue, so I've just put the $200,000 there. It doesn't change any of the totals.

997
02:26:20.050 --> 02:26:29.119
Boardroom: So that allows us to continue to fund those 9.0 positions, and then the compromise on small sites appears below.

998
02:26:29.120 --> 02:26:34.390
Boardroom: That we would keep the $2.5 million and,

999
02:26:34.440 --> 02:26:41.940
Boardroom: leave the $1.3 million in the Housing Trust Fund, and so that is my substitute motion for the budget. Second.

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1000
02:26:42.120 --> 02:26:57.939
Boardroom: So, if there is an additional $200,000 in the ambulance fund, Mr. City Manager, then I would also like to make a friendly amendment to ours to have that funding instead of the City Clerk's position.

1001
02:26:58.110 --> 02:26:59.340
Boardroom: accepted.

1002
02:26:59.870 --> 02:27:01.649
Boardroom: Second or accept.

1003
02:27:02.390 --> 02:27:14.069
Boardroom: So, the only difference here would be that in yours, you would be taking money from small sites. Is that correct, Councilmember? Yes, I want to keep $1.3 million in the Housing Trust Fund.

1004
02:27:14.420 --> 02:27:19.299
Boardroom: And I thank you for accepting all of the other proposals I've put forward.

1005
02:27:19.570 --> 02:27:27.549
Boardroom: Okay, so there's a second and a motion. Do we want to have discussion on this, or should we just… let's keep going.

1006
02:27:27.730 --> 02:27:32.860
Boardroom: Okay, so, Councilmember Blackaby? Thank you, Madam Mayor.

1007
02:27:33.350 --> 02:27:48.290
Boardroom: In the understatement of the year, I do, want to acknowledge that we all know this is a difficult budget. We all know it reflects really hard decisions that will have real impacts on residents, on staff, on real people.

1008
02:27:48.390 --> 02:27:53.650
Boardroom: I want to thank all of our labor partners for their advocacy leading up to tonight.

1009
02:27:53.710 --> 02:28:11.140
Boardroom: For their outreach, for being here tonight. I want to thank city staff for all the hard work in getting us to this point. I want to thank the public for being here. I want to thank the mayor for her draft and her updated, proposal, and I want to thank my colleague, Councilmember Kastarwani, for her supplemental.

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1010
02:28:11.210 --> 02:28:15.929
Boardroom: To address our structural deficit and put the city on a sustainable path.

1011
02:28:16.160 --> 02:28:23.899
Boardroom: We know we need to make significant reductions, including the loss of valued staff positions and the elimination of unfilled positions.

1012
02:28:24.360 --> 02:28:35.960
Boardroom: I'm both proud of the work we have done, but also extremely mindful of the sacrifices that these decisions require. We've made substantial progress, but our work is not finished.

1013
02:28:36.170 --> 02:28:45.400
Boardroom: Looking ahead, as we've discussed tonight, we know we may face significant additional challenges if local funding measures fail or if state and federal funding is reduced.

1014
02:28:45.730 --> 02:28:51.659
Boardroom: I remain committed to finding creative ways to strengthen our finances, especially on the top line.

1015
02:28:51.820 --> 02:28:56.110
Boardroom: The revenue side, approving efficiency and supporting economic growth.

1016
02:28:56.360 --> 02:29:07.050
Boardroom: I'm hopeful that a stronger local economy will help generate the revenue growth we need in the years ahead. And I'll say, kind of by way of sidebar, just a conversation I had today.

1017
02:29:07.080 --> 02:29:26.829
Boardroom: Just today I was meeting with a high-tech company, a clean tech company, a startup that's considering locating here in Berkeley, because they want to be part of the ecosystem and all of the innovation that's happening here in Berkeley. And I think as a city council, as a city, we need to be doing more of that. We need to be bringing these sort of businesses to Berkeley.

1018
02:29:26.830 --> 02:29:37.800
Boardroom: that's a way of generating revenue without increasing fees or taxes at all. It's moving more economic output through the pipeline, and

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I think there's a lot of opportunity to do more of that, and I'm excited by that prospect.

1019
02:29:37.800 --> 02:29:54.400
Boardroom: On the discussion we've been having about the supplemental, I want to be really clear that, you know, we've heard a lot about pitting fire versus small sites, or fire versus housing, and that's a false choice. That is not what's happening here tonight.

1020
02:29:54.400 --> 02:30:00.979
Boardroom: We're working on two separate issues in one budget at the same time, in different parts of the budget.

1021
02:30:01.030 --> 02:30:04.649
Boardroom: We're talking about how to optimize what we're doing in the Housing Trust Fund.

1022
02:30:04.720 --> 02:30:19.579
Boardroom: and we're talking about optimizing what we're doing in the general fund. I think, and then Councilmember Kastarwani, Councilmember Taplin, I think most of us think, we deserve and can provide robust public safety services to all residents, police and fire.

1023
02:30:19.770 --> 02:30:34.440
Boardroom: And we can do that out of the general fund. We've identified ways of doing that better. And I also think we can look for the biggest bang for the proverbial buck on affordable housing. Those two things are doable. They are not in competition with one another.

1024
02:30:34.440 --> 02:30:41.710
Boardroom: As a matter of fact, we're not taking money from housing. On the contrary, what Councilmember Casawani and others have proposed is trying to get the most

1025
02:30:41.820 --> 02:30:47.209
Boardroom: out of those limited resources. As a matter of fact, we don't want to spend less on affordable housing.

1026
02:30:47.300 --> 02:30:49.659
Boardroom: We want to spend more.

1027
02:30:49.700 --> 02:31:02.460
Boardroom: If you consider the dollars that we're talking about putting on the table and the match from state and federal funding, we're

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proposing spending more on affordable housing here in Berkeley in the Kesarwani proposal. And I want to be clear about that.

1028
02:31:02.480 --> 02:31:11.959
Boardroom: So I appreciate everything that the land trusts are doing, the small sites are doing. The residents in those properties are benefiting from that impressive work.

1029
02:31:12.150 --> 02:31:20.020
Boardroom: But we do have limited funds across the board, and we need to decide how best to scale these limited resources.

1030
02:31:20.120 --> 02:31:23.870
Boardroom: So here is the choice that Councilmember Cassarwani is offering.

1031
02:31:24.380 --> 02:31:26.240
Boardroom: We can preserve

1032
02:31:26.540 --> 02:31:32.350
Boardroom: a smaller number of existing units, and I, again, I think that's valuable, but I'm just saying this is the choice.

1033
02:31:32.490 --> 02:31:37.719
Boardroom: Or creating, adding, and developing a larger number of new units.

1034
02:31:37.900 --> 02:31:41.230
Boardroom: With the same money. That's the choice that's being presented.

1035
02:31:42.250 --> 02:31:44.140
Boardroom: That's the choice that's being presented.

1036
02:31:45.920 --> 02:31:53.770
Boardroom: You can disagree with that, but that's the policy decision. That's a policy discussion. This is not pitting one against the other, this is saying.

1037
02:31:53.970 --> 02:32:02.369
Boardroom: That's a policy choice for the council and for this community. Would we want to preserve housing with those $3.8 million, or now the $1.3 million? Or do we want to

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1038
02:32:02.370 --> 02:32:15.070
Boardroom: match that money and use that to provide more affordable housing. The Council will vote, we'll decide, but that's the choice. It's not saying we want less affordable housing, it's how do we provide as much affordable housing as we can. On the public safety front.

1039
02:32:15.390 --> 02:32:17.459
Boardroom: As a representative of District 6.

1040
02:32:18.080 --> 02:32:22.110
Boardroom: It's the highest, area of fire risk in the city, as we all know.

1041
02:32:22.180 --> 02:32:30.450
Boardroom: Nothing is more important to me than public safety. After we went through the whole debate and discussion about Ember.

1042
02:32:30.450 --> 02:32:44.400
Boardroom: and we're asking residents in District 6 and across the city to do their part to provide fire safety. We need to make sure the city's doing their part. That's why I appreciate what the mayor has offered. Councilor, you can have one of my minutes. I appreciate that, I'm almost done.

1043
02:32:44.480 --> 02:32:56.680
Boardroom: I appreciate the fact that we're stepping up on that, because if we're asking residents to do their part, the city needs to do their part and provide the kind of public service we need, the kind of fire safety that we need. I wish we could have done a little bit more.

1044
02:32:56.680 --> 02:33:16.570
Boardroom: On both the police and the fire side, but I'm comfortable that, like, we've done a lot, and depending on how revenues trend in the months ahead, we can come back and look at that again. So, anyway, I appreciate the discussion. I just wanted to clarify a little bit about how I think some of us are thinking about this up here.

1045
02:33:16.670 --> 02:33:19.379
Boardroom: And it's not… it's not about…

1046
02:33:19.530 --> 02:33:38.990
Boardroom: not caring about affordable housing, it's like, what do we… what do we think is the best choice to get more affordable housing here? That's really the question. And it's not pitting one against the other,

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it's not pitting fire against housing, it's saying, how can we get more public safety, and what's the best use of those limited dollars to get the most affordable housing we can? So with that, I appreciate,

1047
02:33:38.990 --> 02:33:43.630
Boardroom: Councilmember Kesterwani's proposal, I support, the supplemental. Thank you.

1048
02:33:44.920 --> 02:33:47.319
Boardroom: Thank you. Vice Mayor Treykov.

1049
02:33:48.350 --> 02:34:00.350
Boardroom: And just, sorry, just so you know, Vice Mayor Trega, Councilmember Humbert, Councilmember Taplin, and then Councilmember Lunopara, because, just so the folks online know, I can still see you. And then Councilmember Bartlett, after.

1050
02:34:01.920 --> 02:34:09.700
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor. The last several months have been nothing short of heart-wrenching for so many of us.

1051
02:34:10.600 --> 02:34:30.409
Boardroom: And I want to extend my sincere gratitude to, city administration, to my colleagues, to our mayor, to the city manager, to Deputy White, Budget Manager Dupaiah, and their team, and all city staff and labor partners for approaching this budget.

1052
02:34:30.630 --> 02:34:37.959
Boardroom: Early on, with transparency, honesty, and integrity, worthy of the city we serve.

1053
02:34:38.300 --> 02:34:42.860
Boardroom: It has been and will continue to be some of the most difficult times

1054
02:34:43.620 --> 02:34:45.790
Boardroom: To which to lead the city.

1055
02:34:46.810 --> 02:34:50.019
Boardroom: And the only way we can do it is together.

1056
02:34:50.370 --> 02:34:52.810
Boardroom: I also want to thank all of our…

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1057
02:34:53.120 --> 02:35:01.209
Boardroom: Community partners, residents, and the public who are doing the work in our community.

1058
02:35:01.320 --> 02:35:03.060
Boardroom: For all of their input.

1059
02:35:03.680 --> 02:35:07.490
Boardroom: We all understand how much these decisions affect you.

1060
02:35:07.620 --> 02:35:14.069
Boardroom: And… Your neighbors, thank you for your grace, understanding, sacrifice, and collaboration.

1061
02:35:14.190 --> 02:35:30.440
Boardroom: I will continue to look under every rock and in every corner to save our staff positions and to support our community, our arts and culture, and our many community partners. And I know I'm not the only one on this dice. I think we all share that sentiment.

1062
02:35:30.490 --> 02:35:35.029
Boardroom: Tonight, I want to speak directly to the preservation of affordable housing.

1063
02:35:35.350 --> 02:35:50.980
Boardroom: In my time working towards a Berkeley we can all call home, including serving 8 years on the Rent Board, helping craft Measure U1, and serving as chair of the Measure Oversight Committee, I have learned that affordable housing policy truly needs to be built around all three P's.

1064
02:35:50.980 --> 02:36:00.599
Boardroom: Production, protection, preservation. Each addresses a different part of the housing puzzle, and serves the different members of our community.

1065
02:36:00.610 --> 02:36:03.649
Boardroom: Berkeley has invested heavily in production.

1066
02:36:04.380 --> 02:36:09.680
Boardroom: Measure Oil alone committed $135 million towards new affordable housing.

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1067
02:36:10.280 --> 02:36:11.520
Boardroom: Including…

1068
02:36:11.690 --> 02:36:22.849
Boardroom: $7.5 million, towards 1740 San Pablo, which was cited earlier by Councilmember Casserwani, and which I strongly continue to support funding.

1069
02:36:23.380 --> 02:36:27.099
Boardroom: New construction alone, however, is not enough.

1070
02:36:27.220 --> 02:36:29.559
Boardroom: And should not be our only metric.

1071
02:36:31.330 --> 02:36:32.600
Boardroom: Preservation.

1072
02:36:32.780 --> 02:36:38.590
Boardroom: Of naturally occurring, affordable, housing,

1073
02:36:39.480 --> 02:36:49.919
Boardroom: Sorry. Preservation of naturally occurring affordable housing is critically important, especially to help vulnerable residents remain housed and connected to their communities.

1074
02:36:56.830 --> 02:37:09.450
Boardroom: Alarmingly, Berkeley's naturally occurring affordable housing is disappearing faster than we are replacing it. Since 2020, the city has lost roughly 1,000 unsubsidized affordable homes.

1075
02:37:09.450 --> 02:37:18.030
Boardroom: Of the approximately 7,600 affordable units that remain, an estimated 1,200 are at risk of loss within the next 5 years.

1076
02:37:18.440 --> 02:37:35.000
Boardroom: So, I can also tell you that even in Berkeley, with some of the strongest tenant protections in California, displacement still happens, and it happens more frequently than we may realize. And those most at risk tend to be seniors, families, women, and folks of color.

1077
02:37:35.000 --> 02:37:43.479

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Boardroom: Funding small sites through Measure U1 was specifically designed to supplement the city's efforts to keep our neighbors here in their houses.

1078
02:37:43.590 --> 02:38:03.100
Boardroom: Rooted here, in this community. The Small Sites Program preserves affordability within months, not years. Right now, community land trusts have identified approximately $5 million in acquisition opportunities, including for 28 units in West and Southwest Berkeley, and if unfunded.

1079
02:38:03.100 --> 02:38:08.549
Boardroom: Once these naturally affordable units are lost, they are effectively gone forever.

1080
02:38:10.080 --> 02:38:17.800
Boardroom: We should recognize that the availability of state and federal matching funds has become increasingly uncertain and competitive.

1081
02:38:17.910 --> 02:38:28.560
Boardroom: While leveraging outside resources is important, we should also note that some construction projects can wait for future funding that may never materialize.

1082
02:38:29.010 --> 02:38:40.570
Boardroom: In conclusion, I want to say that when voters supported our housing measures, they understood affordable housing to mean both creating new units and also preserving existing affordable units.

1083
02:38:40.580 --> 02:38:55.049
Boardroom: And keeping vulnerable residents in the communities they already call home. Measure O was our major investment in production. Measure U1 is our opportunity to strengthen the oft-overlooked third P of preservation.

1084
02:38:55.050 --> 02:39:05.049
Boardroom: These strategies should not be pitted against one another. Our goal must be to use every effective tool available to keep Berkeley neighbors housed

1085
02:39:05.210 --> 02:39:14.660
Boardroom: I need 20 more seconds to finish. You can have 20 seconds of Councilmember O'Keefe's. Thank you. And preserve the diverse community we all value.

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1086
02:39:15.030 --> 02:39:16.080
Boardroom: Truly.

1087
02:39:16.640 --> 02:39:22.360
Boardroom: Both are needed for… all three P's are needed for Barclay Weekendall call home.

1088
02:39:22.780 --> 02:39:25.680
Boardroom: The mayor's budget does just that.

1089
02:39:26.380 --> 02:39:40.199
Boardroom: Unfortunately, and while I appreciate all the efforts to compromise, like last year, we're down to that last piece, and with deep respect to the author and the co-sponsors.

1090
02:39:40.310 --> 02:39:48.649
Boardroom: I, am unable to support the substitute motion, because I believe that it falls short of crafting that careful balance.

1091
02:39:49.240 --> 02:39:52.749
Boardroom: I will be supporting the mayor's motion. Thank you.

1092
02:39:53.940 --> 02:39:55.450
Boardroom: Thank you, Vice Mayor.

1093
02:39:55.630 --> 02:40:02.580
Boardroom: Alright, in our order, we have, again, Councilmember Humbert, then Taplin, then Lunapara, then Bartlett.

1094
02:40:04.040 --> 02:40:05.330
Boardroom: And then O'Keefe.

1095
02:40:06.530 --> 02:40:07.930
Boardroom: Thank you, Madam Mayor.

1096
02:40:08.520 --> 02:40:17.869
Boardroom: I want to say, first of all, thank you to everyone who's commented and sent us emails, everyone who's come in here tonight, sent us, you know.

1097
02:40:18.080 --> 02:40:21.439

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Boardroom: tons and tons of emails. I've tried to read every one.

1098
02:40:21.560 --> 02:40:36.930
Boardroom: I want to say thank you to all of our city staff, and especially the finance department and the city manager's office, all of our department heads and so many others for their ongoing work on this complicated, you know, to put it very mildly, difficult budget.

1099
02:40:37.200 --> 02:40:48.200
Boardroom: I also want to thank Mayor Ishii, her Chief of staff, and all of her staff for their work on the budget, and really, it was a whole lot of work, and for including me as part of the Mayor's Brown Act Circle.

1100
02:40:48.360 --> 02:41:07.760
Boardroom: I do want to thank, as well, Councilmembers Kesarwani, Taplin, and Blackaby for offering their supplemental. I think we all share in the goal in making sure that our first responders, be they firefighters, paramedics, or police, have the resources and tools they need to keep Berkeley safe and deliver the level of services

1101
02:41:07.760 --> 02:41:09.420
Boardroom: That residents expect.

1102
02:41:09.750 --> 02:41:21.000
Boardroom: Candidly, I see merit. You know, things are moving very quickly here tonight. I see merit. I saw merit in both of the motions. To the mayor's great credit.

1103
02:41:21.160 --> 02:41:28.569
Boardroom: I'm gonna have to strike that, because things have, have moved quickly.

1104
02:41:29.720 --> 02:41:35.239
Boardroom: I do want to say the following thing that I've said way too many times recently.

1105
02:41:35.980 --> 02:41:43.329
Boardroom: I sound like a broken record, but I mediated hundreds of cases in my career, and the thing that I come back to

1106
02:41:43.490 --> 02:41:53.460
Boardroom: over and over again is my definition of a good result. And a good result in a very difficult, disputed situation is when both sides

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1107
02:41:53.970 --> 02:41:57.010
Boardroom: Or all sides in that, in that dispute.

1108
02:41:58.260 --> 02:42:03.099
Boardroom: are… leave… are able to reach rapprochement.

1109
02:42:03.420 --> 02:42:13.999
Boardroom: are somewhat unhappy with the result, but willing to live with it and move forward. And I think that's where we're… we're heading tonight.

1110
02:42:15.250 --> 02:42:19.270
Boardroom: I also want to say the following,

1111
02:42:19.740 --> 02:42:23.570
Boardroom: And I want to be really clear, because this is true.

1112
02:42:23.570 --> 02:42:40.860
Boardroom: No one has done more to bring affordable and supportive housing to her own district than Councilmember Kesarwani. Literally hundreds of people in Berkeley have roofs over their heads because of her, saying that she's engaged in some kind of class warfare

1113
02:42:40.930 --> 02:42:50.940
Boardroom: is frankly garbage. I mean, it just makes no sense at all. It's just ridiculous, false hyperbole. I also want to say that I agree with

1114
02:42:51.030 --> 02:43:02.929
Boardroom: Rashi philosophically on affordable housing in general, but I'm willing to compromise, to give the land trusts a chance, for the projects that are in the pipeline.

1115
02:43:03.120 --> 02:43:09.240
Boardroom: You know, I also want to say that I think that

1116
02:43:09.300 --> 02:43:17.539
Boardroom: you know, I would join in Councilmember Blackaby's comments that, really, a more effective way of

1117
02:43:17.580 --> 02:43:37.479

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Boardroom: putting roofs over people's heads is by leveraging, our affordable housing dollars, other than through the small sites program. But what I'm hearing lately, and I heard this from one of the, representatives of the Land Trust, is that maybe the,

1118
02:43:37.840 --> 02:43:41.259
Boardroom: The, the housing bond coming down the pike.

1119
02:43:41.380 --> 02:43:49.080
Boardroom: hopefully it'll pass, will help leverage small site monies, too. So, you know, that would be great if that happens.

1120
02:43:49.650 --> 02:43:54.479
Boardroom: And those are my comments for now. Thank you.

1121
02:43:55.470 --> 02:44:00.289
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember. We are moving on to Councilmember Taplin Online.

1122
02:44:01.830 --> 02:44:08.789
Terry Taplin: Thank you, and thank you, everyone. I, too, wish to underscore the severe difficulty with which we make tonight's decision.

1123
02:44:08.920 --> 02:44:11.749
Terry Taplin: I also believe that this is only the beginning.

1124
02:44:11.860 --> 02:44:18.850
Terry Taplin: We will need to treat every dollar and every program with scrutiny in order to correct course and right-size the organization.

1125
02:44:19.060 --> 02:44:30.640
Terry Taplin: The city has an obligation to provide core critical services, including public safety. There would have been no way for me to support a budget that eliminated so many fire positions. I appreciate everyone's work to minimize the cuts.

1126
02:44:31.260 --> 02:44:43.179
Terry Taplin: Regarding affordable housing, the Trust Fund supports a variety of affordable housing projects, so there should be some flexibility to make the most sound choice with our limited resources. And for that reason, I will be supporting the substitute motion. Thank you.

1127
02:44:44.840 --> 02:44:48.199

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Boardroom: Thank you. Councilmember Lunapara. Thank you.

1128
02:44:48.940 --> 02:45:06.729
Boardroom: This is, without a doubt, the hardest part of this job. My staff and I have worked tirelessly to identify other ways to sustainably balance the budget that limits layoffs and keeps necessary services intact, and I know that the city manager, the mayor, and each council member on this dais has done the same.

1129
02:45:07.400 --> 02:45:22.810
Boardroom: Ultimately, the budgetary decisions that have prioritized one-time funding for continuous services, patched anticipated deficit with unsustainable revenues, and bypassed established council processes have brought us to this moment. Throughout this process, my goals have remained steady.

1130
02:45:22.940 --> 02:45:36.869
Boardroom: Protect as many filled union jobs as possible, while balancing the critical need for emergency services, comprehensive public safety, and sustainably balance the budget so future city managers, councils, and city workers are not faced with this impossible task.

1131
02:45:37.790 --> 02:45:44.800
Boardroom: This whole process has forced us to examine how we approach budgeting, and has given us an opportunity to reflect on where we have fallen short.

1132
02:45:46.050 --> 02:45:56.139
Boardroom: Past decisions have shifted the responsibility for making these heartbreaking and nearly impossible decisions onto the city manager's team, while asking our employees to bear the heaviest burden through layoffs and service reductions.

1133
02:45:56.200 --> 02:45:59.899
Boardroom: And I'm not suggesting that we control every variable. There are certainly economic

1134
02:45:59.930 --> 02:46:17.310
Boardroom: and financial conditions beyond our influence. But we do have a responsibility moving forward to make difficult policy choices, set clearer priorities, and create a more sustainable framework for the future. If we fail to do that, we will continue to place staff in an untenable position and force our workforce and community to absorb the consequences.

1135

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02:46:17.850 --> 02:46:20.879
Boardroom: I believe this council has really stepped up to the plate.

1136
02:46:21.160 --> 02:46:27.590
Boardroom: We do not take city workers for granted, and we recognize the weight of navigating competing priorities with limited resources.

1137
02:46:27.720 --> 02:46:44.939
Boardroom: We are no longer comfortable with funding ongoing projects with one-time dollars. We are mindful of the actual labor required to implement our policy intentions, and we respect that true democracy and meaningful change do not happen overnight. I want to thank the mayor for her leadership. You've been dealt a really difficult hand, and you've faced it head-on.

1138
02:46:46.900 --> 02:47:04.430
Boardroom: I want to thank the Mayor and her Brown Act Circle for making the study and design of a car-free telegraph a priority. This idea has been discussed since the 1960s, and it remains one of the most important opportunities for creating a more sustainable, people-centered city. It is near and dear to my heart, and what got me excited about and energized to join Civic life in Berkeley.

1139
02:47:04.670 --> 02:47:16.129
Boardroom: By investing in this effort, we're sending a clear message that our city values the people who walk, bike, roll, and rely on public transit to move around our city. It shows that we're committed to designing streets with them in mind, not as an afterthought.

1140
02:47:16.310 --> 02:47:24.409
Boardroom: It also shows respect for the Council's established planning and ranking process, and a willingness to follow through in the community-centered, democratic vision it was created to advance.

1141
02:47:24.540 --> 02:47:28.379
Boardroom: This is a first step to a long process, and I'm so excited to see it progress.

1142
02:47:29.100 --> 02:47:40.629
Boardroom: I also want to thank the Mayor for prioritizing the Sacred Rest drop-in Center. It's an extremely important fixture in Southside, and enables homeless folks to rest, store their belongings, and get connected to local and regional services.

1143
02:47:41.410 --> 02:47:50.139

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Boardroom: It has been really important for me this year to develop items and identify priorities that do not require general fund money, and I'm grateful that that is an evident goal of this budget.

1144
02:47:51.880 --> 02:48:06.379
Boardroom: On small sites, we received many emails saying that we should fund firefighter positions over the allocated small sites funding, and I want to clear that up again. These are not flexible dollars. They have to be used on affordable housing funds, as they are part of the Housing Trust Fund.

1145
02:48:07.350 --> 02:48:16.279
Boardroom: I am deeply in support of new, dense, affordable housing, and I am not under the false assumption that it is the only way to solve our affordability crisis.

1146
02:48:16.540 --> 02:48:28.640
Boardroom: If preservation was not an important part of the puzzle, organizations fighting to address the housing crisis, like Eastway for Everyone and EBHO, major affordable housing developers, and regional partners would not support preservation funding, which they do.

1147
02:48:28.850 --> 02:48:35.750
Boardroom: This consensus reflects a clear understanding that preservation must be part of our housing strategy, and one that I think makes sense

1148
02:48:36.670 --> 02:48:40.019
Boardroom: To go after, because we ultimately need an all-of-the-above approach.

1149
02:48:40.130 --> 02:48:43.850
Boardroom: And developing new housing at the moment is unfortunately incredibly expensive.

1150
02:48:44.580 --> 02:48:58.749
Boardroom: I also want to clarify where this money for small sites is coming from. We have $2.5 million that we would be carrying over from the allocation last year, and the mayor and her Barnack Circle are also proposing an additional $1.3 million from the Housing Trust Fund.

1151
02:48:58.750 --> 02:49:05.139
Boardroom: If that's what the Council decides, as of right now, there's still another $1.4 million in the Housing Trust Fund.

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1152
02:49:06.030 --> 02:49:11.970
Boardroom: Overall, I support the main motion, and I'm very grateful for everybody's work. Thank you.

1153
02:49:14.170 --> 02:49:19.159
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember. We are moving online to Councilmember Bartlett.

1154
02:49:24.180 --> 02:49:29.249
Ben Bartlett: Okay, thank you. And, you know, I for one, too, want to thank everyone for your work.

1155
02:49:29.270 --> 02:49:45.219
Ben Bartlett: This is tremendous. The level of scrutiny you had to apply, to our complex city operations and all the facets of it. I know it was hard, you put a lot of time into this, all of you. Thank you so much. Thank you. From the city side, and my colleagues on the Budget Committee side.

1156
02:49:45.220 --> 02:49:59.500
Ben Bartlett: Thank you again. And I do want to speak to, the accusations as well. You know, Councilor Gastarwani, I know her really well, long-time friend and colleague, and, you know, she believes she's doing the right thing for a community.

1157
02:49:59.500 --> 02:50:06.749
Ben Bartlett: And that… that is valuable. And it's not… nothing to be distrust, it's just something you may not agree with, that's all.

1158
02:50:06.820 --> 02:50:22.709
Ben Bartlett: So, for one, I'm really excited, you know, the elements of the mayor's budget, of both budgets that I'm happy about here, these latest interpretations of it, makes me happy because, you see, I swore an oath, quite some time ago to defend the week.

1159
02:50:23.060 --> 02:50:27.479
Ben Bartlett: And this budget does just that. The first responders.

1160
02:50:27.890 --> 02:50:48.990
Ben Bartlett: they're there, front line for the people. And all the times we've worked with people and worked out our health programs, we created the health equity plan, we created the SCU, it was all about these people on the ground and fire interacting with them. And police as well. And so

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police are going to come to this later, I think, after the… after this… after this moment. But.

1161
02:50:48.990 --> 02:50:52.680
Ben Bartlett: So, so, so getting those jobs set up is important.

1162
02:50:52.680 --> 02:51:00.990
Ben Bartlett: important. And then the Small Sites Initiative. You know, this city was decidedly anti-housing, as you all know, for many decades.

1163
02:51:00.990 --> 02:51:15.229
Ben Bartlett: And part of the way that we succeeded in moving the needle and getting people to accept a new consensus of housing production and new housing and legalizing housing, there's an 18-month-long charrette series

1164
02:51:15.230 --> 02:51:25.610
Ben Bartlett: throughout the region to come up with a framework that everyone could get into, buy into. And that framework, as Vice Mayor Trigov mentioned, the three P's. Produce.

1165
02:51:25.790 --> 02:51:27.540
Ben Bartlett: Preserve. Protect.

1166
02:51:28.120 --> 02:51:39.950
Ben Bartlett: So, we're producing a lot. I know right here in my district, we have tons and tons of affordable housing, all new. Preserve, come to that. Protect, we passed the strongest tenant protections in the country.

1167
02:51:40.470 --> 02:51:46.659
Ben Bartlett: and not preserve. This is the Small Sites Initiative, and I'm very proud of it because I've seen it work.

1168
02:51:46.710 --> 02:51:49.119
Ben Bartlett: My district was the first church housing

1169
02:51:49.120 --> 02:52:08.690
Ben Bartlett: version of this thing in the country, and it was amazing. People were gonna be gone, had nowhere to go, now they're here. Another building in California that people, again, are so happy, and they have roots here, they're from here. It won't be a new family that you don't know in seven years trying to get in. These are people who have existed connections to this community now.

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1170
02:52:08.690 --> 02:52:28.529
Ben Bartlett: And so, capturing these, you know, this land value, and land trusts, I think, is very valuable, and it's an important part of the three P's. And this is the most underutilized P, too, by the way. And so a balanced housing portfolio has the three Ps in full effect. And also, and it's a displacement strategy.

1171
02:52:28.530 --> 02:52:35.530
Ben Bartlett: must incorporate the second P, preservation. And third, I just wanna, I just wanna call out again,

1172
02:52:35.550 --> 02:52:49.739
Ben Bartlett: the, the need to do… so we're going to have to really rework everything as we go forward, and one thing I just want to put out there now, and I said this before, years ago, it may be time, to explore Henry George's model of taxation.

1173
02:52:50.220 --> 02:53:03.690
Ben Bartlett: And that's a… that's a public value, creation, benefit value. So that's something we can discuss later, but I want to get that conversation going right now, because this is not sustainable with our desires and our needs.

1174
02:53:03.850 --> 02:53:08.400
Ben Bartlett: But to that effect, I'm supporting the mayor's motion, and thank you very much for all your work.

1175
02:53:09.060 --> 02:53:15.189
Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember. Moving on to Councilmember O'Keefe. Thank you.

1176
02:53:18.460 --> 02:53:32.510
Boardroom: First, I want to express, just a couple small things to be in, and then I'll talk about the big issues. I want to express some gratitude that the Solana Stroll and some very important District 5 infrastructure projects are slated to be funded.

1177
02:53:32.510 --> 02:53:42.750
Boardroom: I want to thank Alan Kane and, Vice Mayor Jennifer Hansen Romero of Albany for working with me on the stroll issue, and, a number of my constituents for working with me on the,

1178
02:53:42.820 --> 02:53:46.419

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Boardroom: Infrastructure issues, and of course, city staff that supported all of that.

1179
02:53:47.730 --> 02:53:53.530
Boardroom: Regarding small sites, I'll be supporting the mayor's motion.

1180
02:53:53.640 --> 02:53:56.870
Boardroom: I understand.

1181
02:53:57.000 --> 02:54:03.029
Boardroom: The arguments made against this allocation that the funding's not optimal?

1182
02:54:03.300 --> 02:54:11.630
Boardroom: I… I get that. I think… I think this is a situation where the argument is maybe more or less technically accurate, if you look at it a certain way.

1183
02:54:11.900 --> 02:54:12.930
Boardroom: But…

1184
02:54:13.530 --> 02:54:23.729
Boardroom: In order to do that, you really have to ignore some of the unquantifiable benefits of a program like this, which includes keeping communities intact.

1185
02:54:23.940 --> 02:54:30.459
Boardroom: You cannot put a price on that. And also shielding people from the life-altering trauma of being displaced.

1186
02:54:30.930 --> 02:54:40.009
Boardroom: So I actually think it's okay to pay a little more for those intangible benefits that can make a world of difference to the people affected. And I'm glad that we have a diverse

1187
02:54:40.230 --> 02:54:52.349
Boardroom: portfolio of affordable housing strategies, because you have to do all of it, PPP, and everyone already talked about that, but I am happy to support, including this and continuing to support this particular strategy for those reasons.

1188
02:54:53.850 --> 02:55:00.409

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Boardroom: Regarding the fire positions, I'm so glad we figured out a way to fund those, oh my god.

1189
02:55:00.810 --> 02:55:12.880
Boardroom: I represent one of the three, real fire risk, districts, and, you know, and I represent the district that will stand to lose a fire station if the, God forbid, the sales tax doesn't pass.

1190
02:55:13.070 --> 02:55:21.389
Boardroom: I'm a person whose children have had medical emergencies, and I have two octogenarian parents living in Berkeley extremely far from any emergency room.

1191
02:55:21.640 --> 02:55:36.540
Boardroom: All this to say, I really love the firefighters, not just for myself and my family, but for the important, essential, and often back-breaking work they do, that our entire community benefits from every day, whether they realize it or not.

1192
02:55:37.200 --> 02:55:38.969
Boardroom: So, I…

1193
02:55:39.190 --> 02:55:50.750
Boardroom: while I feel really good, really good, so good, about restoring these fire positions, I do want to just name, I have some reservations, I'm voting for it, but I have some reservations,

1194
02:55:50.860 --> 02:56:05.070
Boardroom: about, equity, because I know that there are other types of positions that you're not choosing to restore. I just really wanted to name that. It doesn't… I don't feel great about it. Specifically, I know our police officers, took a lot of cuts.

1195
02:56:05.140 --> 02:56:21.659
Boardroom: And haven't gotten anything back in this. To some extent, I think the inequity is to some extent justified because a lot of this extra funding came from the ambulance services, which is a strong nexus with the firefighters' work, but not all of it. And so,

1196
02:56:22.320 --> 02:56:26.219
Boardroom: But I also know that these… cutting these positions really…

1197
02:56:26.230 --> 02:56:39.179

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Boardroom: it has a very specific, devastating effect on our firefighters. I've heard this directly from them, that it really forces them to work a huge amount of mandatory overtime, which is just unsustainable in that kind of work.

1198
02:56:39.180 --> 02:56:47.990
Boardroom: And so it feels good to, to be able to give back some of that. But I do want to make a request of Council, and actually a personal promise that I will…

1199
02:56:48.060 --> 02:56:49.080
Boardroom: upkeep.

1200
02:56:49.240 --> 02:57:02.050
Boardroom: that when we do come back in early 2027 for the mid-year budget review, which will hopefully include revenue from our newly passed sales tax, and also our transfer tax income will be untouched, I really hope we can look

1201
02:57:02.050 --> 02:57:12.870
Boardroom: again, at some of those public safety positions and other positions that are being cut, because I… we're not… this work is not complete tonight. This is what we're doing right now, tonight. This is the most,

1202
02:57:12.890 --> 02:57:18.570
Boardroom: This is the best thing to do right now, but this work is not done, and we need to revisit that to feel good about this process.

1203
02:57:19.060 --> 02:57:21.130
Boardroom: So that's… that's my,

1204
02:57:21.260 --> 02:57:34.949
Boardroom: my one caveat. But for tonight, I think this is gonna have to be good enough. I really want to thank all my council colleagues and city staff, especially our budget team, our city manager, and our deputy city manager. And I… really, lastly, I want to thank the mayor.

1205
02:57:34.980 --> 02:57:44.830
Boardroom: For, just really amazing leadership, navigating us through really difficult waters with integrity and honesty and really good communication. Thank you so much.

1206
02:57:45.790 --> 02:57:58.409

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Boardroom: Thank you, Councilmember. Councilmember Blackaby, did you have something you wanted to add? I had a technical amendment, actually, and a consultation with staff, on the provision for the Euclid Street improvement,

1207
02:57:58.580 --> 02:58:17.510
Boardroom: In 28, we had listed it as a surplus fund relinquishment. What staff's asked is we consider that a reduction in our office budget from the beginning. So it's a slight tweak. It's still the $25K, but it's a reduction in our budget as opposed to a later relinquishment. So my ask would be a friendly amendment to both

1208
02:58:17.930 --> 02:58:19.489
Boardroom: the substitute…

1209
02:58:19.680 --> 02:58:31.410
Boardroom: amendment makers, as well as the primary motion makers, to make that friendly amendment. It's just a characterization of what we do at the 25K, how we consider it. Yes. Okay, and Councilmember Kastarwani on the substitute.

1210
02:58:31.420 --> 02:58:39.859
Boardroom: Do you accept the friendly amendment? It's basically considering the 25K and 28 to be a reduction in our office budget from the beginning, as opposed to a later relinquishment.

1211
02:58:40.190 --> 02:58:47.810
Boardroom: requests from staff, of just how we consider it. It's the same numbers. Clark is clear on… Yeah.

1212
02:58:47.870 --> 02:59:03.440
Boardroom: Clerk, are you… yeah. Okay. Okay. Okay. Great, thank you. That's it. Okay, thank you. Okay, popping back to Councilmember Humbert. Yeah, I, I want to join in the final set of comments that,

1213
02:59:03.900 --> 02:59:17.039
Boardroom: Councilmember O'Keefe just made, and I want to join in the promise that she made. I think it's really critical that when we come back mid-year, that we look at what we can do for our other

1214
02:59:17.310 --> 02:59:26.800
Boardroom: you know, our other unions, our police union, our police department, and, Local One and SCIU. So, thank you.

1215

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02:59:27.040 --> 02:59:36.579
Boardroom: Thank you. Back to Councilmember Kesarwani. Yes, thank you very much, Madam Mayor. So, you know, I just, I want to thank you again for,

1216
02:59:36.700 --> 02:59:55.419
Boardroom: helping us reach a consensus here, and feel very comfortable with where we are. And, with the small sites funding, I did want to ask, this is something I had been contemplating with the city manager, and maybe Ms. Ernst, if she's still there, she can advise.

1217
02:59:55.420 --> 03:00:02.719
Boardroom: My understanding is typically these acquisitions happen within a year. I did want to…

1218
03:00:02.730 --> 03:00:16.429
Boardroom: ensure that we had some protection if the acquisition did not occur within a period of 36 months, that the funds would be returned to the city, and I want to ask if we can… Ms. Ernst has any input on that, and if…

1219
03:00:16.510 --> 03:00:20.620
Boardroom: I wanna… anyhow, let me pause there and see if she can advise.

1220
03:00:23.360 --> 03:00:33.040
Margot Ernst: Yes, if I could clarify, you mean 36 months from the time that we've approved a specific project?

1221
03:00:34.080 --> 03:00:35.010
Boardroom: Yes.

1222
03:00:35.320 --> 03:00:35.880
Margot Ernst: Yes.

1223
03:00:35.880 --> 03:00:50.989
Boardroom: from the time of providing the funding, that, because I don't know which project is going to be awarded these funds and what their full need would be, and I do want to acknowledge, I didn't acknowledge this, it is…

1224
03:00:51.120 --> 03:01:07.870
Boardroom: accurate that there are… there could be some sources of matching funds, right? There's Measure W at the county level, there's a

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possibility of this state affordable housing bond. I think the reality is those are limited resources that are very competitive.

1225
03:01:07.870 --> 03:01:26.640
Boardroom: And so… so that is why… I'm concerned if our funds are sort of sitting there and not able to be fully used. I don't think that has happened traditionally, but in the event that it does, I wanted to provide this direction around 36 months, which is, you know, 3 years to…

1226
03:01:27.240 --> 03:01:27.960
Margot Ernst: Sure.

1227
03:01:27.960 --> 03:01:30.080
Boardroom: Draw down those matching funds.

1228
03:01:30.820 --> 03:01:46.150
Margot Ernst: Yeah, I think that… that seems reasonable. I would say that in most cases, when… once funds… an application has been approved for funding, and just to clarify, we don't actually disperse the money until the… the acquisition goes through.

1229
03:01:46.150 --> 03:02:00.529
Margot Ernst: But, once… once we've approved an application over the counter through the NOFA, it would… it's usually much quicker than a year that the acquisition would happen, so 3 years is certainly…

1230
03:02:00.820 --> 03:02:06.770
Margot Ernst: Yeah, if it hasn't happened in 3 years, I mean, it wouldn't… then something's gone wrong, and we would wanna…

1231
03:02:06.990 --> 03:02:10.120
Margot Ernst: We would want to pull that… that award back, yes.

1232
03:02:10.120 --> 03:02:27.280
Boardroom: Okay, so I just want to… and maybe this is something you would have already done, because I, you know, I haven't reviewed these contracts in detail, but I just want to give you that direction so it's clear that, that, that there's a 30… there's, you know, up to 36 months to conduct the acquisition.

1233
03:02:29.370 --> 03:02:30.999
Boardroom: Is that clear enough?

1234

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03:02:31.420 --> 03:02:33.089
Margot Ernst: Oh, yes, yes, sure.

1235
03:02:33.090 --> 03:02:40.679
Boardroom: Okay, so that's an amendment I'm adding to the substitute motion. I'm wondering if the mayor, or it's not the mayor, it's Mr. Humbert who's…

1236
03:02:41.770 --> 03:02:43.720
Boardroom: the motion maker…

1237
03:02:43.870 --> 03:02:53.040
Boardroom: For the main motion? Sorry, what are you asking for? I'm asking who do I ask to consider this as a friendly amendment to the main motion as well? You are asking both…

1238
03:02:53.210 --> 03:03:12.590
Boardroom: Councilmembers Humbert and Vice Mayor Treykop. Okay. So, Councilmember Humbert, are you amenable to adding this language around small sites funding, that the acquisition needs to take place within 36 months of receiving the funds from the city? And if not, you know, the expectation is that those funds are returned to the city.

1239
03:03:12.750 --> 03:03:16.269
Boardroom: I guess I would want to confirm that with the mayor, since it is truly your…

1240
03:03:17.970 --> 03:03:25.079
Boardroom: Okay, you can turn your mic on, too. Yeah, sorry. Well, also, the Vice Mayor would have to accept it as well, so…

1241
03:03:25.440 --> 03:03:31.390
Boardroom: Right, but I want your response. Yeah, I mean, it would be good to know if 36

1242
03:03:31.840 --> 03:03:39.400
Boardroom: Months was gonna be enough time from… from when the… Okay, yeah.

1243
03:03:39.890 --> 03:03:43.500
Boardroom: Alright, sounds like that's okay. Okay, yes.

1244
03:03:45.880 --> 03:03:54.570

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Boardroom: Okay, okay, wonderful. I, I, I, yeah, I don't expect it to be an issue, but I just want to make sure we have that… that assurance, so thank you very much.

1245
03:03:56.260 --> 03:03:59.580
Boardroom: Okay, Councilmember Taplin, did you have your hand raised?

1246
03:03:59.580 --> 03:04:18.819
Terry Taplin: Yes, thank you. I wanted to chime in in response to Councilmembers O'Keefe and Humbert, and I am in agreement. I would offer that whatever diligence and prudence we apply to our efforts to restore other positions.

1247
03:04:19.090 --> 03:04:21.839
Terry Taplin: In our mid-year review.

1248
03:04:23.310 --> 03:04:30.759
Terry Taplin: be also… Applied to our evaluation of the programs we support, and the

1249
03:04:31.160 --> 03:04:32.969
Terry Taplin: The public funds that we gift.

1250
03:04:33.780 --> 03:04:39.369
Terry Taplin: I think those two efforts are continuous and mutually beneficial.

1251
03:04:39.630 --> 03:04:40.480
Terry Taplin: Thank you.

1252
03:04:43.690 --> 03:04:52.759
Boardroom: Okay, alright, so, I did just want to make a few comments about small sites, but then I really would like us to vote. So…

1253
03:04:53.310 --> 03:05:08.660
Boardroom: As we've said, and as many folks have already said, preservation is an important part of the equation. The money for new buildings can be leveraged because there is more funding available for new housing, and as we heard, there's also some opportunities coming up for…

1254
03:05:08.660 --> 03:05:15.519

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Boardroom: these projects to be… to leverage funds as well. The cost per unit for homes that are preserved is lower.

1255
03:05:15.520 --> 03:05:21.349
Boardroom: from the Berkeley site article that was published yesterday, according to data from our city.

1256
03:05:21.350 --> 03:05:39.529
Boardroom: The three buildings acquired through the Small Sites program cost $459,000 per unit to buy and rehabilitate, on average, less than half the cost of recently… recent newly built affordable developments Berkeley has funded, which has averaged $930,000 per unit.

1257
03:05:40.150 --> 03:05:48.739
Boardroom: New housing takes many years and does nothing to keep people in the neighborhoods and communities they live in now. We really need both types, preserved and new.

1258
03:05:50.340 --> 03:05:57.450
Boardroom: So, I did also want to just add one thing about staff,

1259
03:05:58.220 --> 03:06:12.570
Boardroom: As I said already, I am very disappointed that we weren't able to find additional funding. I know there are a number of folks who won't be able to continue working in the city, although we are working to offer those folks positions as well.

1260
03:06:12.770 --> 03:06:28.560
Boardroom: And I did want to especially comment on the fact that, I really appreciate that BPA has been very supportive throughout this process, and… and so I do recognize that this will feel painful, especially to our police department. I want to thank

1261
03:06:28.720 --> 03:06:34.410
Boardroom: staff, very much for all the work that they've been doing. Both are…

1262
03:06:34.410 --> 03:06:56.569
Boardroom: finance director and deputy city manager, city manager, my Chief of staff, and also my Chief of Policy have been meeting weekly. I have been talking to our city manager about this budget since I was elected. And so, although I am definitely relieved for us to be able to take this vote tonight, I am

1263

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03:06:56.670 --> 03:07:07.260
Boardroom: Definitely want to acknowledge just the sacrifice and the time and energy that's gone into this, both from city staff and, my staff and all of us here on the dais.

1264
03:07:09.400 --> 03:07:16.920
Boardroom: as has been said, these are not easy decisions, and none of us got elected so we could cut positions.

1265
03:07:16.920 --> 03:07:35.940
Boardroom: incredibly painful, and I want folks to know that I'm also working very hard on increasing our revenue. We've been doing a lot of work around tourism, encouraging the development in downtown to move forward, and also helping to keep a lot of the startups that are at UC Berkeley

1266
03:07:36.060 --> 03:07:49.700
Boardroom: In our city locally, so that they continue to grow and stay here. And so, just know, folks, that cutting during budgets isn't the only solution. We really need to be working on revenue generation, and that that takes time.

1267
03:07:49.790 --> 03:08:06.929
Boardroom: So we are very focused on that. I know my council members agree with me on this as well, and we will continue to keep an eye on November's elections to see how this is going to impact our budget so that we can move forward and continue to make responsible decisions. That is really important to me.

1268
03:08:07.760 --> 03:08:16.110
Boardroom: Okay, so, there is a motion that's on the floor. Oh, Councilmember Kissimani, did you have something else? Yes, I, I just, I have to clarify that

1269
03:08:16.340 --> 03:08:31.820
Boardroom: the numbers you cited in the Berkeley site article, the unit… per unit cost for Berkeley, for each unit of the small sites, it's $286,000. Compared to the new buildings, it's only $209,000. I just… I think the facts matter.

1270
03:08:31.960 --> 03:08:46.230
Boardroom: And we are creating new units with less money with the new affordable housing. Thank you. Okay. So there is a substitute motion that's on the floor. Councilmember Keserwani's substitute motion, so could we take the roll on that, please?

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1271
03:08:47.660 --> 03:09:01.949
Boardroom: Okay, so, on the substitute motion, so I'm just gonna go through it, please indulge me. The substitute motion is everything from the main motion with a few, differences, so…

1272
03:09:02.110 --> 03:09:22.069
Boardroom: It's to adopt the staff recommendation that includes a revised material from the City Manager in Supplemental 2, the revised material from the City Manager that was accepted at the meeting, further revised by the Mayor's amended proposal that she went through on the floor, including the four projects that were reclassified in the CIP,

1273
03:09:22.350 --> 03:09:30.070
Boardroom: Retaining the Assistant City Clerk position and using the additional $200,000 from the ambulance transport revenue.

1274
03:09:30.440 --> 03:09:40.439
Boardroom: Clarifying that the $25,000 in fiscal year 28 for the Euclid Street project is a reduction from the office budgets rather than relinquishments.

1275
03:09:40.880 --> 03:09:49.589
Boardroom: And adding, the provision of the small sites language, that the acquisition needs to take place within 36 months.

1276
03:09:49.940 --> 03:10:00.349
Boardroom: And then the main difference being that for small sites retaining the $2.5 million for small sites.

1277
03:10:00.470 --> 03:10:04.580
Boardroom: And retaining the $1.3 million in the Housing Trust Fund.

1278
03:10:05.230 --> 03:10:14.130
Boardroom: Thank you, that was very, very well said. Yes. Okay, alright, so we're voting on the substitute motion. Councilmember Kezarwani. Oh, yes.

1279
03:10:14.690 --> 03:10:15.690
Boardroom: Taplin?

1280
03:10:16.960 --> 03:10:17.990
Boardroom: Bartlett?

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1281
03:10:17.990 --> 03:10:18.730
Ben Bartlett: No.

1282
03:10:19.560 --> 03:10:21.460
Boardroom: Trey Gup? No.

1283
03:10:21.620 --> 03:10:23.310
Boardroom: O'Keefe? No.

1284
03:10:24.030 --> 03:10:25.630
Boardroom: Blackaby? Yes.

1285
03:10:26.150 --> 03:10:27.890
Boardroom: Luna Parra? No.

1286
03:10:28.390 --> 03:10:30.309
Boardroom: Humbert? Abstain.

1287
03:10:31.450 --> 03:10:33.300
Boardroom: Mayor Ishii? No.

1288
03:10:33.720 --> 03:10:35.760
Boardroom: Okay. Motion fails.

1289
03:10:37.010 --> 03:10:39.229
Boardroom: Alright, on the main motion.

1290
03:10:40.470 --> 03:10:42.090
Boardroom: Councilmember Kessarwani?

1291
03:10:42.190 --> 03:10:43.050
Boardroom: Yes.

1292
03:10:43.280 --> 03:10:44.420
Boardroom: Taplin?

1293
03:10:44.420 --> 03:10:45.180
Terry Taplin: Yes.

1294

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03:10:45.950 --> 03:10:46.620
Boardroom: Bartlett?

1295
03:10:46.620 --> 03:10:47.340
Ben Bartlett: Yes.

1296
03:10:47.980 --> 03:10:53.290
Boardroom: Triggup? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby? Yes.

1297
03:10:53.570 --> 03:10:55.390
Boardroom: Luna Parra? Yes.

1298
03:10:55.600 --> 03:11:03.430
Boardroom: Humbert? Yes. And Mayor Ishii? Yes. Motion passes. All right. Thank you, everyone.

1299
03:11:09.920 --> 03:11:17.000
Boardroom: So, Mr. City Manager, could you speak to what happens for this item number 2 here? This…

1300
03:11:17.230 --> 03:11:20.360
Boardroom: FY2027 Annual Appropriations Ordinance.

1301
03:11:22.360 --> 03:11:26.310
Boardroom: Mari Kar will… Marika can just say a little bit about it, and then we'll turn it back over.

1302
03:11:34.230 --> 03:11:43.549
Boardroom: We need to capture the motion that just passed, because that has impacted the 2027 annual appropriation ordinance.

1303
03:11:44.100 --> 03:11:47.639
Boardroom: So, would it be possible to take a quick 5-minute break?

1304
03:11:48.970 --> 03:11:52.109
Boardroom: I think we have to, so thank you.

1305
03:12:00.750 --> 03:12:10.089
Boardroom: We are moving on to item number 2, which is the FY2027 Annual Appropriations Ordinance, and I will pass it over to Marikar, please.

1306

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03:12:11.090 --> 03:12:12.329
Boardroom: Thank you.

1307
03:12:14.930 --> 03:12:26.150
Boardroom: The recommendation will change as follows. So, the current gross appropriation, was $918,080,782.

1308
03:12:26.550 --> 03:12:31.809
Boardroom: The change will be $3,515,334.

1309
03:12:31.950 --> 03:12:41.730
Boardroom: With a new revised gross appropriation for fiscal year 2027 to be $921,596,116.

1310
03:12:41.960 --> 03:12:47.829
Boardroom: And that captures new appropriation for the Downtown Berkeley Revitalization Project.

1311
03:12:48.050 --> 03:12:56.949
Boardroom: So, Sip Fund. Small sites, 1.3 million Sacred Rest Village of Love, Fund 147.

1312
03:12:57.170 --> 03:13:03.449
Boardroom: At the $100,000, the OBD Community Development Project Coordinator, General Fund.

1313
03:13:03.820 --> 03:13:10.919
Boardroom: Fire positions, and the CIP reduction of Measure FF projects, Fund 166.

1314
03:13:11.210 --> 03:13:13.550
Boardroom: At $1.65 million.

1315
03:13:17.470 --> 03:13:19.179
Boardroom: The net appropriation?

1316
03:13:19.860 --> 03:13:38.530
Boardroom: was $792,372,533. The change to that is $3,456,799, with a new net appropriations of $795,829.332.

1317
03:13:42.160 --> 03:13:45.049
Boardroom: And, that concludes the…

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1318
03:13:45.610 --> 03:14:01.319
Boardroom: Revision of the annual fiscal year 27 Annual Approbation Ordinance. Thank you very much. Is there a motion to approve? Moved as amended. And I'll second and say you're amazing. Thank you very much. Okay, can we take the roll on that, please?

1319
03:14:01.580 --> 03:14:10.910
Boardroom: All right, including the materials in this up, too, and further… Sorry, yeah, do we need to take public comment on that? Oh, sorry, we were all jumping the gun. Any public comment on this item?

1320
03:14:15.370 --> 03:14:17.879
Boardroom: Okay, okay, hi.

1321
03:14:17.980 --> 03:14:20.479
Boardroom: Seeing no commenters on this item.

1322
03:14:20.610 --> 03:14:21.750
Boardroom: All right.

1323
03:14:22.370 --> 03:14:39.509
Boardroom: Okay. I assume that you all don't have any comments on the dais? Okay, great. In that case, can you take the roll, please? Sure thing. Including the revised material from the City Manager in the Step 2, and further revised on the floor at the meeting. Councilmember Kesarwani? Yes. Taplin?

1324
03:14:39.510 --> 03:14:40.290
Terry Taplin: Yes.

1325
03:14:40.610 --> 03:14:41.570
Boardroom: Bartlett.

1326
03:14:47.570 --> 03:14:51.720
Boardroom: Councilmember Bartlett, on item 2, Annual Appropriations Ordinance?

1327
03:14:53.870 --> 03:14:54.800
Boardroom: We'll come back.

1328
03:14:54.800 --> 03:14:55.630

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Ben Bartlett: Yes.

1329
03:14:55.790 --> 03:15:05.919
Boardroom: Oh, great, thank you. Trey Gibb? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes. Blackaby? Yes. Lunapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. Mayor Ishii? Yes.

1330
03:15:07.150 --> 03:15:11.450
Boardroom: Alright, motion passes. Can we get a motion to adjourn, please?

1331
03:15:12.780 --> 03:15:14.980
Boardroom: So moved. Second.

1332
03:15:15.970 --> 03:15:20.700
Boardroom: Can we take the roll on that? To adjourn, Councilmember Keserwani? Yes. Chaplin?

1333
03:15:20.700 --> 03:15:21.410
Terry Taplin: Yes.

1334
03:15:21.750 --> 03:15:22.730
Boardroom: Bartlett?

1335
03:15:22.730 --> 03:15:23.480
Ben Bartlett: Yes.

1336
03:15:23.800 --> 03:15:26.520
Boardroom: Trakup? Aye. O'Keefe? Yes.

1337
03:15:26.780 --> 03:15:31.950
Boardroom: Blackaby? Yes. Nunapara? Yes. Humbert? Yes. Mayor Ishii? Yes.

1338
03:15:32.370 --> 03:15:36.149
Boardroom: We are adjourned! Thank you all so much. Thank you, everyone.

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